

PM says he'll decide next steps on Havana file after briefing

Carney acknowledges 'duty of care' owed to diplomats who faced mysterious ailments in Cuba

STEVEN CHASE
MERCEDES STEPHENSON
ROBERT FIFE OTTAWA
MIKE HAGER VANCOUVER

Prime Minister Mark Carney says he will determine the government's response to new details surrounding the unexplained health ailments experienced by Canadian diplomats stationed in Cuba almost a decade ago once he has been briefed on the matter.

The Globe and Mail reported last week that Canada and the United States were working closely together in Cuba between 2016 and 2018 when Canadian and Amer-

ican diplomats began reporting symptoms, including nosebleeds, dizziness, headaches, blurred vision and memory loss.

The report cited a source who said that a Canadian diplomat was sharing intelligence with American spies in Havana. It also cited a second source who said that Canadians were also using satellite equipment brought into Cuba under diplomatic cover by the U.S.

Asked about this Tuesday, Mr. Carney said he is looking into it.

"I expect to be briefed on the situation. There's some new information, as you say, that's come to light, and I'll take a determination after that's happened," he told re-

porters during a press conference in Vancouver, in his first public comments on the matter since the story was reported last week.

He acknowledged the duty Canada owes its diplomats.

"We owe a responsibility, and we discharge a responsibility, a duty of care for Canadian diplomats who serve on the front lines on behalf of Canadians," the Prime Minister said.

"As I've said, I expect to be briefed. I haven't been briefed in more detail about the latest revelations, and I commend you for raising them. And I expect to be briefed and take action from there."

■ HAVANA, A7

Ottawa poised to designate new pipeline a major project by Thursday

EMMA GRANEY CALGARY
MARIEKE WALSH OTTAWA
JEFFREY JONES CALGARY

The federal government is poised to list the newly proposed West Coast oil pipeline as a project of national interest by Thursday, Energy Minister Tim Hodgson said.

The pipeline is a key part of Prime Minister Mark Carney's suite of policy changes that aim to reset federal relations with Alberta and diversify Canadian exports away from the United States.

The national interest designation is allowed through the Building Canada Act, passed by the Liberals as one of the Prime Minister's first orders of business last year. It says that projects deemed to be in the national interest will "be advanced through an accelerated process that enhances regulatory certainty and investor confidence."

In May, Mr. Carney's government said it would designate the proposed pipeline a project of national interest under the act by Oct. 1. That process is being led by the federal Major Projects Office, headquartered in Calgary.

In a Tuesday interview with The Globe and Mail, Mr. Hodgson said that the MPO is still completing the steps needed to make the designation official.

■ PIPELINE, A17

[JUSTICE]

A BURDEN LIFTED

Ontario mother acquitted in 'shaken baby' case as court finds 2002 conviction was based on discredited science ■ A3



Jennifer Gaskin, right, holds mother Barbara Levesque's hand as they leave the Toronto courthouse where Ms. Gaskin's conviction was overturned Tuesday. 'They took my life and they made it right,' she says. EDUARDO LIMA/THE GLOBE AND MAIL

New Brunswick island with deep U.S. ties caught in the chaos of latest trade escalation

STEVEN CHASE
SENIOR PARLIAMENTARY REPORTER
OTTAWA

Donald Trump's new import ban targeting select Canadian goods is playing havoc with shipments of milk, liquor and groceries to Campobello Island, a part of Canada where the only land access is through Maine.

U.S. Customs on Tuesday blocked a truck from New Brunswick that carries supplies through Maine to the Canadian island – a land journey of about 75 kilometres, according to Campobello's mayor, Harvey Matthews.

The supply truck was turned back at the border crossing between St. Stephen, N.B., and Calais, Me., and instead travelled by two ferries to reach Campobello, home to about 950 people. The second ferry is only seasonal and expected to shut down after Thanksgiving.

The Trump administration's ban, which took effect at 12:01 a.m. Tuesday, targets Canadian alcoholic beverages, motorcycles, and products such as molasses and whey. It is the latest escalation in a trade war between Canada and the United States that was started by Mr. Trump in early 2025.

Mr. Matthews said he was not sure which products prompted U.S. Customs and Border Protection to turn back the Canadian

truck, but he said its shipment includes liquor for a grocery store on the island.

The truck, which is sealed with a customs tag, makes daily runs to deliver mail to residents of Campobello and it carries liquor and groceries, including milk, about once a week, the mayor said.

He said the truck's contents won't make any difference in the U.S.-Canada trade war.

"It's pretty stupid for two countries that are supposed to be neighbours to be fighting over this foolish stuff," Mr. Matthews said.

"You can live without the alcohol, but the milk is pretty important."

■ TRADE, A17

Federal drug trafficking law violates users' Charter rights, B.C. judge rules

ANDREA WOO
DAVID EBNER VANCOUVER

A B.C. Supreme Court judge has struck down a provision in Canada's federal drug law that prohibits possession for the purposes of trafficking, ruling that it violates the Charter rights of people who use drugs by preventing access to safer alternatives to toxic street drugs.

The Tuesday ruling was in response to a constitutional challenge by Jeremy Kalicum and Eris Nyx, who were convicted of trafficking for operating a compassion club in Vancouver that provided drug users with such unadulterated alternatives for more than a year.

B.C. Supreme Court Justice Catherine Murray declared Section 5(2) of the Controlled Drugs and Substances Act (CDSA) to be "of no force or effect," finding that it infringes on sections 7 and 15 of the Charter of Rights and Freedoms, which guarantee the right to life, liberty and security of the person, and equal protection under the law.

While the trafficking section of the law was declared invalid, Justice Murray suspended that declaration for six months to allow for legislative amendments. She also stayed the pair's convictions.

The federal Public Prosecution Service of Canada has 30 days to decide whether to appeal the ruling.

■ LAW, A7



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FELICIA CHANG/
THE GLOBE AND MAIL

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GLEN FAULMAN'S INSTALLATION VIEW OF MADE IN HAMILTON



1951 STUDEBAKER CHAMPION COLLECTION OF GLEN FAULMAN INSTALLATION VIEW OF MADE IN HAMILTON: THE GLEN FAULMAN COLLECTION AT THE ART GALLERY OF HAMILTON, JUNE 26, 2026 -JANUARY 3, 2027

Founded in 1914, the Art Gallery of Hamilton is the oldest and largest art museum in the region, with a permanent collection that is recognized as one of the finest in Canada. Embracing Canadian historical, international and contemporary art, the collection consists of just under 12,000 works. You can see pieces by Alex Colville, Tom Thomson, the Group of Seven, Emily Carr, James Tissot, Jean-Léon Gérôme, Gustave Doré, Norval Morrisseau, Keith Haring, Edward Burtnysky and Kim Adams, to name a few.

Made in Hamilton presents the remarkable collection of Glen Faulman, a third-generation Stelco worker who has spent two decades gathering Hamilton-made goods spanning the city's manufacturing history. This exhibition nods to the past when Hamilton, Ont., was home to more than 700 manufacturing industries. Made in Hamilton evokes the spirit of the city's bygone industrial exhibitions and civic identity, inviting us to reflect on how this legacy continues to shape Hamilton's role in a global economy. Made in Hamilton: The Glen Faulman Collection is on view at the AGH until Jan. 3, 2027.

COLUMNISTS

GARY MASON

OPINION



When there's a push to replace Premier Smith, will she finally take a principled stand? ■ A11

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Andaz Lisbon, a new luxe hotel with reliable AC, may be reason enough to book ■ A12

RITA TRICHUR

OPINION



It's time for Ottawa to get serious about setting Canadian regulators up for success ■ B4

CORRECTIONS

A Tuesday news article about calls for a parliamentary inquiry into Havana Syndrome incorrectly stated that Foreign Affairs Minister Anita Anand addressed reporters at a press conference in Ottawa. She was in Toronto.

A Saturday Opinion article about Vancouver Island forests misidentified the trees in the main image. The tree known as Big Lonely Doug was pictured in the background at left; its nearby sister was shown in the foreground.

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SANDRA E. MARTIN, STANDARDS EDITOR, standardseditor@globeandmail.com

Journalist crowned king of Uganda monarchy

RODNEY MUHUMUZA KAMPALA

A journalist on Tuesday was crowned king of a traditional monarchy that lost its one-time "boy king" last month, triggering widespread grief and a succession dispute in Uganda's Tooro Kingdom.

The journalist is a prince who had long been employed as a broadcaster and editor with Uganda Broadcasting Corp. He picked the regnal name of Edward Rukidi Nyabongo. He performed rituals overnight, was ushered into the palace and was formally unveiled to his followers on Tuesday.

Traditional kingdoms were banned in the 1960s, after Uganda's independence from British colonial rule, by a republican president who said that he wanted to unify the country. They were restored in 1993.

Traditional leaders don't wield any formal authority in this East African country and are legally barred from engaging in partisan politics. But they wield immense authority among their people as guardians of traditional culture.

The coronation ceremony in Fort Portal, a remote town in western Uganda not far from the Congo border, was watched by thousands in person and on televised broadcasts. Speaking at the event, Ugandan President Yoweri Museveni urged traditional leaders to promote local languages.

In a brief speech at his coronation, Mr. Nyabongo pledged to be a unifying figure for all his people. Before his enthronement, the monarch told the local New Vision newspaper that "heritage must be matched by discipline and hard work. My family never let me treat royal descent as an entitlement; it was presented to me as a duty to prepare for."

Mr. Nyabongo wasn't particularly high in the line of succession, but elders within the kingdom's ruling clan, known as the Babiito,



Journalist Edward Rukidi Nyabongo delivers a speech during his coronation as king of Uganda's traditional Tooro Kingdom, in Fort Portal, on Tuesday. HAJARAH NALWADDA/ASSOCIATED PRESS

selected him from a pool of eligible princes after King Oyo Nyimba's death from cancer at the age of 34 in August without a publicly known heir.

The queen mother, Best Kemigisa, disputed that decision and charged that the written will of King Oyo hadn't been followed in the selection of Mr. Nyabongo.

Queen Kemigisa said that Mr. Oyo left behind a young son whose identity would be unveiled at the right time, casting doubt on the legitimacy of Mr. Nyabongo and the decision of the Babiito to choose him. Local media cited scenes of disagreement - including a brief squabble over custody of the king's remains - at King Oyo's Sept. 12 funeral.

Although King Oyo's alleged son has yet to be revealed, purported photos of a "Baby Oyo" have flooded social media, giving hope to devotees of the deceased monarch. But critics say that the child, if he exists, should have been introduced to the kingdom's elders while his father was still alive.

"They have demonstrated that these are the norms of the kingdom," Nicholas Sengoba, a promi-

nent political analyst in Uganda, said of the Babiito's selection of Mr. Nyabongo. "Many of these positions may not be popular."

King Oyo was crowned in 1995, at the age of 3, after his father's death. He was a curious child in colourful robes and an object of adoration for his hundreds of thousands of followers.

At his coronation, he went through a series of tribal rituals and was led into the royal cemetery to perform a coming-of-age ceremony: successfully tossing nine coffee beans into his father's tomb.

King Oyo once held the unofficial title of the world's youngest king, a mesmerizing figure even for world leaders introduced to him at national events, including South Africa's Nelson Mandela. Libyan leader Moammar Gadhafi was one of those who befriended the Tooro royal family as if they were part of his extended family. Mr. Gadhafi made multiple trips to Uganda and supported King Oyo and Queen Kemigisa for years before Mr. Gadhafi's death in October, 2011.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Decades-old shaken baby conviction overturned in Ontario court

Jennifer Gaskin had two children taken from her after being convicted in the 1999 death of her infant son, on evidence that is now discredited

MOLLY HAYES

After decades of feeling like she was seen as a monster, Jennifer Gaskin broke into sobs Tuesday morning as her “shaken baby” conviction was overturned by the Ontario Court of Appeal.

To Ms. Gaskin’s right, in the Toronto courtroom, sat her mother, who she said has never doubted her innocence. To her left was her daughter, the baby’s sister, who was removed from Ms. Gaskin’s care after her arrest more than 25 years ago. The mother and daughter had only just reunited for the first time on the eve of Ms. Gaskin’s long-sought hearing.

“I feel wonderful. I feel lighter. I feel like years and years have been taken off my life right now,” Ms. Gaskin, 51, told reporters outside the Toronto courthouse Tuesday morning, after the court officially acknowledged her case as a wrongful conviction.

The Crown and defence had submitted jointly to the court that Ms. Gaskin’s 2002 manslaughter conviction – for the “shaken baby” death of her infant son Joeseeph, in July, 1999 – should be overturned, and an acquittal entered in its place.

They agreed the science behind shaken baby syndrome diagnoses – which were often applied in cases of infant death when there were internal, but no external, head injuries – simply does not hold up today.

“She should not have been convicted, and she has endured



‘I feel wonderful. I feel lighter. I feel like years and years have been taken off my life right now,’ Jennifer Gaskin told reporters outside the Toronto courthouse Tuesday, after the court officially acknowledged her case as a wrongful conviction. EDUARDO LIMA/GLOBE AND MAIL

tremendous hardship as a result,” Crown lawyer Elise Nakelsky told the panel of judges at Tuesday’s hearing.

Justices Sally Gomery, Peter Lauwers and Renee Pomerance agreed.

“This is another in the sad litany of cases of wrongful convictions based on the discredited ‘shaken baby syndrome’ as the cause of a child’s death brought about, in part, by unreliable expert evidence,” Justice Lauwers told the court, as he read out the panel’s decision Tuesday.

The term shaken baby syndrome was coined in the early 1970s and it became a go-to diagnosis for pathologists in cases where infants had a “triad” of internal symptoms that included brain swelling, retinal bleeding and tissue damage to the brain lining. But it came under scrutiny in the early 2000s, when some experts began to dispute the validity of the diagnosis.

In Ontario, an inquiry into errors by Charles Smith, a former forensic pathologist at Toronto’s Hospital for Sick Children, un-

covered more than a dozen child-death cases that were tainted by flawed analyses.

An expert committee was established in 2008 by the Ontario government to specifically probe shaken-baby deaths in the province dating back to the 1980s – including Ms. Gaskin’s son’s case.

Baby Joeseeph was 9½ weeks premature when he was born in April, 1999. He spent two months in hospital before he was finally able to go home to Ms. Gaskin in Ignace, Ont., in mid-June.

On July 2, just two days after Ms. Gaskin brought him to her local health clinic, concerned about vomiting and possible dehydration, Joeseeph suddenly stopped breathing.

Ms. Gaskin’s boyfriend, who had been changing the baby’s diaper at the time, sought help from a neighbour, and then called an ambulance, but the baby was pronounced dead soon after.

An autopsy was performed by a surgical pathologist at the Thunder Bay Hospital, and a second opinion was sought from a

neuropathologist at the Hospital for Sick Children in Toronto. Both concluded the baby died of head injuries from multiple instances of shaking, over a period of roughly two weeks – which Ms. Gaskin had vehemently denied.

But the Crown argued the finding successfully at her jury trial, and she was sentenced to two years less a day in prison.

Her surviving children – a daughter, just 13 months at the time that Joeseeph died, and a son who was born while Ms. Gaskin was on bail, awaiting trial – were taken from her, and adopted by families in Dryden, about an hour away. (Her surviving children’s names are covered by a publication ban.)

As part of the fresh evidence in her appeal, Ms. Gaskin’s legal team submitted the findings of the province’s review committee, along with new reports from a forensic neuropathologist, a biomechanical engineer and a forensic pathologist.

The reports concluded that while it would be difficult to rule out an inflicted injury, natural causes could also have been to blame for Joeseeph’s cardiorespiratory arrest – and that some of the injuries cited after his death were likely caused by the autopsy itself.

They also point out that more substantial testing would be done after a death like this today than was conducted (or even possible) at the time.

In Tuesday’s decision, the panel of judges noted this fresh evidence shows Ms. Gaskin’s conviction is “unsustainable.”

“As this court has stated in similar cases, it bears repeating that it is profoundly regrettable that, because of what has been shown to be flawed pathological evidence, Ms. Gaskin was wrongly convicted,” the decision reads.

“Although this was not one of

disgraced pathologist Dr. Charles Smith’s, this case took the same flawed approach to the applicable forensic science,” Justice Lauwers said, as he read the panel’s decision Tuesday.

Outside court Tuesday, Ms. Gaskin’s lawyer, veteran wrongful convictions lawyer and Innocence Canada co-founder James Lockyer, praised the judge’s decision, and said it was “an important day.”

“It may be the beginning of the end, if not the end, of shaken baby syndrome – at least in Ontario, potentially in Canada,” he said.

“To refer to it as a ‘discredited’ science was really a giant leap forward in the jurisprudence, and it will make it easier for any other cases that we may have coming up.”

He said Innocence Canada, a non-profit that advocates for wrongfully convicted individuals, is pursuing the overturning of “more than one” other case involving shaken baby syndrome.

Ms. Gaskin now lives in Eastern Ontario, where she works as a restaurant hostess. For years, she wrote in an affidavit to the court, she felt unable to breathe freely, keeping her story to herself, feeling people viewed her as a monster. But with the burden of her conviction lifted, she said she looks forward to going home and living her “best life.”

“I’m so appreciative of everything the court did today,” she said. “They took my life and they made it right.”

She is grateful, most of all, that the case has allowed her to reunite with her daughter – and she hopes, one day soon, her son.

“I hope that all of this will give me a chance to bond with my kids, and ... to just make everything else right,” she said. “And we will, bit by bit.”

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AI writer suspected in Canadian publications

Someone using name Daniel Robson has been pitching stories to variety of print and digital outlets

PAUL WALDIE LONDON
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The explosive e-mail landed in Ilker Sezer's inbox just after 9 p.m. on Sept. 2 with the subject line “Investigative feature submission. Canada-based criminal network with a Turkey trail.”

The story sounded like a huge scoop for Mr. Sezer and his staff of 30 journalists at Türkiye Today, an English-language news website based in Istanbul.

The e-mail was from Daniel Robson, who said he was an independent Canadian journalist specializing in “extremism, terrorism, foreign interference, and transnational cyber-enabled crime.” He listed several articles he'd written for a variety of Canadian news outlets.

“It was very exciting,” Mr. Sezer said in an interview Tuesday. “A Moroccan-Canadian drug lord is running money through Turkey. Wow.”

In follow-up e-mails, Mr. Robson “had this sense of urgency to publish the article,” Mr. Sezer added.

But the editor wanted to do some reporting on the alleged Turkish middleman in the story. He quickly discovered he was a shopkeeper in Istanbul. He needed more proof of the allegations.

“I'm like, ‘Look, I cannot hurt a Turkish citizen. It can put me in legal trouble, also journalistically, it's just wrong,’” Mr. Sezer told Mr. Robson.

When he asked Mr. Robson for documents to back up the story,

he couldn't come up with much. He also begged off a video or phone call with the editor, claiming he was suffering from complications from dental work.

Mr. Sezer noticed that the e-mails and the article had telltale signs of being AI-generated – “these long, very ChatGPT-ish phrases.” Earlier this year he'd refused to publish several articles that had clearly been written by AI.

He started reaching out to the Canadian news outlets that had published Mr. Robson's work. He read some of the pieces and found the same hallmarks of AI.

In an article published Tuesday in Türkiye Today, Mr. Sezer said he also noticed that Mr. Robson's “international focus revealed a coordinated agenda: fiercely defending the Moroccan state while orchestrating targeted information campaigns against its critics.”

He went on to describe how “Canadian newsrooms scrambled to address the breach.”

The Ottawa Citizen, he wrote, promptly deleted Mr. Robson's biography page and removed his articles without publishing an editorial note. In a statement published Tuesday evening, editor-in-chief Nicole Feriancek acknowledged that the newspaper had “published an author in the opinion section who, upon further investigation, does not seem to be a real person.”

She said the Citizen began an investigation after being alerted by Mr. Sezer, adding that Mr. Robson would not agree to a phone call or meeting “because of recent emergency dental surgery.”

The Montreal Gazette and four digital publications – the Western Standard, The Hub, Open Canada and Policy Options – also published articles by Daniel Robson.

The earliest was published in

July, 2025, by the Gazette, according to a review conducted by The Globe and Mail that identified more than two dozen articles. The latest appeared in the Western Standard in September, 2026.

That digital outlet, based in Alberta, published roughly 20 articles by Mr. Robson over an 18-month period, according to publisher Derek Fildebrandt and opinion editor Christopher Oldcorn.

It has since removed those articles and published a notice noting that Mr. Robson was “unable to verify his identity.”

The outlet became aware of the questions surrounding Mr. Robson after being contacted by other concerned publications, Mr. Fildebrandt said.

He said the Western Standard had previously rejected several of Mr. Robson's pitches. “I'm informed that a significant number of what he had submitted was what I would classify as propagandizing for foreign governments,” he said.

Mr. Oldcorn said he had communicated repeatedly with Mr. Robson during the past year, including over the phone. The last time they spoke was in late July or early August, he said, when Mr. Robson explained that he would be unavailable for a few weeks because of upcoming dental surgeries.

“The person I spoke to on the phone ... The accent was clearly what you would expect in Ontario,” Mr. Oldcorn said. “There was nothing in his voice that would make me think he was Moroccan in any way, shape or form.”

Mr. Robson also published articles in The Hub, a digital publication focused on policy and economics. The Globe identified six articles published between August, 2025, and March, 2026, all of which have since been removed

from the website.

Three Robson articles published by Open Canada, a policy magazine published by the Canadian International Council, were removed Tuesday after a request for comment from The Globe. An unsigned e-mail from Open Canada said the articles were removed because the publication was unable to verify the author's identity.

The editor-in-chief of the digital magazine Policy Options, Les Perreux, worked with Mr. Sezer to try to identify the writer.

When he couldn't find Mr. Robson or verify his work, Mr. Perreux wrote a lengthy note on the publication's website last week acknowledging that editors should have been more thorough and that Mr. Robson's article had been removed from the website.

“My main takeaway in all this is that we have to be really careful,” he told The Globe. “In this case, I relied on a publication history, combined with a very productive and cordial communication on the edit – albeit via e-mail – to put our trust in this guy.”

Someone with the same name who described himself as a journalist specializing in “extremism, national security, and digital threats” pitched two stories to The Globe in the summer of 2025. The Globe declined to publish the pieces. Attempts to contact Mr. Robson on Tuesday were not successful.

Mr. Sezer suspects that Moroccan intelligence could have been behind the Robson story pitched to him. The central figure in the alleged drug ring was Hicham Jerando, a Moroccan-Canadian businessman who has been actively criticizing Moroccan officials and institutions online.

Mr. Jerando was not available for comment, but he told Mr. Sezer that Moroccan intelligence regularly targets him because of his

opposition to the “corrupt elite” in the country.

Several of the Robson articles published in Canada also praised Morocco's King Mohammed VI and urged Canada to form a security partnership with the African country.

The Globe identified a link between Morocco and Mr. Robson. According to a digital research tool, Mr. Robson's e-mail address was used to register a Moroccan Microsoft account in March, 2026. That account was last active in early September, records show.

“So my understanding is that this is probably a Moroccan person building a persona under an Anglo-Saxon name and using AI to produce articles,” Mr. Sezer said.

Morocco is among a handful of countries that signed the Abraham Accords in 2020, an initiative spearheaded by U.S. President Donald Trump to bring some Arab nations closer to Israel. Morocco and Israel have full diplomatic ties and have increased their trade and transportation links. However, those ties have generated fierce opposition in Morocco and much of the Arab world, especially in the wake of Israel's war in Gaza.

Mr. Sezer's contacts with Canadian media and his questioning of the author somehow got back to Mr. Robson. “He sent me this very, very agitated, very threatening e-mail saying that there will be repercussions because I am putting his life in danger,” Mr. Sezer said.

“I was like, ‘Look, if you want to be a real deal, declare yourself, send everyone your CV, make a video call. I'm going to pull this story. I'm not going to publish anything.”

He hasn't heard from him since.

Initiative aims to close the gap in training for Indigenous teachers

DAVE MCGINN
EDUCATION REPORTER

Growing up in Burns Lake, a small community in B.C., Dustin Louie never had an Indigenous teacher.

This experience is familiar to many Indigenous youth, and it has detrimental effects, he said.

Indigenous students are more likely to do better at school when they have Indigenous teachers, and not having those teachers influences students' ideas about the careers they might pursue, said Prof. Louie, now 45 and director of the Indigenous Teacher Education Program at the University of British Columbia.

“That sets the expectation for those students about what's possible for them,” he said. Not having Indigenous teachers could discourage them from pursuing education as a career themselves, perpetuating the pattern.

Last September, the UBC program launched a field centre in Prince Rupert to deliver the university's full bachelor of education program to more than 40 Indigenous students from the area, funded by a grant of nearly \$1-million from the Rideau Hall Foundation.

“Within four years of getting those funds, there are going to be at least 25 new teachers in this school district that is 63 per cent Indigenous,” he said. “You cannot overemphasize the implications of this region having 25 new Indigenous teachers.”

When the Truth and Reconciliation Commission of Canada issued its 94 calls to action in 2015, among them was a directive to the federal government to work with Indigenous groups to “develop a joint strategy to eliminate educational and employment gaps between Aboriginal and non-Aboriginal Canadians.”

One program that takes aim at both gaps is the Indigenous Teacher Education Initiative, launched by the Rideau Hall



Dustin Louie of the Indigenous Teacher Education Program at UBC says not having Indigenous role models affects what ideas pupils may have for potential careers. FELICIA CHANG/THE GLOBE AND MAIL

Foundation, a non-partisan national charitable organization, in 2022.

The initiative has two overarching goals, said Annette Trimbee, co-chair of the foundation's national advisory committee on Indigenous teacher education.

The first is to understand how teachers move through the educational system, what inspires them to become teachers and what barriers they face.

“We're trying to understand all the things that might be behind the underrepresentation of Indigenous teachers,” she said.

The second goal is to support the recruitment and retention of 10,000 First Nations, Inuit and Métis teachers across Canada.

The initiative has supported 22 projects to date, including several research projects, Dr. Trimbee said.

“I really see it as a bit of a catalyst and accelerator because there are phenomenal things happening all across the

country,” she said.

“Education opens doors, and Indigenous students do better when they have the opportunity to learn from Indigenous teachers who they can share culture, history, language with. It creates a sense of pride.”

The foundation has estimated there are 6,000 to 8,000 Indigenous teachers in Canada, added Dr. Trimbee, who is also president of MacEwan University in Edmonton.

Increasing the number of Indigenous teachers is key to improving high-school graduation rates for Indigenous students, said Evelyn Steinhauer, associate dean of Indigenous teacher education at the University of Alberta and a member of the Rideau Hall Foundation's advisory committee.

“Graduation rates don't really go up when you keep sending our children to schools where people don't understand us,” she said.

The high-school graduation rate for First Nations youth is 63 per cent, compared with 91 per cent of the non-Indigenous population, according to the 2016 census, the most recent data available.

For those living off reserve, the graduation rate is 73 per cent, while for those living on reserve it is just 46 per cent.

Last year, the teacher education program that Prof. Steinhauer helps oversee received a nearly \$1-million grant from the Rideau Hall Foundation. She said it has been pivotal in helping build relationships with Indigenous communities.

The grant will support up to 90 students annually between 2025 and 2029 to bring traditional practices and perspectives to field experiences, while also connecting them with mentor teachers, among other things.

Training Indigenous teachers who will then take up positions in their communities is vital to

the success of students who live there, Prof. Steinhauer said.

“We have to have somebody who's from the community that understands,” she said. “If you don't have the lived experience, how can you really relate to what the children are saying?”

Often, teachers working in remote Indigenous communities come from other parts of Canada, and frequently stay only for a couple of years, Prof. Louie said.

That can have a very negative affect on students in those communities, he said.

“Students kind of see the teacher as being transient, and there's only so much that you open up, create trust, want to connect with somebody if the expectation is they're just going to leave,” he said.

Prof. Louie said this shows the value of the field centre model: “We want to educate people from those communities because we know they'll stay there.”

Having more Indigenous teachers across the country is good for all students, not just Indigenous ones, especially considering how much Indigenous material is included in curriculums, said Nicole Bell, an associate professor of education at Trent University whose research focuses on Indigenous culture-based education.

“The way we teach our Indigenous teachers how to teach in culturally appropriate ways is found to be extremely beneficial by all students,” she said. “It's just good pedagogy for everyone.”

Indigenous teachers can help all students better understand themselves and the world, Prof. Louie said.

“We think of the massive benefit for the settler students – not just having enough certified teachers to be able to fill the schools, but the new types of learning that they're going to be exposed to that's going to fundamentally change their view of the world as well.”

U.S. SUPREME COURT ALLOWS TRUMP TO RESUME DEPORTING MIGRANTS TO THIRD COUNTRIES

The U.S. Supreme Court on Tuesday let U.S. President Donald Trump's administration resume deporting migrants to countries other than their own without offering them the chance to show the harms they may face, bolstering a tool his administration has used for rapid expulsions as part of his immigration crackdown.

The court granted the Justice

Department's emergency request to put on hold Boston-based U.S. District Judge Brian Murphy's ruling that the Department of Homeland Security's policy to remove migrants to so-called third countries is unlawful. The court also agreed to hear arguments in the dispute in December, with a formal ruling on the policy to follow.

The court has a 6-3 conserva-

tive majority. Its three liberal justices dissented from the decision to let the deportations immediately resume pending the final outcome of the litigation.

Judge Murphy's ruling came in a class-action lawsuit filed by immigrant rights groups on behalf of migrants seeking to prevent the U.S. government from sending them to third

countries without notice and a chance to assert the harms they could face.

More than 25,000 migrants have been deported to 29 countries under the policy implemented last year, according to a tally by human rights groups, with the vast majority going to Mexico.

The policy is one of a number of measures the adminis-

tration has taken in its pursuit of Mr. Trump's goal of mass deportation. The Republican President has enforced a sweeping crackdown on immigration – among his top priorities – since returning to office last year.

Department of Homeland Security General Counsel James Percival welcomed the court's decision. REUTERS

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Wednesday > October 14
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7994 Yonge St.

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Thursday > October 15
Royal Niagara Golf Club
1 Niagara-on-the-Green Blvd.

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Thursday > October 15
Stratford Country Club
53 Romeo St. N

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Tuesday > October 20
Markland Wood Golf Club
245 Markland Dr.

OTTAWA

Tuesday > October 20
Hilton Garden Inn Ottawa Airport
2400 Alert Rd.

GUELPH

Wednesday > October 21
Cutten Fields
190 College Ave. E

KANATA

Thursday > October 22
Irish Hills Golf & Country Club
3248 Carp Rd.

LONDON

Tuesday > October 27
Best Western Plus Lamplighter
Inn & Conference Centre
591 Wellington Rd.

PETERBOROUGH

Tuesday > October 27
Holiday Inn
Peterborough-Waterfront
150 George St. N

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Wednesday > October 28
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Thursday > October 29
Dalewood Golf Club
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10 Vacation Inn Dr.

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Thursday > November 5
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Referendum or not, the return of the PQ will break Carney’s federal-provincial consensus

CAMPBELL CLARK
OPINION

Mark Carney has managed to fashion a surprisingly workable peace with provincial premiers. But it's hard to imagine that peace will reign across the land after next week's Quebec election.

The Parti Québécois is about to take power again, for the first time in more than a dozen years, and it's not just the possibility of an eventual referendum on Quebec sovereignty a few years down the road that will change things.

Whether PQ Leader Paul St-Pierre Plamondon, widely known as PSPP, will command a majority government is not yet clear – it's hard to predict precisely how the PQ's lead in a five-party contest will translate into seats in the National Assembly. With a minority government, Mr. St-Pierre Plamondon might not be able to trigger a referendum. But barring a dramatic, last-minute reversal of fortune, he will win the election.

And referendum or not, the PQ in power won't have the same incentives as most provincial governments.

That will have an impact on the Prime Minister's priorities, including a relatively unified approach to U.S. trade talks, reducing internal trade barriers, and building major resource and infrastructure projects.

After U.S. President Donald Trump announced a new set of ramped-up tariffs after Canada-U.S. talks in August, PSPP criticized Ottawa's countertariffs as measures that are harmful to Quebec business, imposed by a government insensitive to the practical interests of Quebecers.

The PQ Leader has opposed the Alto high-speed rail project from Quebec City to Toronto that Mr. Carney's government has backed. He initially expressed skepticism about the massive, tripartite agreement between Ottawa, Hydro-Québec, and Newfoundland and Labrador Hydro to develop the Churchill Falls hydroelectric station, even though Ottawa was offering to put \$10-billion into an expansion plan. PSPP's first instinct on federal-provincial co-operation is to be against.

There have been premiers in Mr. Carney's time who haven't always sung the Team Canada tune. Alberta Premier Danielle Smith



Parti Québécois Leader Paul St-Pierre Plamondon is greeted by his family at a leaders debate in Montreal last week. Quebec will vote in a provincial election on Oct. 5. GRAHAM HUGHES/THE CANADIAN PRESS

and Saskatchewan Premier Scott Moe pointedly issued pre-emptive warnings about using their provinces' resources – oil and potash, respectively – as leverage in a trade war with the U.S. But Mr. Carney managed to fashion surprising federal-provincial harmony.

When he took power, no one expected the Prime Minister would sign a memorandum of understanding with Ms. Smith on a new West Coast oil pipeline and the regulation of emissions. Or that Ms. Smith would ever say the Liberal Prime Minister “gets it.”

Polls show that as much as Quebec voters want a change in government, they are still worried about the Canada-U.S. trade war and they don't want a referendum.

Quebec Premier Christine Fréchette, the one-time PQ staffer now leading the Coalition Avenir Québec, has not only struck deals with Mr. Carney, she has stood on stage beside him and his ministers to laud co-operative federalism.

That love-in has been driven by political strategy, as Ms. Fréchette sought to revive her party's fortunes and fight the PQ by arguing she could work with Mr. Carney to respond to Mr. Trump's trade war.

That hasn't trumped the desire for change. And Mr. St-Pierre Plamondon's political strategy doesn't revolve around making

federalism seem co-operative.

He will face some constraints. PSPP isn't very popular, and he isn't a consensus choice. Opinion polls suggest the PQ could win with a historically low popular vote of around 30 per cent.

Polls also show that as much as Quebec voters want a change in government, they are still worried about the Canada-U.S. trade war and they don't want a referendum. No wonder the PQ Leader promised to put off a referendum until Mr. Trump leaves the White House, so sometime after January, 2029.

And it's worth noting that Mr. St-Pierre Plamondon is ideologically aligned with some of Mr. Carney's priorities. The PQ Leader has spoken favourably about knocking down interprovincial barriers to trade, albeit with caveats about protecting Quebec's language and culture and interests. Let's wait and see how gung-ho he is to join Mr. Carney's promise to build One Canadian Economy.

PSPP's bigger project is advancing the cause of Quebec independence. That's not a popular cause right now, but he hasn't shied away from a commitment to advance it. He has said, for example, that he will replace Quebec's intergovernmental relations minister with a minister for the independence process.

That's the process that will unfold over the next three years, according to the PQ Leader's timeline. It requires convincing large numbers of Quebecers to leave Canada in a relatively short period. That doesn't leave a lot of time for working harmoniously with Ottawa.

Teen pleads guilty in hockey hazing assault

Fifteen-year-old admitted to sexual assault with a weapon at a team sleepover; a second boy heads to trial in February

LINDSAY JONES

A teenaged boy pleaded guilty to sexual assault with a weapon in a Nova Scotia youth court Tuesday after a violent hockey hazing incident last fall.

A second boy, who is facing four charges related to the assault and who has pleaded not guilty, is scheduled to go to trial next February.

In the Truro courtroom, the first teen, now aged 15, stood with his hands on the front of his slacks, rocking slightly as Judge Brian Warcop read out the charge. The boy's father sat next to him in the front row, his head down, his elbows on his knees. Dozens of supporters of the three victims listened intently on the opposite side of the courtroom as the details of the violent sexual assault at a team sleepover party were read aloud from the agreed statement of facts.

The identities of the victims and accused cannot be named under the Youth Criminal Justice Act.

News of the assault struck a chord nationwide as hockey, and the sports bodies that regulate them, has faced a reckoning in recent years for a culture of silence and toxic masculinity. Hockey Canada, which governs amateur hockey in the country, opened an investigation into the Nova Scotia incident, but the sports body said it is confidential.

The court heard that on the evening of Oct. 3, 2025, the under-15 boys hockey team gathered at a teammate's house for a team party and sleepover at or around Colchester County. The gathering had been organized so the more senior players could get to know the rookies.

The players' parents gathered downstairs, while the boys socialized upstairs in two rooms. In one room, a 13-year-old rookie player was laying down on his stomach on a bed, scrolling on his phone, when two older players, who were 14 at the time, pinned him down, pulled down his pants and underwear and exposed his buttocks. The boy who has pleaded not guilty allegedly pushed a mini hockey stick between the younger boy's buttocks. The rookie shouted for them to stop and started crying, later telling authorities that the assault lasted 15 to 20 seconds, but it “felt like forever.”

The court heard that he always planned to tell his parents but didn't know how to raise the subject and he didn't want to get anyone in trouble.

After the assault, the two older boys went after two other rookies and removed their pants, but were unsuccessful in taking off their underwear. The younger boys kicked themselves free of their attackers.

The victim's father eventually heard about the incident, went to the RCMP on Jan. 30 and filed a complaint, according to the statement of facts.

In court, it was agreed that a psychological and psychiatric study on the boy who pleaded guilty would be presented to the court prior to sentencing, which is expected to take place in the new year. The defence and the Crown attorney told the court they would be recommending a joint sentencing submission for the boy's case.

The sentence for sexual assault with a weapon for a youth can range from an absolute discharge to a period of secure custody and community supervision, senior Crown attorney Patrick Young said after the hearing.

Mr. Young told reporters he couldn't disclose the discussions that took place ahead of the guilty plea, but he said that the agreement, sentence and statement of facts can all be negotiated by counsel. “Because they're privileged it would be inappropriate for me to comment on that.”

The teen is also facing two other charges of sexual assault. Those charges will carry over to sentencing and be disposed of at that time, Mr. Young said.

His guilty plea also impacts the case against the second teen because he now potentially becomes a compellable witness for the Crown, Mr. Young said. The trial of the second teen is scheduled to begin Feb. 22. That boy, who is also now 15, has pleaded not guilty to charges of sexual assault with a weapon, two counts of sexual assault and one count of assault.

Hockey Canada has been embroiled in controversy over its handling of sexual assault allegations made against five members of the 2018 national junior team (they were found not guilty in a criminal court last year), and for quietly using registration fees from players across the country to settle such cases.

In response to that scandal, Hockey Canada launched an independent third party (ITP) process in 2022 for confidentially handling hockey-related maltreatment complaints and to ensure possible Criminal Code offences are reported to law enforcement and child protection services.

Hockey Nova Scotia, a branch of Hockey Canada and the organization that governs the sport in the province, initially suspended and later disbanded the team involved in last year's hazing incident. The Globe and Mail is not naming the team to protect the identities of the victims and accused.

The incidents of sexual violence involving the team were reported to Hockey Canada's ITP and an investigation was launched earlier this year, Hockey Canada chief of staff Jeremy Knight said, adding he couldn't comment on the status or outcome of the process, which is confidential.

The ITP has the power to make their decision public. They did not immediately respond to The Globe's query about what they plan to do.

CSIS MAY HAVE MISUSED SPECIAL POWERS, SAYS SPY WATCHDOG

The Canadian Security Intelligence Service may not have complied with the law when using special powers to gather information, the national spy watchdog has found.

The CSIS Act allows designated employees to commit certain offences when collecting information, a measure meant to keep CSIS operations from breaking the law. But it sets limits: the authority does not permit CSIS to willfully obstruct justice, infringe a Charter right, or detain, torture or kill a person. Employees must also be specifically designated to commit offences, obtain a senior official's authorization before directing someone else to do so, and document why their actions are reasonable and proportional.

Examining CSIS's use of the authority in 2022 and 2023, the National Security and Intelligence Review Agency found the service complied with the restrictions on permissible offences. But some employees may have committed offences without the required designation, and direction may have been given without the authorization the law requires. CSIS also sometimes failed to adequately document its justification for offences.

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Law: Judge found ruling had a fundamental contradiction in Canada’s drug laws

■ FROM A1

Prosecutors are reviewing the judgment and assessing “any potential next steps,” the agency’s spokeswoman Alessia Bongiovanni said.

People in the courtroom gallery cried as the judge read her findings and addressed Mr. Kalicum and Ms. Nyx directly.

“I applaud you for what you’ve done,” Justice Murray said. “I think you should be very proud of yourselves, and it’s people like you who make a difference. And you just did.”

For more than a year, the compassion club founders Mr. Kalicum and Ms. Nyx operated as the Drug User Liberation Front (DULF), buying illicit heroin, cocaine and methamphetamine from the dark web and testing the products at university labs for fentanyl and other impurities. They then sold the drugs at cost to their group’s 43 members.

At the heart of the ruling is what Justice Murray found to be a fundamental contradiction in Canada’s drug laws: A prohibition intended to protect public health and safety can also criminalize actions that can reduce the risk of overdose. But a critic of B.C.’s approach to drug use said the decision fails to account for broader societal harms and called the judge’s praise of the pair “insulting” to police combating the criminal organizations behind the illicit drug trade.

During a multiweek trial and constitutional challenge that unfolded over nine months, the court heard that Mr. Kalicum and Ms. Nyx regularly engaged with top health, government and police officials as they pursued legal pathways to operate the club.

Vancouver Coastal Health officials provided letters of support as they applied to Health Canada for an exemption from drug laws required to operate. Mr. Kalicum regularly e-mailed top police brass with updates.

The court also got a window



A B.C. Supreme Court judge tossed the drug trafficking convictions of Drug User Liberation Front co-founder Jeremy Kalicum, pictured last year, and his co-founder Eris Nyx. JIMMY JEONG/THE GLOBE AND MAIL

into the pair’s motivations; the two have responded to more than 100 overdoses and described panic and distress from having watched friends and co-workers die from drugs.

Health Canada denied their application in April, 2022, saying that acquiring drugs from the dark web was “not a viable option.” Jennifer Saxe, director-general of the controlled substances directorate, said the department “is committed to supporting efforts to expand access to a safer supply” nonetheless, and conveyed appreciation for the pair’s “willingness to think and act creatively in search of new solutions.”

Despite the denial, DULF began openly operating the compassion club in August, 2022, out of a Vancouver storefront provided by B.C.’s Ministry of Health. The local health authority provided DULF with up to \$200,000 in annual funding for drug-checking and overdose preven-

tion services.

The tides turned in September, 2023, when a magazine article on the pair ignited what Justice Murray called “a maelstrom of activity.” Members of the political opposition rebuked the B.C. NDP for supporting the illegal activity, successfully putting pressure on officials to end funding and the site lease.

People in the courtroom gallery cried as the judge read her findings and addressed Mr. Kalicum and Ms. Nyx directly.

In October, 2023, Vancouver Police raided the site and arrested Mr. Kalicum and Ms. Nyx. They were each charged with three counts of possession for the purposes of trafficking and found guilty in November, 2025.

Lawyers Stephanie and Tim Dickson, the married co-counsel for DULF, called 14 witnesses, including five experts, who testified to the causes of the toxic drug crisis, the inadequacy of the current response, the efficacy and limitations of existing prescribed alternatives programs, and the urgent need for expanded access.

In her ruling, Justice Murray said there are “no legally and practically available safety valves in the CDSA to support the implementation of a non-medicalized safer supply program,” which she said is “urgently needed to save lives.” She also found that the compassion club “reduced the harms associated with the toxic drug crisis and did not negatively impact the community or public safety.”

Mr. Dickson called the judgment a vindication.

“This case is about the federal and provincial governments’ refusal to implement that life-sav-

ing measure, and it is also about how the federal legislation effectively blocks any effort to implement that measure,” he said outside the courthouse.

CentreBC Leader Elenore Sturko, who as the former BC United addiction critic in 2023 called for an investigation into the public funding of DULF, called the ruling worrisome. She argued that Justice Murray gave insufficient weight to the broader harms of the program, including its funding of criminal organizations through dark-web drug purchases.

Ms. Sturko, a former RCMP officer, supports providing pharmaceutical alternatives to illicit drugs through medically supervised programs, but rejects models that make them available outside of a health care setting.

She said governments should focus on recovery-oriented systems of care and urged Ottawa to appeal the decision.

“British Columbians have resoundingly said that they do not think that the answer to our drug crisis is more drugs,” she said.

John Conroy is a Vancouver-area lawyer who was involved in successful challenges at the Supreme Court against parts of the federal drug law, first in 2011 in the Insite case over supervised drug injection and then in 2015 in the Smith case over medical marijuana. The top court, in both cases, ruled parts of the drug legislation violated Section 7 of the Charter, similar to Tuesday’s ruling.

“This is very good news,” Mr. Conroy said of the latest judgment. “It is going to be interesting to see what the government does to rectify the unconstitutionality.”

In the Insite case, the Supreme Court ordered Ottawa to allow the facility to keep operating. In the medical marijuana case, the court said the government had to provide reasonable access for patients for possession and use of cannabis through a health care practitioner.

Havana: Former spies and retired security officials call for parliamentary examination

■ FROM A1

Former Canadian spies and retired senior security officials have called for an independent parliamentary examination on whether Russia targeted the diplomats for allegedly helping U.S. intelligence agencies, and how Ottawa subsequently treated the diplomats.

On Saturday, The Globe revealed that Ottawa triggered a rare national-security provision last year to keep secret new details of a multimillion-dollar lawsuit brought by 10 Canadian diplomats who were stationed in Havana when the symptoms were reported.

The Justice Department confirmed last Friday it invoked Section 38 of the Canada Evidence Act in the diplomats’ lawsuit. The rarely used law restricts disclosure of matters that could harm national security, national defence or international relations.

On Monday, Foreign Affairs Minister Anita Anand said the diplomats’ unexplained health ailments were a human-resources concern for her department. She sidestepped calls for a parliamentary inquiry into whether they were harmed by alleged sonic attacks linked to Russia.

Ms. Anand told reporters Monday she has asked her top deputy to follow up on the case. But her office later confirmed the minister is not ordering the department to reopen a 2024 interdepartmental report that concluded the diplomats’ health concerns were not the result of “any malicious act of a foreign actor.”

Paul Miller, counsel for Canadian diplomats and their families, criticized Ms. Anand’s dismissal of the episode as a human-resources problem.

“We are extremely disappointed in the minister’s response to the story in The Globe & Mail. The diplomats and their family members who have suffered all these years deserve better,” he said. “We need to understand what caused these ailments. Not only will this help determine accountability, but understanding the cause may help doctors better treat those who continue to suffer.”

Scientists have offered conflicting explanations for what could have caused the set of symptoms that became known as Havana Syndrome.

Researchers at the University of Pennsylvania examined 21 of the American diplomats and concluded that their injuries were similar to a concussion. Other theories were put forward about pre-existing medical issues, psychosomatic conditions and environmental factors.

CNN reported in January that the Pentagon has spent more than a year testing a device that some investigators think could be the cause of Havana Syndrome-type ailments. It said defence officials considered their findings serious enough that they briefed the House and Senate intelligence committees late last year.

Defence Minister David McGuinty, to whom the chief of the Communications Security Establishment reports, refused Tuesday to discuss satellite technology equipment sharing between Canada and the U.S. at embassies.

The CSE is Canada’s electronic eavesdropping agency.

“There are some things I can’t talk about. Some things remain confidential. Some things remain secret,” he said during a tour of a defence exhibition in Ottawa.

Some security experts have recommended the National Security

and Intelligence Committee of Parliamentarians review the matter.

NSICOP is composed of MPs and senators who have top-secret security clearance to receive classified information. The committee reports directly to the Prime Minister.

Mr. McGuinty said The Globe’s

story about Canadian diplomats “is raising important questions” but added it’s not for him to call on NSICOP to initiate a review.

The NSICOP Secretariat said in an e-mailed statement to The Globe that the committee “has no comment on the matters you have raised.” It said it would not discuss the Cuba matter.

“The Committee speaks only to and through its reports, and posts statements if and when it initiates a review. Once a review is completed and the Prime Minister tables the Committee’s report in both Houses of Parliament, the Committee also posts the revised version of the report on its website,” the secretariat said.

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Why the safer-supply program persists despite opposition

Prescribed to steer people away from fentanyl, hydromorphone pills are instead flooding Ontario's streets

MARCUS GEE HAMILTON
PHOTOGRAPHY BY SAMMY KOGAN

One hot morning this summer, a group of weary-looking men and women gathered outside the door of a Hamilton pharmacy, waiting for opening time. Just before 9, they started filing through the door to collect the medicines they take for their various addictions. The meds are designed to help them fend off the agony of withdrawal and perhaps even get on the road to recovery.

But within minutes of emerging, one of them, a bearded man in a baseball cap, was emptying his bottle of pills into the palm of another guy, who in return gave him a small handful of a yellowish powder: fentanyl, the potent opioid that causes most drug overdoses.

Transactions like this are commonplace on the streets of Hamilton, so routine that those involved hardly bother to conceal them. This one took place just around the corner from the pharmacy on James Street South, a busy avenue in the heart of the city. The two men exchanged their drugs right in front of me, after I explained who I was and what I was writing about.

The pills were a potent painkiller called hydromorphone. Sold under the commercial name Dilaudid, they are normally used to treat severe pain from cancer, bone fractures or burns.

About a decade ago, some doctors began prescribing them to people with addictions. They reasoned that, with fentanyl flooding the streets, it was safer for patients to satisfy their need with a regulated, prescription medication than a dangerous, illegal drug. Health authorities sanctioned the practice, which became known as safe supply or safer supply.

Before long, though, evidence started to mount that many patients were selling or exchanging the pills, which became popular street drugs in their own right.

In 2021, Hamilton police seized a total of just eight hydromorphone pills. Last year, they seized 1,639. The price has dropped as the supply has increased, and now a pill costs less than a can of beer.

Authorities eventually woke up to the problem – known as drug “diversion” – and governments began imposing more controls. But in Ontario at least, safer supply continued to thrive.

A group of 36 alarmed physicians wrote to the Ontario government in July demanding action. One of them, Lori Regenstreif, 63, used to work at a clinic just a few steps away from the James Street pharmacy where the pills-for-powder trade happened. She told me her “blood boils” over what the mass dispensing of safer-supply drugs is doing to her patients.

Because hydromorphone pills are so easy to get, some of them are falling back into using street drugs after years of stability on the standard addiction medicines she prescribes.

“You are turning people into criminals instead of patients,” she says. “They’re trying to move forward, and you’re pulling them back in.”

With doctors like her raising a fuss and the media asking more and more questions, regulators began moving this week to further tighten the rules on safer supply. But not before the program caused what she calls “horrible” damage in cities like Hamilton.

Dr. Regenstreif took me on a tour of its downtown, pointing out the addiction pharmacies that dot the city and the struggling people who congregate outside them. Over the next few weeks, I spoke with doctors, pharmacists, addiction experts, police, community leaders and drug users on the streets.

What emerged was a picture of a well-intentioned policy gone wildly off course. Though federally funded clinics supplying safer-supply drugs closed down, and the provincial government banned new ones, individual doctors kept prescribing large quantities of hydromorphone pills.

A network of pharmacies and clinics sprang up to distribute them. Taking advantage of a billing system that rewards them for the heavy traffic they get from addiction medicine, they collect fees from the health system and send their customers out the door with bottles of highly addictive medicines, which then make their way into the street-drug market.

The spread of the pills echoes the origins of the opioid crisis, which began with the mass prescribing of addictive pain pills. Ontario neighbourhoods from North Bay to downtown Toronto are coping with the side effects, which include open drug use



and dealing. Dr. Regenstreif says she is seeing more and more young people turning to the pills, some of them in their early teens. Indigenous communities are seeing more of them, too.

Safer supply sprang from the best of motives. When drug overdoses started soaring a decade ago, advocates argued that we should treat the opioid crisis as a health, not a crime, problem.

To reduce the spread of diseases such as AIDS and hepatitis C, they handed out clean needles. To reduce the toll of overdoses, they offered people supervised places to take their drugs, with trained staff on hand to revive them in case they collapsed.

Harm reduction was the goal and safer supply was the next step. At the program's peak, 5,000 people were approved for the drugs in British Columbia, ground zero of the opioid crisis. B.C. even introduced vending machines where selected users could get their pills.

From the start of Canada's safer supply experiment, though, many patients were selling the pills to give themselves some pocket money or to buy more powerful drugs. In London, Ont., police said the number of prescription hydromorphone pills they were discovering in drug busts had soared from 1,000 in 2019 to 30,000 in 2023.

In Prince George, B.C., police seized 10,000 prescription pills in a single raid in 2024. They said safer-supply drugs were being trafficked by organized criminals and deployed by drug users “as a form of currency to purchase more potent, illicit street drugs.”

A series of articles in the National Post shone a spotlight on the issue. The pharmacies dispensing the pills began coming under scrutiny. A Globe and Mail investigation in 2024 found that some B.C. pharmacies were paying prohibited cash incentives to patients so that they would go to those pharmacies to get their prescriptions filled.

A leaked B.C. Ministry of Health document last year confirmed the practice, saying that more than

In 2021, Hamilton police seized a total of just eight hydromorphone pills. Last year, they seized 1,639. The price has dropped as the supply has increased, and a pill now costs less than a can of beer.

60 pharmacies were being investigated for offering kickbacks. It also said that a “significant portion” of prescription opioids are sold – trafficked provincially, nationally and internationally.

As a result, since the end of 2025 British Columbia has been prohibiting most safer supply patients from taking their addiction medications out of the pharmacy, insisting they take the meds on site, under observation – a system known as “witnessed dosing.” Meanwhile, the federal government quietly halted its funding for safer-supply programs last year. In 2024 the Ontario government brought in a law, the Safer Streets, Stronger Communities Act, that bars new safer supply programs.

But Canadian doctors have wide latitude to prescribe drugs as they see fit, if they believe their patients will benefit from them. Many have continued to approve daily doses of hydromorphone pills to patients with serious addictions.

“There is no way anyone can tell me this is harm reduction,” Dr. Regenstreif said. “It is harm promotion.”

The daughter of a Winnipeg city planner, she studied genetics and molecular biology at university, then went into medicine. She moved to Hamilton in 2004, started treating the homeless and the mentally ill and gravitated to addiction treatment.

She has seen wave upon deadly wave of the drug crisis roll over Hamilton since, but nothing has left her as discouraged as the chaos wrought by safer supply. In the last few years, she says, the clinics and pharmacies offering the program have spread “like wildfire.”

The facilities can be found everywhere from Niagara Falls to the Toronto suburb of Pickering to Elliot Lake in Northern Ontario.

True North Medical has more than 100 addiction-medicine clinics, from Red Lake in the northwest of the province to Kingston in the southeast. Arrow Medical, established in 2023, offers “urgent, compassionate, evidence-based care for people living with opioid use disorder, without judgment, barriers or delay.” It has 11 locations around Southern Ontario, as well as a virtual clinic.

The James Street pharmacy in Hamilton, Well-kare, offers “fast, friendly” service and short wait times. “We are accepting new patients!” an ad on the outside wall says.

Visitors can come out of the door with their pills in minutes. Many pharmacies have doctors on site to write prescriptions. If a doctor is not there, clients can often talk to one by video.

Hamilton pharmacist Priya Sandhu says such outfits have discovered that specializing in addiction medicines can be a moneymaker. Many of their clients are on multiple medications. Along with hydromorphone, they might be receiving addiction meds such as methadone, Suboxone and Kadian, as well as drugs for anxiety, insomnia, infections and high blood pressure. The pharmacies can charge dispensing fees for each, plus another charge for observing the taking of the drugs, if that is required.

Ms. Sandhu figures they can make \$40 a day off some customers. That means that, in theory, a pharmacy could earn nearly \$15,000 a year from a single person.

“It’s a great business model,” she says. But “I think there is a level of patient care that is missing. It’s very transactional.”

Defenders of safer supply insist it is a vital service. Arrow Medical’s founder, Joshua Fletcher, says traditional addiction meds such as methadone and Suboxone may calm patients’ drug cravings but they don’t provide the high that some of them seek. Bet-





ter that they should get it from fast-acting hydromorphone pills than street fentanyl laced with dangerous additives, says Dr. Fletcher, who is affiliated with North York General, a Toronto hospital.

The founder of True North, addiction doctor and University of Toronto professor Chris Cavacuiti, told me by e-mail that his clinics prescribe safer supply pills only in combination with more standard addiction meds and that “any patient identified as diverting medication is discontinued from the program.” He said the program’s aim is “to reduce reliance on street drugs and keep patients connected to health care providers.”

David D’Souza, the founder of another chain, New Dawn Medical, acknowledges that diversion and “lax prescribing” happens. But in an Aug. 27 paper for the Macdonald-Laurier Institute, an Ottawa think tank, he wrote that safer supply “properly targeted and rigorously regulated, can be a pragmatic response to the new realities of today’s illicit-drug market.”

The pharmacies, too, defend their practices. They stress their job is to dispense addiction medications, not prescribe them. That is up to the doctors.

The pharmacies also say they have strict protocols in place to prevent diversion, such as taking urine samples from patients to make sure they have traces of the prescribed drug in their bodies and requiring them to take at least some of their meds in front of pharmacy staff.

Staff at the Wellkare pharmacy showed me the small washroom where patients go to produce a sample. It has a video camera inside to discourage them from tampering with their samples. A sign warns visitors it is there. The owner declined to speak to me on the record.

None of these measures seem to do much to prevent the buying and selling of the pills. I visited four different Hamilton pharmacies over several days this summer and often found people waiting out-

side to buy hydromorphone pills. They had no problem finding sellers.

A steady stream of people came out of the pharmacies, holding white plastic bags containing their meds. Some told me they would take only one or two of their pills so that the drug showed up in their urine test at the pharmacy, but trade the rest for fentanyl or sell them for cash.

Jesse Steingart, 44, said pill selling and trading is a fact of life in Hamilton. He used to sell his hydromorphone to get fentanyl “because that’s a hard drug to afford.” Now, he says he sells them just once or twice a week, “whether it’s to get laundry done or to get a pizza in my stomach.” With the pills in his pocket, “it’s just inevitable.”

Joshua Gordyn told me he sells or trades the pills he gets daily from his pharmacy. The eight-milligram pills go for about \$2 on the street in Hamilton – more in communities where they are less common. Mr. Gordyn said he could get \$10 a pill if he took them to a nearby Indigenous reserve, Six Nations of the Grand River.

Police there confirm that outsiders bring pills to the reserve. Detective Sergeant Rob Monteforte of the Six Nations drug squad said that, in a bust last year, they seized more than 1,000 from suspected Toronto-area traffickers.

Locals on safer supply sometimes sell their meds, too, he said. If police find a pill bottle with a name on it, they call the prescribing doctor and ask him or her to cut the patient off.

Brett Stubbs works as a security guard at a church soup kitchen across the street from a well-known Hamilton addiction pharmacy. He told me that, once, when he was reviving someone who had suffered an overdose, he had to cut open the man’s pants to give him a life-saving injection. About 70 pills tumbled out of his pockets.

“It’s so blatant, it’s frightening,” said Regan Anderson, head of Wayside House of Hamilton, a live-in addiction-treatment centre. He sees people using and dealing pills right on the steps of a nearby pharmacy.

It would be one thing, he told me, if the array of drugs that people get at such places was helping them get better. Instead, “they’re staying unwell, and to the point of being basically publicly intoxicated or paralyzed on the street, without a real strong road map to change or to recovery.”

Dr. Regenstreif has done lots of work with youth who have run afoul of the law. They told her hydromorphone pills are cheap and easy to find. For those with limited experience using opioids, and thus a low tolerance, they pose a serious threat.

The eight-milligram Dilaudid pills, or D8s, are so strong they are not often used in ordinary medicine. Yet some safer-supply patients are walking out of the pharmacy door with 10 or 20 D8s at a time.

Though the death rate from opioids has been trending downward in Canada, 165 people died in Hamilton last year of suspected overdoses, a staggering number for the Southern Ontario city of about half a million. The victims of this 21st-century plague can be seen all over downtown, passed out on the sidewalk or bent over, swaying, in the half-conscious state that comes from consuming opioid drugs.

Critics of safer supply like Dr. Regenstreif say the practice is contributing to the problem, by giving drug users a marketable commodity that produces ready cash on a daily basis – just what they need to support their habit.

Hamilton police say that although fentanyl is still the main threat, they know prescription pills are being sold on the streets. This July, they carried out a two-week investigation of suspected drug dealing around a local pharmacy. They arrested nine people and seized 284 hydromorphone pills, along with quantities of fentanyl, methamphetamine and other drugs.

Hamilton is far from the only Ontario city struggling with the fallout from safer supply. In North Bay, drug-squad officer Brad Reaume said the Northern Ontario city was blindsided by the spread of diverted safer-supply drugs, hit when “we had our backs turned.” He said some pills end up in Indigenous com-



Brett Stubbs works as a security guard at a church soup kitchen across the street from a well-known Hamilton addiction pharmacy.

munities farther north, where they are less numerous and fetch a higher price.

In London, downtown business owners have complained about open drug use, vandalism and other problems around pharmacies that specialize in addiction meds. In April, city council voted unanimously to ask the provincial government to review what one councillor, David Ferreira, called the “variety-store” model of dispensing them.

In Ottawa, merchants and residents complained about similar issues around a clinic in the Chinatown district. “It’s creating a very visible, very active and I would say dangerous open-air drug market,” city councillor Ariel Troster said. “It’s just the absolute Wild West with these private clinics.”

Even at one of Toronto’s trendiest intersections, Dundas and Ossington, residents have been complaining on social media about open drug use outside an addiction pharmacy. In a scene much like that outside the Hamilton pharmacies, a collection of people gather in the morning to wait for it to open.

Province-wide, the Ontario Provincial Police say they seized 12 times as much hydromorphone in 2025 as they did in 2022, though they cannot say for certain how much came from diverted safer supply.

Regulators are aware of the diversion issue.

Lily Barnes, press secretary for Ontario Health Minister Sylvia Jones, said that “to be absolutely clear, our government does not and will never support the distribution of illegal drugs,” though it was up to the bodies that oversee pharmacists and doctors to make sure their members were following the rules about opioids.

The Ontario College of Pharmacists said it was looking into complaints about certain addiction pharmacies and “reviewing standards, policies, guidelines and other requirements.”

The College of Physicians and Surgeons of Ontario brought in new rules this May requiring doctors to see patients in person (rather than just online) before starting them on safer-supply drugs, to offer them other addiction medicines first and to assess patients in person every three months.

Then, this week, it went much further. It said it would direct doctors not to prescribe safer supply except in combination with other more standard addiction drugs; to limit prescribing of the drugs to eight weeks; and to require patients on safer supply to undergo “a comprehensive in-person clinical assessment” at least monthly. Most significantly, it would direct doctors to specify that patients should not take their pills out of the pharmacy or clinic.

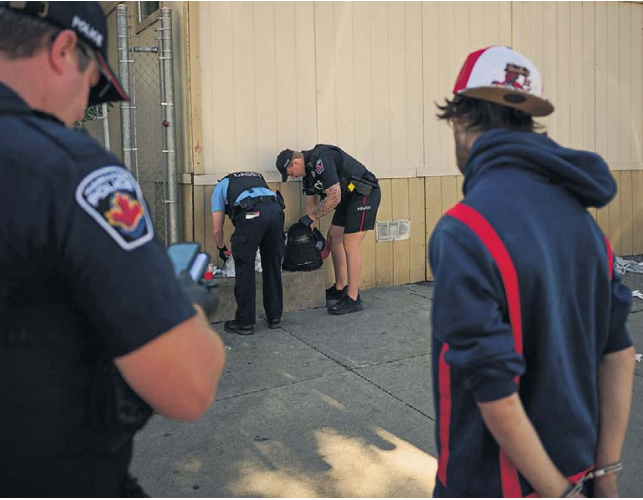
The new directive will go to the college’s directors for approval on Oct. 13 and, provided they give the green light, take effect on Nov. 16. “These amendments would not prohibit safer supply prescribing,” said Laura Zilke, a spokeswoman for the college. “Rather, they would strengthen clinical oversight of prescribing, while minimizing the risks associated with diversion and supporting a short transition for patients from safer supply to OAT,” she said, referring to opioid agonist therapy, the blanket term for treatment with standard addiction meds.

The college of pharmacists is also considering change. Without specifying what it would do, its board voted Tuesday to make it a priority “to strengthen pharmacy practice related to opioid dispensing for safe supply.”

The change of tack comes too late for Dr. Regenstreif. In an emotional open letter in August, she said she was leaving her addiction practice after 15 years, fed up with “a business model bent on making a profit for doctors and pharmacies by keeping people on the addictive opioids that got them into trouble in the first place.”

Some of her patients cried when she told them, but she said that, as much as she cared for them, she could not keep working in a system “that has lost sight of recovery as a goal.”

Hydromorphone pills, prescribed under the name Dilaudid and known informally as ‘dillies,’ are meant to treat severe pain but have become part of the street drug trade in such places as Hamilton.



Officers search a suspect’s belongings during an arrest in July in Hamilton. Local police say that although fentanyl is still the main threat, they know prescription pills are being sold on the streets.



A Hamilton police cruiser passes a downtown pharmacy bearing a True North addiction program sign. In July, they carried out a two-week investigation of suspected drug dealing around a local pharmacy.

The subject who is truly loyal to the chief magistrate will neither advise nor submit to arbitrary measures - Junius

The risky bet of prediction markets

Prediction markets let people bet on the outcome of real-world events based on a yes-or-no question. Will the Bank of Canada raise interest rates? Will the Dodgers win the World Series again?

For the right answer, each contract pays \$1; losers get nothing. Participants buy and sell contracts at a price that reflects the odds the market has assigned to a particular event.

Canada has opened the door a crack to such markets. We'd wager that the door has already been opened too far.

For the trading platforms collecting transaction fees, it can be a lucrative business. The popularity of prediction markets has exploded since 2025, especially among young men. Monthly trading volume on the two largest global platforms, Kalshi and Polymarket, went from less than US\$5-billion last September to nearly US\$53-billion in July.

Betting in prediction markets right now is largely unregulated. Governments around the world are grappling with the question of whether to treat it as gambling or something that belongs in financial markets – or to allow it at all.

In typical fashion, Canada has so far followed the U.S. in choosing the financial markets route but stopped short of allowing everything that U.S. authorities have greenlit.

Canadians, for now, can legally bet only on contracts linked to economic indicators, financial markets and climate trends through authorized investing platforms. That excludes contracts tied to popular categories such as sports, politics and entertainment, which the U.S. largely allows. Contracts in Canada must be also linked to events that are at least 30 days in the future, limiting short-term betting.

Predictably, there is a push to expand prediction markets. Wealthsimple, one of only two financial firms permitted to offer prediction markets so far, has argued that other types of contracts, such as those related to sports, the biggest driver of bets, should also be regulated as financial instruments.

Canada should not heed such calls. There is little evidence that event contracts serve any kind of real-world purpose, unlike financial instruments such as stocks and bonds. But there are growing signs of harm from online wagering.

Some argue that prediction markets herald financial innovation. For example, they could serve as a sort of insurance against everyday financial risks.

Wealthsimple posits the example of an ice cream vendor, facing the risk of slim sales in a cold summer. To offset that possible hit, goes the argument, they could buy event contracts that pay out in the event of bad weather. In practice, it would take quite the sophisticated ice cream shop to know how many contracts to buy and at what price. That notion melts under scrutiny.

Ditto for the claim that prediction markets are a useful forecasting tool. Even in the politics category, where they have a good track record of accurately forecasting the outcome of U.S. presidential elections, only about 1 per cent of politics-related event contracts have liquid enough markets for the odds they produce to be considered at all reliable.

What we do know is that people overwhelmingly use event contracts for gambling. And the risks of online gambling are becoming plain for everyone to see.

A recent Canadian study, for example, found that emergency-room visits for gambling-related disorders nearly doubled since Ontario allowed online gambling on private platforms in 2022, with boys and men under the age of 30 accounting for the biggest increase.

Pervasive online gambling ads have helped turn online wagering and sports betting into a financial snare for young adults already contending with soaring living costs, high housing prices and the easy-spending traps of social media.

Adding sports and other popular categories to Canada's prediction markets is likely to dramatically broaden their appeal, turning them into yet another domestic venue for betting on the Internet.

The correct answer to who should supervise additional types of prediction markets in this country – financial authorities or gambling regulators – is neither.

Unless prediction markets evolve into something that shows clear financial utility, securities regulators should refrain from opening the door wider. And Canada should certainly not allow prediction markets under its gambling regime – not until it has restricted gambling and sports-betting ads and found ways to reduce the risk of underage betting and addiction. To do otherwise would be a reckless gamble.



LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

COME TOGETHER

Re “The next generation of leaders must be ‘in-betweeners’ ” (Opinion, Sept. 26): I appreciate contributor Jody Wilson-Raybould’s recognition of “the integrated and interconnected nature of so much of what humanity must grapple with,” but I hope many will see a stronger common foundation.

She speaks of Indigenous and non-Indigenous people as having “distinct ways of talking and viewing the world,” but my experience is we also have many similarities and common ambitions. As noted, “traditions are not static; they evolve.”

Many of us have identities and worldviews that draw on different backgrounds; there are many ways we can group ourselves around shared values and ambitions. As we work to address historical injustices and deal with the global issues of today, I hope more of us will think simply of living together rather than “side-by-side together.”

We can celebrate and draw from our ancestries without that being our only anchor. I believe this is how we will best break down harmful silos.
■ David Clarry Toronto

NO PAIN ...

Re “Mark Carney’s long-term plans and Canadians’ immediate pain” (Sept. 26): Only a little reflection is needed to recognize that our challenges – climate change, health care, housing, defence, reconciliation, productivity, trade, sovereignty, take your pick – have been decades in the making and are deeply rooted. Never were quick fixes going to be the answer.

In Mark Carney, we finally have a leader who understands this and acts accordingly. Yes, there can be short-term wins. But in the main, the national project of repairing, stabilizing and building a prosperous, modern Canada is a long-term endeavour.

And, as difficult as it is to acknowledge, it won’t come without some “immediate pain.”
■ Donald Hall Ottawa

STRIKE OUT

Re “Ottawa strikes a better balance on labour” (Editorial, Sept. 28): Why does it always seem that governments deal with the symptoms, and not the diseases, of unionization?

Governments should consider adopting “flexicurity,” an approach successfully used in Denmark. Under this methodology employers, instead of unions or strict seniority rules, have the flexibility to select and manage staff. In return workers receive strong social protections, including generous unemployment

support and retraining opportunities.

Giving employers the ability to hire and fire would strengthen the overall work force. It would boost productivity, improve compensation and benefits and build more resilient organizations. Morale rises, collective bargaining becomes more constructive and the entire system works better for everyone, employers, employees and the public alike.

The only losers would be the chronically disruptive or unproductive employees (appropriately so) who drag down performance. What are we waiting for?
■ John Budreski Whistler, B.C.

You applaud the Building Canada Strong Act because the legislation “rebalances” the power between unions and employers. Needless to say, employers are unanimously in favour of these reforms.

The new law would empower the government to terminate a lawful strike and impose arbitration by ministerial fiat, from behind closed doors. One would have thought any “balance” of interests would start with the fact that the government proposes to curtail a Charter right in favour of business efficiency and profit.

Moreover, the government already has the power to enact back-to-work legislation in Parliament after full public debate and discussion. Surely the existing parliamentary process brings far more transparency and accountability rather than a minister’s direction initiated by an employer’s initiative.

To borrow a phrase from the Prime Minister who proposed this new law: Charter rights are not “written in pencil” to be negated by government upon the request of big corporations.
■ Paul Cavalluzzo CM, O Ont, LSM; Toronto

In your support for the government’s proposed labour law reforms contained within Bill C-39, you argue that they would “only apply for disruptions with significant national impact.” Therein lies the rub.

Who gets to determine whether a strike has “significant national impact?” Presumably, the federal government will define “significant” as it sees fit.

That you cite, with approval, measures to limit the right to strike in the United States, where successive administrations have for decades rolled back the rights of both unions and workers, is downright scary.
■ David Bright St. Catharines, Ont.

Re “Labour Code changes will increase transparency amid high-profile bargaining disputes, Hajdu says” (Report on Business, Sept. 23): Workers and management of businesses protected by regulation, or which have significant market share, should face

damages through class actions for strikes and lockouts. The costs should be borne proportionally by the variance of the last offer to the final settlement.

The right to strike exists, but the costs today are borne by the customers of a business and often multiply through the economy. Litigation is slow and expensive.

Government action seems reasonable to keep the overall economy functioning. If unfairly used, the reckoning would be at the ballot box.

The economy, workers and companies are better off when cooler heads prevail, not unlike our judicial system ultimately ruling on private contract disputes. It should be rare, and it is far more civilized.

Canada would be a better place to invest, work and operate business.
■ Richard Vanderlubbe Milton, Ont.

BRIGHT SIDE

Re “Blue Jays are handcuffed to underperforming Vladimir Guerrero Jr. for 13 more years” (Sports, Sept. 25): Many fans have complained about Vladimir Guerrero Jr.’s performance, particularly given the size of his paycheck. But there’s an overlooked upside.

Even after agents, fees and sophisticated tax planning take their share, his enormous salary still sends a sizable sum into Canadian government coffers through taxes.

So, even when he isn’t delivering at the plate, his salary is still making a substantial contribution to Canada.
■ Mark Agro Burlington, Ont.

Re “The Blue Jays’ failed 2026 season confirms it: The 2025 run was a fluke” (Sports, Sept. 28): Hey, nobody promised a rose garden.

For around \$50, I can sit in the 500s at Rogers Centre with my friends. I can have a beer, popcorn and a soggy hot dog – all overpriced, of course. With the sun shining and a view of the CN Tower, there’s no where I’d rather be on a summer day.

The score? Who cares? This is heaven on Earth. Maybe there will be a home run, stolen base or wicked slider, and maybe all those things will happen for the opposing team. But, again, who cares?

I could pay \$200 to sit on my hands and watch the National Ballet of Canada perform *Swan Lake* (again), but why? Baseball is the beautiful game, and I know the other 40,000-plus people in the stands would agree with me.
■ Mary Lou Ditta Calgary

Letters to the Editor should be exclusive to The Globe and Mail. Include name, address and daytime phone number. Keep letters under 150 words. Letters may be edited for length and clarity. E-mail: letters@globeandmail.com

 OPINION

The ugly reckoning coming for Danielle Smith

The referendum, and its nine non-secession questions, is contemptible



With just a few weeks to go before Alberta's referendum on separation, fresh polls indicate growing support for those wanting no part of ripping the country apart.

One by Ipsos shows 70 per cent of Albertans want to remain in Canada, while 20 per cent are in favour of holding a binding referendum on separation. However, if Alberta was to hold such a vote, only 14 per cent said they'd choose to leave.

Meantime, a new survey conducted by Janet Brown Opinion Research for CBC News showed 72 per cent of Albertans in favour of remaining in Canada, versus 23 per cent in favour of

starting the legal process to hold a binding referendum on the question. That's down from 27 per cent in April.

None of these numbers come as a shock.

There has never been any widespread desire among Albertans to cut ties with their country. Certainly, there has been some separatist sentiment that has taken root in rural parts of the province, especially among older males. But there has never been a groundswell of rage that has translated into a majority of Albertans wanting to leave – despite the best efforts of a succession of provincial leaders (especially conservatives) to demonstrate the policies of any Liberal prime minister who has ever held office.

Recently, Premier Danielle Smith, speaking at an online forum with former Reform Party leader Preston Manning, was overcome with emotion talking about how hurt and angry Albertans are over the horrible, ghastly manner in which they have been treated by Ottawa over the years. It prompted her to wonder

at times: “Does this country actually want us?”

Yet, a person intent on destroying the province's oil and gas industry couldn't have done a lousier job if they tried than former Liberal PM Justin Trudeau.

The province's oil output has doubled since 2007, and between 2013 and 2025 – including the decade in which Mr. Trudeau allegedly tried to kill Alberta's golden goose, according to the provincial narrative – Canada's crude oil production rose roughly 41 per cent, according to the Canada Energy Regulator.

Alberta continued to set new records for oil production in 2025 – adding 182,000 barrels of oil a day. Of course, that production has been assisted greatly by the new oil pipeline to the West Coast that the notorious Mr. Trudeau got built.

For decades, Alberta has been the richest province in the country, by a wide margin in some cases. And yet, all provincial conservative governments have done is whine about how Ottawa steals all their money.

Everything about this referendum on separation and the other nine questions on the ballot – among other things they attempt to scapegoat immigrants for many of the province's problems – is contemptible. It's a phony, illegitimate exercise Ms. Smith has lent credibility to in order to save her job.

Ms. Smith's United Conservative Party has been hijacked by separatists, and as a sop to them she has construed a separation referendum that she did not campaign on. It really has zero, and I mean zero, credibility. Many Albertans I talked to on a recent week-long trip to the province were furious their government was wasting time and money on a poorly organized fishing expedition almost exclusively designed to help the Premier avoid the same fate as her predecessor, Jason Kenney, who lost his job after running afoul of the same UCP types who are pulling the strings behind this ridiculous referendum.

Most “normal” Albertans want no part of this clown show. They live in a stunningly beauti-

ful and prosperous province that is an integral part of a country that is the envy of the world – one led by a Prime Minister who has emerged as one of the pre-eminent leaders of the free world. Most Albertans have far more respect and admiration for Mark Carney than they do their own provincial leaders – a fact borne out by recent polling.

There is a reckoning coming for Ms. Smith. When this attempt to get the secession ball rolling goes up in flames, which it will, the Premier will have to deal with a party membership angry over the results. Many will agitate for a change at the top, wanting to punish their leader for her (milquetoast) support of the status quo. There will surely be a push to replace Ms. Smith with someone who is a stronger advocate for breaking away from Canada.

That's when we'll see what Ms. Smith is made of. Will she attempt to give the braying mob what they want, or will she finally take a principled stand and expose these desperate and delusional people for who they are?

Brave David Eby will challenge anyone (with a leg injury) to wrestle



B.C. NDP Leader David Eby is a shrewd, confident competitor.

He will challenge anyone currently suffering from a stomach virus to a hot-dog-eating contest. He will dare any chess champion to a tournament when they are sleeping. Mr. Eby will tackle a bear in a cage (from the outside, without actually touching the bear), or wrestle any and all comatose patients in their beds. Had he been given the opportunity, I'm sure he would have even laced up his skates in the 1994 U.S. Figure Skating Championships to compete against the compromised Nancy Kerrigan.

But Mr. Eby has a more important battle to fight at the moment. Yes, the trade war with the U.S. is primarily Prime Minister Mark Carney's to fight, but Mr. Eby has the very important role of pretending he is a central figure – sort of like a younger child pressing buttons on an unplugged controller, while his older brother enjoys a single-player game in peace. Mr. Eby's co-operation, his complacency, is very important.

And so, B.C.'s Premier has no choice but to call an election two years early, even though he already had a majority mandate from the electorate. He needs to make sure that he has permission from the people of British Columbia to press those disabled buttons, for a game he is not actually playing, while he can still say he is fighting a dragon. Because who knows where that dragon will be in two years' time?

During a press conference last



B.C. Premier David Eby, centre, makes an announcement on housing on Friday during a B.C. election campaign stop in Burnaby, flanked by NDP candidates, from left: Rohani Arora, Jennifer Whiteside, Raj Chouhan and Janet Routledge. Mr. Eby has defended his decision to call an early election.

RICH LAM/
THE CANADIAN PRESS

week, Mr. Eby defended his decision to call an early election, saying “There is never a bad time to go to British Columbians to ask the right direction.” But the best time, of course, is when the opposition is without a permanent leader and consumed by infighting (and also when there is already a municipal election going on, and when a by-election was already scheduled for Abbotsford-Mission, which has now been cancelled). Anyway, as Mr. Eby said, this is an “existential moment” for the province, one where British Columbians are left to ponder such foundational questions as “what is the point of a fixed election date if the Premier can call a snap vote at a whim?” And also, “how stupid, exactly, does this guy think we all are?”

That said, it's evident that this early election scheme has not gone entirely as Mr. Eby might have hoped. At the time of writing, four of his cabinet ministers have said they won't be running for re-election in the upcoming vote. On the other side of the aisle, a handful of MLAs that defected from the B.C. Conservatives under the leadership of Kerry-Lynne Findlay, who resigned just two days before Mr. Eby called the election, have found their way back to the party. A poll by Angus Reid conducted just after the election call had the Conservatives leading the NDP by eight points, which is a reversal from the four-point lead the NDP had.

Mr. Eby's attack lines aren't really landing either. His party has charged that British Columbians

won't know what leader they're going to get if they vote for the Conservatives, which is currently being steered by interim leader Lorne Doerkson. But as the CBC's Katie DeRosa put to Mr. Eby directly, it was his choice to throw the province into a campaign right now, before the B.C. Conservatives had time to elect a new leader. He has also tried to frame this election as his righteous battle against an opposition MLA who imagined the province to be an “American protectorate,” but Mr. Doerkson quickly neutered that narrative by repeatedly referring to U.S. President Donald Trump as a “bully,” and by accusing the governing NDP of failing to stand up to Mr. Trump effectively.

Mr. Eby, of course, has plenty of time to turn this all around (he is very good at turning things around, after all; he turned an operating surplus inherited from former NDP premier John Horgan into a projected \$13.8-billion deficit). And another Premier, Ontario's Doug Ford, was able to wring success from a similarly opportunistic election call (though the Ontario election was held before Mr. Carney became Prime Minister, when there was an absence of leadership in Ottawa, and so it was slightly more credible that a provincial election could be about standing up to Mr. Trump). Mr. Eby just needs time for the electorate to forget about the very cynical reason he called this election – and also about the state of the province's books, and hospitals, and housing, and crime and addiction, and a few other niggling things. And then, surely, they will reward him for his brave, confident challenge. Those feverish, vomiting competitive eaters don't stand a chance against this guy.

The trade war is no excuse for flights of economic nationalist fancy



These are unusual times. There's a trade war on, given special intensity by Donald Trump's threats to use “economic force” to bend Canada to his will. To counter the U.S. administration's crude attempts to divert capital south of the border, governments across the country are mobilizing resources in ways they might not otherwise contemplate. A sort-of wartime economy, fit for fighting a sort-of war.

Fair enough. But just because economic logic might have to be stretched here and there to fend off the depredations of a lunatic administration does not mean it should be thrown out altogether. The answer to the economic nationalism of the Trumpists is not to descend into our own fever-swamp of economic nationalism, for which there is an all-too-enthusiastic constituency at the best of times. Alas, they happen to

have a convenient platform at the moment.

Hence the release, within a couple of weeks of each other, of two high-profile reports rooted in some of the most enduring obsessions of economic nationalism: the value-added fallacy, and pension conscription.

Export Development Canada is responsible for the first. The federal Crown corporation has issued a report (“From Resources to Resilience: How Canada Can Capture More Value Through Trade”) based firmly in the “hewers of wood, drawers of water” tradition of nationalist laments, albeit dressed up in more technocratic jargon.

But the argument is the same as always: Canada's economy is too focused on exporting raw resources, when we should be producing more “sophisticated” and “complex” products – products with more, you guessed it, *value-added*. As the language suggests, a lot of this is based on a kind of advanced-industrial snobbery – a vague feeling that certain kinds of industries are simply *infra dig* for

an economy of Canada's place and station.

But it's also based on a simple economic error. A chart on page eight of the report is a classic of the type. Canada, it notes, sells yellow peas for \$30 a tonne, when we could be processing them into snacks or pasta and selling them for \$3,000 a tonne.

Put like that, you'd have to wonder why Canadian businesses would be so dumb as to leave all that money on the table. But of course a lot of other resources go into turning those \$30 peas into \$3,000 snacks. What determines the profitability or otherwise of a good is not simply the sale price, but the difference between the price of the good and the cost of the resources used to make it.

That same arithmetic applies at any stage of production. At any stage of production, profits can be high or low, and at any stage of production a firm's workers can be relatively efficient in their use of resources or relatively inefficient. It's profits that matter to investors' returns, and productivity that matters to workers' wages –

not where they fit in the “value-added chain.”

If firms in this country decide to concentrate on selling the raw resource, rather than process it into something more “sophisticated,” possibly they have a good reason. The mere observation that they are not doing what the writer of a report might prefer they should is not evidence in itself that they don't know their own business. Absent some demonstrable market failure it's just an aesthetic preference masquerading as economic analysis.

But the EDC report is Nobel-worthy compared to the other recent report, from the Canadian Shield Institute, an offshoot of the Council of Canadian Innovators, with much the same techno-nationalist leanings. Their report attempts to resurrect one of those zombie ideas that refuse to die: forcing Canada's pension funds to invest a certain percentage of their assets in Canada.

Sorry, did I say Canada? Actually, the report is against such simplistic solutions: “It would miss the mark to simply direct pension

funds to allocate more of their assets to Canada.” Rather, it would force the funds to invest in Canadian “growth” companies, defined as Canadian-controlled firms “with 10 or more employees, growing at 20 per cent or more per year, on a three-year average annualized rate.”

Why yes, that definition does rather fit the members of the CCI, now that you mention it. Beyond the outrageous self-servingness, beyond even the distortion this would imply in pension funds' fiduciary duty to obtain the best possible risk-adjusted return for their beneficiaries, there is the usual opportunity-cost objection: The CCI's proposal to tax pensioners to fund risky growth companies would divert capital from other companies that might represent a better risk-return trade-off.

Again: Where's the market failure? If there are genuinely superior returns available in Canada, fund managers are at least as capable of recognizing it as anyone else. And yes, that includes the CPP.

Inside the mansion from Million Dollar Secret

The opulent chateau behind the Netflix series is drawing star-struck guests to Kelowna, B.C.

CAROLYN IRELAND

On the Netflix reality series *Million Dollar Secret*, 12 strangers are sequestered at a palatial lakeside retreat where they vie to identify the “millionaire” among them.

Many of the show’s fans, meanwhile, are racing to uncover the real-life location of the opulent cliffside mansion set high above a deep blue lake.

An online search leads to Château Okanagan, a 17.8-hectare private estate in Kelowna, B.C.

The chateau was originally built as a family home by Kelowna real estate developer Michael Holzhey, who created a 20,000-square-foot stone, timber and copper residence and filled it with a container load of antiques imported from France.

Holzhey and his family lived in the home for a time but decided to give the hospitality business a go when he and his wife became empty nesters. The estate opened up to guests in 2022.

Visitors who don’t blink at the price of booking the property – \$13,200 and up a night with a minimum three-night stay – have access to six suites in the Grand Residence, a two-bedroom beach house, five slivers of pebbly beach, two swimming pools, one tennis court and three acres of vineyards.

A more affordable option is a \$900-per-night suite in the new four-bedroom villa that opened in June for a bed-and-breakfast experience.

So how does the show’s backdrop translate into a real-world experience?

I joined a small group of travel writers and influencers at the chateau in late May to see what a stay would be like, and experience the gastronomy, wines and outdoor life of B.C.’s Okanagan Valley.

I settled into the Arrowleaf suite, where French doors open to a shared terrace with views of Okanagan Lake below and the forested hillside on the opposite shore.

The influencers set to work filming the parterre gardens, luxurious spa and infinity pools in cinematic slo-mo. A chef created meals with B.C. spot prawns, oysters and other delicacies, and the gracious staff smoothly responded to every request.

While the Netflix contestants engage in such challenges as out-running snarling dogs and diving into Okanagan Lake, our group engaged in more sedate pursuits — examples of what the Château



Château Okanagan, the cliffside 17.8-hectare private estate with a price tag of \$13,200 per night, has been in high demand since being featured on the Netflix series *Million Dollar Secret*. Below, the dining terrace opens to sweeping views of Okanagan Lake.

Okanagan concierge can organize for guests.

We started in the kitchen, where chef Scott Geiring taught us how to roll and shape the little pillows of ricotta gnocchi that would become our dinner, accompanied by a syrah from Le Vieux Pin Winery.

Sundowner cocktails around the outdoor fireplace became a nightly ritual.

One day we were ferried by helicopter to nine holes of golf on the signature course of the wildly beautiful Rise Resort in Vernon, B.C., followed by lunch with views overlooking the lake.

The afternoon included a tour of the area’s wine cellars and a ride back to the chateau by chauffeur-driven Rolls-Royce.

The most serene experience was a trip across the lake to the storied Mission Hill Family Estate Winery, designed in monastic style by renowned American architect Tom Kundig.

After a tour of the starkly beautiful underground cave cellars, we settled in for an alfresco dinner overlooking the vines and sipped rare vintages of Oculus, the Bordeaux-style red Mission Hill is known for.

The next morning, I joined a sunrise yoga class at the water’s edge. After lunch, I hiked down a steep path to a secluded blackstone beach hoping to see the local spotted sandpipers but no birds were about. (The estate’s beaches are not technically private because the shoreline can be accessed by the public.)



On my clamber back up the slope, I spotted yellow-bellied marmots, deer and a bald eagle perched in a ponderosa pine.

During a poolside soiree, Holzhey acknowledged that filling the calendar with bookings for the full estate has been a challenge, but local zoning rules would not permit the property to rent out rooms individually like a boutique hotel.

Then Netflix came along. The show streams to a global audience in more than 190 countries, but it still seems astounding that many fans have sufficiently deep pockets to follow through with a reservation.

“It has been a surprise to me, too,” quipped Brian Dower, the affable managing director of Château Okanagan, adding that bookings soared after the show began streaming.

He received an e-mail from a

couple in Brazil just that morning.

Corporate travel is big, he explained, and families sometimes take over the Grand Residence for a wedding on the lakefront terrace.

The popularity of the Netflix show inspired Holzhey to expand the experience to a wider audience with the new Estate Villa on the property.

The contemporary poured-concrete and glass aesthetic may also draw a different crowd from the old-world style of the chateau.

The suites have a private bathroom and bedroom, and there’s a communal great room at the centre with lounging, dining and a kitchen. Outside, the villa has a deck and hot tub.

Next year, pinot noir grapes will be planted on the slope just outside the front door because visitors to the Okanagan Valley covet the experience of a lake view and vineyard setting, Dower

said.

During the summer of 2026, British Columbia declared a state of emergency as out-of-control wildfires burned in the province. Evacuation orders covered some parts of the Okanagan, including areas in the vicinity of Vernon and Summerland, but the chateau was not included.

Dower had previously blocked off a chunk of time in August for the filming of *Million Dollar Secret*. As it turns out, the producers weren’t ready to go until September, when they descended with the crew and contestants for the filming of season three currently underway.

Cassandra Zerebeski, chief executive of Tourism Kelowna, notes the province did not issue a travel ban, but some visitors did postpone or cancel trips to Kelowna and the surrounding area in August. Some hotels, wineries, attractions and local entrepreneurs estimated a 30 per cent drop in business during the month, she says.

“They count on August.”

Zerebeski says Kelowna is popular year-round so some travellers will reschedule for another season. Genuine millionaires who enjoy golf, wine-tasting and soaking in healing waters will love the chateau. Fans of *Million Dollar Secret* without such deep pockets can still enjoy the adventure by booking a stay at the villa.

The writer was a guest of Château Okanagan, which did not review or approve this article. Stories are based on merit; The Globe does not guarantee coverage.

Lisbon’s new lighthearted luxury hotel is right in the heart of the old town

CATHERINE DAWSON MARCH

HOTEL REVIEW

You can’t find a closer luxury hotel to Lisbon’s buzzing historic centre – and walking into the new Andaz Lisbon (the first of its brand in Portugal) immediately brings calm and blessed air-conditioned relief. Before I even spotted the front desk, staff took my bags and I was escorted into a chic modern lobby where I was offered a drink to take the edge off the travel day (sparkling wine, mineral water or espresso, whatever works for you, the staff smiled).

While I waited, I noted the difference between the grand stone exterior of this 200-year-old bank building and the colourful contemporary nods to Portuguese art and ceramics inside. Look closely at those stately blue ceramic pieces in the lobby and you’ll laugh at their whimsical sea creature design, modern nods that make a beguiling contrast to the 18th-century Virgin Mary *azulejo* panel nearby, which was unearthed during the hotel renovation.

A hotel tour later revealed the historic-contemporary design extends into its 170 rooms – most noticeably in the recently opened first-floor loft wing. What were once bank offices are now three grand suites that make the most of the marble floors and carved woodwork. Sleek furniture and decorative Arraiolos tapestries juxtapose delightfully in these rooms where natural light floods through arched windows that reach for the 15-foot-high ceiling.

As I finished my welcome espresso, I settled into the relaxed-luxury vibe I was picking up. Not every hotel can pull it off. The Andaz Lisbon was doing it nicely.



The rooms in Hotel Andaz feature historic-contemporary design.

WHY YOU SHOULD VISIT

In the heat of a Lisbon summer, the reliable air conditioning – from rooms to restaurants and common areas – may be reason enough to book. But that’s just one bonus of this hotel, which opened in March. I was also won over by the warmth and cheeriness of the breakfast team in the sixth-floor dining space.

Cheerfully slinging local favourites, such as a ham-and-cheese toast with tangy São Jorge cheese and cured *bisaro presunto* ham (a sandwich hearty enough to power you through a morning of exploring), or making sure your coffee mug is never empty – even offering a box so you can pilfer

snacks from the buffet for later – the service really stood out.

This colourful space turns into Luzzi, a fine-dining restaurant with a Lusitanian influence, where the menu shows off culinary influences from Portugal’s Age of Discovery, including flavours from Goa, Macau, Mozambique, Japan, Cape Verde, Angola and Brazil.

The hotel ran *fado* performances on Friday and Saturday nights in the lobby during my visit, which was an easy way to experience this quintessential Portuguese art form. Principal guitarist Acácio Barbosa made it clear that concert-hall quiet was required to enjoy Soraia Cardoso’s expressive vocals. And he got it, transforming a lobby full of jabbering tourists into a spellbound audience. The music was magical and touched my soul.

SINCE YOU’RE IN THE NEIGHBOURHOOD

We had three days in Lisbon so enjoyed the “centre of it all” location in the heart of Baixa. We were steps from the Rua Augusta Arch (some rooms have views of the arch as does one cozy alcove in the Andaz rooftop bar). The Praça do Comércio, one of Europe’s largest and liveliest squares, is also a quick walk from the front door.

We had the Lisboa card (which covers all public transit, even from the airport, and many museum entrance fees). It took us in all directions and neighbourhoods but even when we got lost, it was never long before another bus or subway came along. Happily, we found MUDE – Museu do Design right behind the Andaz on Rua Augusta for our culture hit of Portuguese design and fashion.

Only a block away from the hotel is a stop for Lisbon’s much-photographed wooden tram as it makes its way up and

down this city of seven hills. Make time for a ride: Tram 28 is an excellent way to see more at public-transit prices.

ROOM FOR IMPROVEMENT

Two things irked me, perhaps unreasonably but enough to mention. While I never had to wait long for an elevator, there is no way I’d miss it if my attention wandered: The doors open with a singsong, two-tone, ding dong that struck me as too goofy even for the lighthearted luxury Andaz vibe. More problematic was the inconsistent water pressure in our third-floor shower. Some days, the rainfall showerhead felt too literal, like I really was trying to wash my hair in a light drizzle. Other times, it was pleasantly pluvial.

THE TAKEAWAY

Located in the heart of the city, Andaz Lisbon was a good base for this first-time visitor. The brand is fun and I loved the thoughtful design (overlapping blackout curtains in the rooms!) and décor brimming with Portuguese talent – even the minibars have Vista Alegre espresso and tea cups and saucers decorated with Lisbon’s famous black and white sidewalk stonework. And truthfully, hotel room coffee has never tasted so good when sipped from proper china.

Andaz Lisbon, R. do Comércio 132, located in the Baixa neighbourhood. Rooms from \$425 a night in low season; one round of minibar drinks and snacks free in all room categories. Historic loft suites start at \$2,400 a night.

The writer was a guest of the hotel, which did not review or approve this article. Stories are based on merit; The Globe does not guarantee coverage.

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How tech lessons are liberating seniors from online scams

As computers, mobile phones have become essential tools for life, older Canadians are sharpening their tech skills

SARAH LAING

Brenda Davis-White, 76, calls herself “a bit of a Luddite.” She says that as a retired operating room nurse, she had a career that required the use of specialized medical equipment, but not much computer use.

“My career and my life never gave me the opportunity to explore that,” says Davis-White, who lives in Sidney, B.C. “I didn’t have a cellphone for years and then finally acquiesced.”

She says that lack of experience resulted in challenges when she was trying to use her mobile phone and tablet.

“I got tired of asking family for help, which never seemed to come with a lot of enthusiasm,” says Davis-White, “and so I decided I was going to get some help myself.”

She found Victoria Seniors Tech Tutor online and met with tutor Gavin Koh. They immediately clicked. “He’s very gentle and easy to work with and that’s important.” Koh came to her home and helped her get comfortable with her devices including tasks like online banking and using a key-chain for her passwords – “really basic stuff, even just navigating screens and buttons,” she says.

Davis-White says the lessons have been invaluable. “I feel like I’m not reaching out into the wilderness. I am very comfortable doing my banking and online purchases and spotting spam and I just feel way more confident,” she says.

As computers, mobile phones and other devices have become essential tools for everyday life, tech classes for seniors – both



Brenda Davis-White, left, asks Gavin Koh a question during a tech tutoring session at her home in Sidney, B.C. CHAD HIPOLITO/THE GLOBE AND MAIL

paid and free – have gained in popularity. Maybe it’s about fixing a malfunctioning WiFi signal, sending photos on WhatsApp or depositing a cheque via a banking app. Increasingly, it’s deciphering whether a text or e-mail is genuine or if it’s a scammer with fraudulent intentions.

Koh – who charges \$120 for a 1½-hour in-home session – says his clients typically fall into three categories. There is a small minority who are totally new to tech and need coaching with things like turning on a cellphone or answering a call. Then, there are the newly retired, who may have been quite adept with computers during their career and want help with using Canva, AI tools or creating YouTube videos.

“And the middle is people who are just frustrated,” says Koh, who does sessions in Victoria, Sidney and Saanich, B.C. “The most common thing that they say is, ‘I never grew up with this. I had a job that either took care of

it or we never used it. No one trained me and I had a family to raise.’ ”

Koh says he often meets with people after they’ve spent hours on a doom loop of customer service that gets them nowhere.

“And then I come over, and because I’m in their physical presence and have access to their computer, it’s ‘click, click, click’ and within twenty minutes everything is fixed,” he says.

Koh says he also devotes a lot of his time to helping his clients avoid scams and says it’s easier to be fooled than you might think. He estimates 30 per cent of his clients have been scammed, including one who held a very senior legal role in their career but fell victim to digital fraud. It’s not unusual for him to work with a client and see something fraudulent – the fake gift card scam is a frequent offender – come through in real time.

He says his goal for any session is that his clients emerge feeling

“liberated” and unburdened from the overwhelm and fear they might feel around this increasingly ubiquitous part of modern life. “I want them to go away thinking, ‘Oh, that wasn’t as scary as I thought it was.’ ”

Emily Jones Joannis, co-founder and CEO of Connected Canadians in Ottawa, says the often-fraught “offspring as unpaid tech support” dynamic is one of the primary reasons that older people seek out paid tech help. Connected Canadians is a national digital inclusion charity that works to help seniors build their technology skills.

“Either they don’t have children or grandchildren that can help them, or they realize that their relationship with their adult child is getting strained due to ongoing requests for tech support,” says Jones Joannis. “It’s very much like when you’re teaching your kids to drive. It’s something that needs to be done, but you’re not necessarily the person

to do it.”

Connected Canadians has nine employees and 900 trained volunteers across the country, providing free, one-on-one coaching for seniors and lessons tailored to the tech skills they’re interested in. Content includes everything from online banking to e-mail to using Zoom or Facebook, texting and streaming music or entertainment. The organization also offers group workshops, either virtually or in person.

She adds that there is a cohort of students who are “self-actualizing,” using their third act to finally do the things they always planned.

“They want to write a novel and they don’t know how to publish it on Amazon or promote it on social media,” says Jones Joannis, who has an undergrad in computer science and works as an assistant professor of business at Carleton University. “We also have older artists who need help getting their art in an online gallery.”

Then there are the people who may have once delegated the tech stuff to a partner who’s now passed away.

“They have their grief, and then this horrible worry of not knowing how to do things,” Jones Joannis says. She adds that a major part of her team’s work is fostering the human connections that can happen between a mentor and older learner.

“We want to make sure that every session that happens has moments of human connection. It’s meant to help reduce loneliness and isolation.” After all, in a world where everything from booking a fitness class to buying a movie ticket to chatting with grandchildren often needs to be mediated by a device, a lack of those skills can drive that isolation.

Jones Joannis also believes that ensuring seniors have tech skills is a way to honour the important place older people have in our society.

“It’s so important to me that older adults are able to still contribute,” she says.

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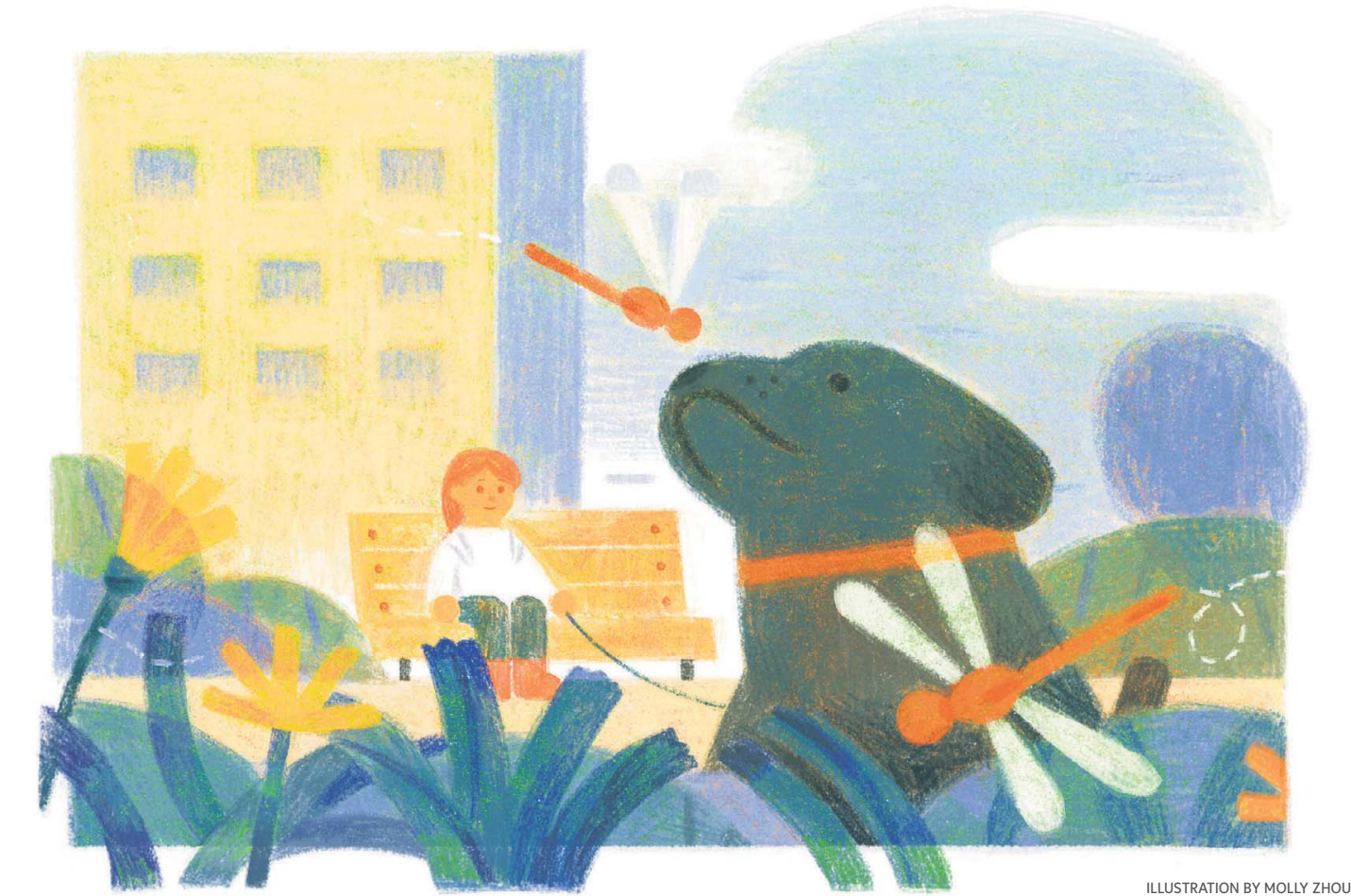


ILLUSTRATION BY MOLLY ZHOU

My rescue dog taught me to see the world

FIRST PERSON

Ronnie came with baggage and half a tail, but she has opened my eyes to new places, **Lindsay Black** writes

I was introduced to Ronnie a few years ago by my good friend, Michelle, who knew we would be a good match. Ronnie is short for Veronica, named after the raven-haired beauty from *The Archies*, and is my rescue dog from the streets of Puebla, Mexico. I like to say she's "got se-

crets" as a light way of saying she's likely had some tough times. From her dog rescue posting, she was described as a great addition to the family if you love the look of a Labrador without having your wine glass knocked off the coffee table, because she has half a tail. It gives her a bit of a unique, rough-and-tumble look. She has the face of a black Labrador but her body is a bit more truncated than a usual female lab, and her vet thinks she has had a litter (or more). She has been given a few different possible ages and came with two documented birthdates so I can only guess her age from the grey-

ing around her face. She also comes with a host of baggage. From living on the streets, she learned (and I haven't yet been able to unlearn her, despite lots of training) to be wary of men – especially men who aren't fully co-ordinated in their walking, which can mean that she will bark at an older gentleman who has mobility issues even when he kindly smiles at her. I usually try to excuse her behaviour by saying she only barks at the handsome ones, which sometimes gets a wary laugh. She also doesn't like when children run, stomping their feet as they do, and will bark at them, too, like a lifeguard around a pool. To ensure she stays on good behaviour when I walk her, I cannot listen to a podcast or be on my phone. At first, this bothered me. Think of all the things I could be learning and listening to! But because I need to be attentive to her quirks, she has taught me to take in the world around us. I have discovered many benches in the neighbourhood to watch the world go by because she enjoys just taking in the environment. I've had people stop

to tell me, with softness in their eyes and fondness in their voice, that they once had a Labrador, and I catch people smiling at her when she politely sits with me. Not only has she taught me to appreciate the setting, but she also has a tight group of "her people" she absolutely loves, showing them that every time she sees them. They range from David, the local dog walker (who is generous with liver treats); our neighbour who has a Frenchie; Jane, the wonderful and patient dog sitter; and my family. When she greets them, she does what I call her opera singing. She lets out a little falsetto howl-croon and she will gently walk up their leg and stick a paw in the air toward their face. She is also an excellent hiker – she loves the hills and leaves no one behind. I wanted to show her all the areas in and around Toronto, including the Rosedale Ravine, Sunnybrook and Sherwood Park. She runs up and down all the hills when she is in an off-lead area, and if one of her brood isn't in her sightlines, she will not go farther until she sees them. Ronnie also loves and appreciates good food, only the high-

est-quality meats and cheeses. If she is offered a pumpkin or yam treat, she will appreciate the gesture, taking it in her mouth but politely setting it down in front of her as if to say, "It's the thought that counts." Her love of treats has worked wonders to curb her triggers, and because of that, I always have treats in my pockets. In fact, I find treats in most of my jackets and jeans even when I'm out without Ronnie (which also works wonders when meeting new dog friends). Not long after I adopted her, I found out another family had first taken her home and returned her to the rescue – likely not giving much time at all for her to decompress. I consider those circumstances lucky for me. It turned out she needed about six months to show her true colours. A rescue dog with quirks like Ronnie's isn't for everyone, but she has certainly opened my eyes to new places and made me see the world differently.

Lindsay Black lives in Toronto.

First Person is a daily personal piece submitted by readers. Have a story to tell? See our guidelines at tgam.ca/essayguide.

TODAY'S SUDOKU SOLUTION

4	5	7	9	1	8	3	2	6
8	1	9	2	6	3	5	7	4
2	3	6	4	5	7	8	9	1
1	4	8	7	2	5	6	3	9
5	7	3	8	9	6	4	1	2
9	6	2	3	4	1	7	8	5
6	8	5	1	7	2	9	4	3
7	9	1	5	3	4	2	6	8
3	2	4	6	8	9	1	5	7

TODAY'S KENKEN SOLUTION

2÷	5+	2-	2÷		
2	1	4	5	6	3
4	5	6	3	2	1
3-	5-				
3	6	1	2	5	4
1-	8+				1-
6	2	3	4	1	5
9+	2÷	5-			
5	4	2	1	3	6
		5		2÷	
1	3	5	6	4	2

WORLD FORECAST

	TODAY	TOMORROW	FRIDAY
AMSTERDAM	24/16 SH	20/12 SH	20/10 S
ATHENS	20/17 SH	22/16 S	21/16 SH
BANGKOK	31/26 T	32/26 T	31/26 T
BEIJING	20/12 S	22/12 S	22/13 S
BERLIN	23/14 PC	23/14 PC	19/13 C
BRUSSELS	25/16 C	19/11 SH	19/10 S
COPENHAGEN	17/15 S	17/14 S	18/11 SH
FRANKFURT	22/10 S	22/12 C	20/12 PC
HONG KONG	31/28 T	31/26 T	28/25 T
JERUSALEM	24/15 SH	23/16 SH	25/16 PC
LAS VEGAS	33/22 S	33/22 S	34/23 S
LONDON	22/14 R	20/12 SH	20/12 PC
LOS ANGELES	31/20 S	32/20 S	35/23 S
MADRID	25/17 SH	27/17 PC	23/17 SH
MIAMI	31/25 T	31/26 T	32/26 T
MOSCOW	16/7 S	13/6 C	12/3 C
NEW DELHI	33/23 S	35/25 S	35/23 S
NEW YORK	24/18 S	25/19 S	25/15 SH
NICE	26/21 PC	26/20 C	26/20 PC
ORLANDO	30/23 SH	31/24 T	32/24 T
PARIS	24/16 C	21/12 PC	21/11 S
PHOENIX	25/19 S	30/21 S	34/23 S
ROME	27/17 S	28/17 S	28/13 S
SAN FRANCISCO	19/14 S	19/15 S	20/14 C
SEOUL	26/13 S	22/12 S	21/12 S
SINGAPORE	29/25 T	29/25 T	29/25 T
SYDNEY	20/15 S	29/18 PC	27/16 PC
TOKYO	22/19 SH	26/21 S	21/17 PC
WASHINGTON	27/19 S	29/19 PC	30/19 PC

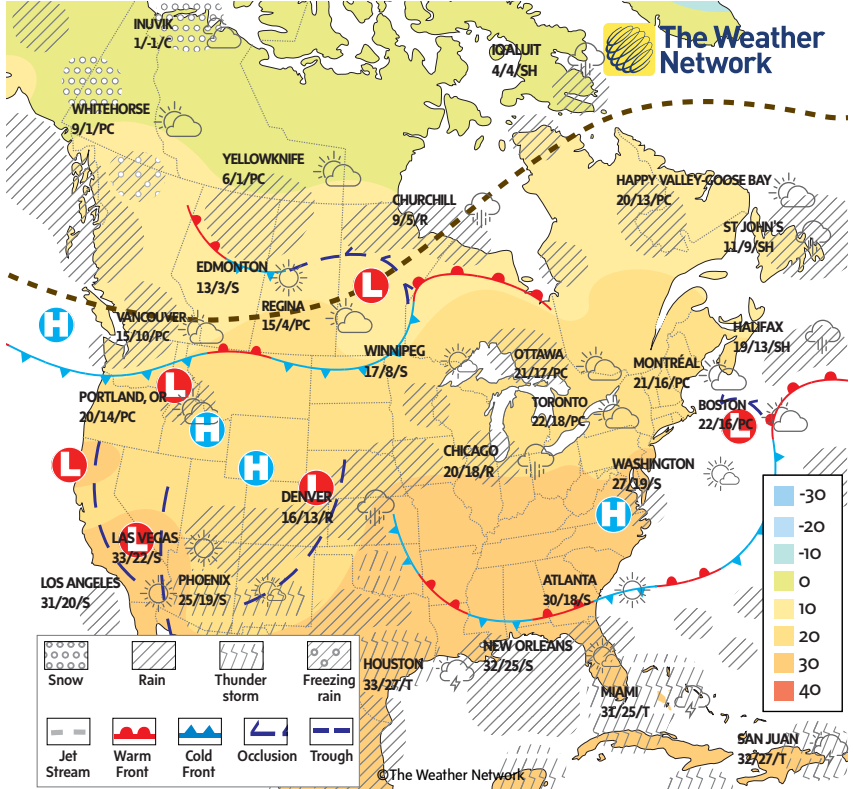
LEGEND

Daytime high, overnight low, and conditions

C CLOUDY	RS RAIN/SNOW
FG FOG	S SUN
FR FREEZING RAIN	SN SNOW
HZ HAZE	SF SNOW FLURRIES
NA NOT AVAILABLE	SH SHOWERS
PC PARTLY CLOUDY	T THUNDERSTORMS
R RAIN	W WINDY

NATIONAL FORECAST

	TODAY	TOMORROW	FRIDAY
BANFF	8/0 S	12/3 PC	12/3 SH
BARRIE	23/17 PC	22/13 SH	17/6 PC
BRANDON	15/6 PC	16/4 S	16/7 PC
CALGARY	13/3 PC	13/5 PC	16/5 SH
CHARLOTTETOWN	16/12 PC	20/16 S	19/11 SH
CHICOUTIMI	21/13 PC	20/10 R	14/6 PC
CHURCHILL	9/6 R	6/4 SH	6/2 SH
CORNER BROOK	16/7 PC	17/12 S	15/8 R
CORNWALL	21/16 PC	24/15 PC	19/8 PC
EDMONTON	13/3 S	14/5 S	15/5 PC
HALIFAX	18/13 C	20/15 PC	22/13 PC
HAMILTON	23/18 PC	23/14 PC	19/9 SH
HUNTSVILLE	21/16 C	20/10 R	16/5 PC
ICALLUIT	4/4 SH	5/2 R	4/1 SH
JASPER	10/1 PC	12/2 PC	13/2 SH
KELOWNA	15/8 S	15/9 SH	17/7 SH
KINGSTON	21/18 PC	23/16 PC	19/10 SH
LONDON	23/18 PC	23/13 SH	18/8 SH
MONTREAL	21/15 PC	23/15 PC	19/9 PC
NIAGARA FALLS	22/18 PC	24/15 PC	18/10 R
NORTH BAY	20/15 PC	19/8 R	15/4 PC
OTTAWA	22/16 PC	24/13 PC	19/7 PC
PRINCE GEORGE	13/1 S	14/4 PC	15/2 PC
PETERBOROUGH	21/17 PC	22/13 SH	18/7 PC
QUERÉBEC	19/13 PC	22/13 SH	19/7 PC
REGINA	15/5 PC	15/6 PC	16/7 SH
SASKATOON	15/5 PC	15/6 S	16/7 PC
SAULT STE MARIE	17/16 R	18/10 PC	15/6 S
SAINT JOHN	19/12 PC	20/15 S	21/11 SH
SEPTÎLES	12/8 PC	15/11 SH	15/7 S
ST JOHN'S	12/9 SH	16/12 PC	16/11 PC
SUBURBY	20/15 SH	19/8 R	16/4 PC
THUNDER BAY	23/12 S	17/7 PC	15/5 S
THOMPSON	10/4 SH	6/2 R	10/3 PC
TORONTO	22/18 PC	24/15 PC	18/11 R
VAL-D'OR	21/15 PC	19/9 R	15/5 SH
VANCOUVER	15/10 PC	16/12 PC	18/12 PC
VICTORIA	16/11 PC	16/12 PC	18/12 S
WHISTLER	13/5 S	14/9 SH	16/9 PC
WHITEHORSE	9/1 PC	8/0 S	6/1 RS
WINNIPEG	17/8 S	15/4 S	16/8 S
YELLOWKNIFE	6/1 PC	7/3 PC	7/2 PC



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UNIVERSAL CROSSWORD READY FOR SOME FOOTBALL? BY DREW SCHMENNER

ACROSS

1 Kind of basin or wave

6 “___ Sutra”

10 Slug’s sound?

13 “Am not!” response

14 Knowledgeable about, as a prank

15 ‘20s skyscraper style

16 Interception and inaccuracy?

19 “Star Wars” bar scene characters, briefly

20 “The Pitt” star Wyle

21 Group of eight

22 Spitting contest projectile

24 ___-mo (iPhone camera setting)

25 “Be there ___ sec”

26 “I’m going deep,” e.g.?

32 Sicilian peak

33 Oxen connector

34 Incensed

35 Rattle, for example

38 Matching up

40 Obama health law, for short

41 Have a debt

42 “In my estimation ...”

43 Mahomes, Brady and Manning?

48 “The loneliest number,” in an oldie

49 Fishing rod attachment

50 Four of a kind in a winning hand?

53 It can bone or pare things

56 Identical

57 Polka ___

58 Bachelor’s residence

59 Halfback who fumbles all the time?

63 Word after “olive” or “coconut”

64 Bridge lengths

65 Rhyming toon brother of Huey and Dewey

66 Practice, as a trade

67 Valuable government asset?

68 Coming up

DOWN

1 They may be played on a boom box

2 Absolutely incensed

3 Station at a banquet with sweets galore

4 Real piece of work

5 Cut of beef

6 Capital of Rwanda

7 Salty Caesar salad morsel

8 Cow’s sound

9 Raggedy ___

10 Muppet with a unibrow

11 Clearasil target

12 The majority

15 Sticker on a helmet

17 It sniffs and snorts

18 Easy to be around

23 Refuse to admit

25 Jet-black

27 They love their furballs

28 It gives Siri her voice

29 “Remind me to go next time”

30 Mama’s mama

31 Like many an indie film

32 Apiece

35 Flutter, as eyelashes

36 Toddler’s minor injury

37 Japanese currency

39 Burned digital medium, in brief

44 “That had to hurt!”

45 Mama’s mama

46 18-wheelers

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EDITED BY DAVID STEINBERG

47 Many a new driver

51 Finnish telecom giant

52 Like a strenuous hike

53 “___ Demon Hunters” (2025 hit movie)

54 Manicurist’s canvas

55 Without much purpose

56 Crackle and Pop’s partner

60 FedEx rival

61 Day-___ paint

62 Rock star Bon Jovi

BRIDGE

BY STEVE BECKER

WEDNESDAY, SEPTEMBER 30, 2026

East dealer.

Both sides vulnerable.

The bidding:

East

Pass

South

1 NT

West

Pass

North

3 NT

Opening Lead – queen of hearts.

NORTH

♠ K 8

♥ K 5

♦ A J 5 4 3

♣ 7 6 3 2

WEST

♠ Q 7 3

♥ Q J 10 9 2

♦ 8

♣ K 10 5 4

EAST

♠ J 10 5 2

♥ 8 6 4

♦ Q 10 7 6

♣ Q 9

SOUTH

♠ A 9 6 4

♥ A 7 3

♦ K 9 2

♣ A J 8

Safety plays take many forms, but the underlying principle is the same: In order to protect against an unfavourable distribution of the adverse cards, declarer risks losing a trick he might not have to lose.

Safety plays need not be memorized. They should suggest themselves when a threatening set of circumstances arises.

In this deal, South sees he has only seven tricks immediately available at three notrump, and the best source of additional tricks lies in the diamond suit.

The normal way of approaching the diamonds is to cash the king and lead low toward the A-J, intending to finesse the jack. This method is designed to gain the maximum number of diamond tricks.

Playing the diamonds in this fashion does not protect against the possibility that East was dealt four diamonds to the Q-10. Since South will most likely not be able to make the contract, he should guard against this.

He can protect himself by winning the opening heart lead in his hand and playing a low diamond to the ace. When both opponents follow, the contract becomes assured. A low diamond is next returned from dummy.

If East shows out, South wins with the king and leads a diamond toward the jack to assure four diamond tricks. If East follows with a low diamond, declarer plays the nine. If West wins the trick, it means the diamonds were divided 3-2 and the contract is made. If West does not win the trick, four diamond tricks are again certain.

It doesn’t help East to play the 10 on the second diamond in the actual deal. In that case, South wins the king and returns the nine to produce the same result.

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CRYPTIC CROSSWORD

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ACROSS

1 Lot of crumbly feta (4)

3 Fish alongside boats in area with many bays (3,5)

8 Advice from governing body announced (7)

10 Plunder gun (5)

11 General visiting one running magazine, perhaps (11)

13 Found earth in box (6)

15 Boss I love in workplace? (6)

17 Supply Liberian oil for Donald Trump? (11)

20 Vessel blocking that road to the west (5)

21 I retain strange disinclination to move (7)

22 Stage one in development? (5,3)

23 Summons comedian over start of routine (4)

DOWN

1 Confront group for cosmetic treatment (4,4)

2 Digital lift-share organiser? (5)

4 Oscar moves into first-class accommodation aboard ship (6)

5 Its presence affected determination (11)

6 Checked entertaining female is urbane (9)

7 Appear in diocese before mass (4)

9 Be naughty, stopping at 20:00, reportedly, and sparkle (11)

12 Expectation for European project (8)

14 Bag more bananas in prohibition (7)

16 Strenuous sex over phone (6)

18 Playwright leaving quietly in Bury (5)

19 Defile father and second son (4)

SUDOKU DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★☆☆☆

INSTRUCTIONS
Fill in the grid so that each row of nine squares, each column of nine and each section of nine (three squares by three) contains the numbers 1 through 9 in any order. There is only one solution to each puzzle.

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KENKEN

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INSTRUCTIONS

- Each row and each column must contain the numbers 1 through 6 without repeating.
- The numbers within the heavily outlined boxes, called cages, must combine using the given operation (in any order) to produce the target numbers in the top-left corners.
- Freebies: Fill in single-box cages with the numbers in the top-left corner.

SOLUTIONS

YESTERDAY’S UNIVERSAL CROSSWORD

B I C E P

P A P I

A G O

O M A N I

L I O N

B R R

B U R G E R

A N D

F R I E S

A P P

P E N T

A I D Y

B A C O N

A N D

E G G S

A D D O N S

O N T

O O H

B E A N

T W O

S L O T H

B A N G E R S

A N D

M A S H

O T C

P O K Y

O A S E S

T H E

U S A

I O U

S H R I M P

A N D

G R I T S

S T A L L

O V A L

O C H O

P A L

O R D E R E D

P A I R

I R L

N O I R E

V E R N E

N E S

D A T A

D R E G S

YESTERDAY’S CRYPTIC CROSSWORD

P O S T C A R D

G R U B

A L

O E

E I

S T E R N

P A R A S O L

S E T

A E E

G

A M P

R E I N F O R C E

G

A R

R V

E S C A P E

P I G E O N

O T

S G

I

L O N G I T U D E

B A G

O C

O P

R L

H

T R A I N E E

A B O U T

T V

R T

A I

O M E N

A B S E N T E E

Solutions to today’s Sudoku and Kenken can be found in the Life & Arts content area of the A section. Crossword solutions will be with tomorrow’s puzzles.

[VANCOUVER]



Showing his chops

Master carver Mark George, right, of the Tsileil-Waututh Nation and Kenny Galvani from the Dakota Nation – Birdtail Sioux perform a live canoe-carving demonstration at the Roundhouse Arts & Recreation Centre in Vancouver on Tuesday

JUSTINE BEAULIEU-POUDRIER / THE GLOBE AND MAIL

Pipeline: Consultation requirement may cause complications

■ FROM A1

“They need to finish that work. I have every reason to believe they will do the work and get it done on time,” he said.

“But we’re not going to prejudge that. They’ve got to do the work.”

A decade’s worth of federal Liberal climate and energy policies under Mr. Carney’s predecessor, Justin Trudeau, stoked separatist sentiment in Alberta that this year boiled over into an impending referendum. Voters will decide on Oct. 19 whether to remain in Canada or lay the legal groundwork for a second, binding referendum on splitting up the country.

The pipeline is a large part of Mr. Carney’s response to the secessionist campaign. The conduit would also reduce Canada’s reliance on the U.S. market, where more than 85 per cent of the country’s oil goes – an attractive prospect given the fractious trade relationship.

When the Prime Minister first announced the potential pipeline in 2025, he said it would have to be “private sector constructed and financed.” However, when the project was finally revealed in July, the government said that taxpayers would foot the bill. Ottawa and Alberta agreed to split the vast majority of the costs. The only private-sector player is Pembina Pipeline Corp., which made a non-binding agreement to take a 10-per cent stake during construction.

Oil, gas and business executives close to the federal and provincial governments told The Globe that they expect the Carney government will follow through on its pledge to designate the pipeline as a project of national importance this week.

Pointing to the coming separation referendum, they indicated that it was unlikely that Ottawa would delay a designation with the future of Alberta’s ties to Canada in question.

The Prime Minister’s Office declined a request for comment on Tuesday from The Globe.

The government has repeatedly said that hastening approval processes under the new rules would not trump the requirement for Indigenous consultation. However, the three months between the July announcement of the proposed pipeline route and the Oct. 1 designation left little time to consult with the more than

100 Indigenous groups along the line’s potential right of way.

One source with direct knowledge of the outreach from the MPO to some of the Indigenous groups said they believed Ottawa is getting ahead of itself if it plans to move ahead with the national interest designation on Thursday.

They said such a timeline would mean full consultations are not yet complete, and they questioned whether the move would be consistent with the language in the Building Canada Act.

The Globe is not identifying the source who was not permitted to disclose details of confidential talks.

One of the groups opposing the fast timeline for the designation of the West Coast pipeline as a project of national importance is the Coldwater Indian Band, in B.C. The group also opposed the Trans Mountain Expansion Project owing to concerns about risks to the community’s aquifer.

On behalf of the band, Vice-Chief Michael Smithers said in an e-mail that there has been a lack of meaningful consultation between the community and the Major Projects Office about the new pipeline.

While the MPO extended the band’s deadline to submit its concerns over the project, after the community spent two of the past three months in a wildfire state of emergency, the community’s Sept. 18 request to delay the national interest designation received no response as of Tuesday afternoon, he said.

In an interview, Mark Podlasly, the CEO of the First Nations Major Project Coalition, said his group does not have a formal position on the new pipeline but he stressed the need for Indigenous people to be meaningfully involved from the start.

“If you do not include Indigenous people from the beginning, in all projects, you may run into trouble later,” he said.

He said the First Nations in his coalition want to participate in the projects in their territories, but it requires involvement in all aspects of the project, including environmental and economic. Mr. Podlasly briefed Mr. Carney’s cabinet at its recent retreat in Banff, Alta.

The British Columbia government also opposed a new pipeline to the West Coast, but it said it would not challenge the fed-

eral project because it falls within Ottawa’s jurisdiction. In July, Mr. Carney extended an olive branch to the province in the form of funding for various other major projects and initiatives in B.C.

Mr. Carney was in Vancouver Tuesday to announce \$1.2-billion to increase ocean monitoring, strengthen science and ecosystem protections, and improve marine incident prevention.

During his press conference, the Prime Minister tried to make the case that his government can protect the environment and sensitive ecosystems while at the same time building massive new projects.

The Alberta government has been pushing hard to get the West Coast pipeline designated as a project of national importance, arguing that the conduit would reduce Canada’s reliance on the U.S. market and allow Alberta oil to access higher international crude prices.

Speaking at an energy services industry event in Calgary on Monday, Premier Danielle Smith said she expected a designation decision from the federal government “very soon.”

“My chief of staff Rob Anderson is here in the room, and I keep asking him if I should lower the expectations around an October 1 conditional approval, and he keeps telling me ‘No,’” she said.

“We expect the project to receive the green light, which will unlock Alberta’s energy potential.”

Not only is Ms. Smith expecting a nod from Ottawa, she said she is also “feeling more and more confident every day” that the West Coast oil pipeline could be one of the first major projects to begin construction.

“I anticipated when we started our conversation with the federal government that it might be a little bit further down the line,” Ms. Smith said. But the recent turmoil in global energy markets caused by conflicts in the Middle East and Ukraine has countries around the world searching for more stable fuel supplies – and they’re looking to Canada as an option, she said.

“So I think that there’s been an urge on the part of the country, on the part of the federal government, to get that one built,” she said.

With a report from Mike Hager

CHARGES FILED OVER UNIVERSITY OF GUELPH HOMECOMING PARTY

After an off-campus University of Guelph homecoming party descended into chaos last weekend, other Ontario universities say they are working to minimize the impacts of similar upcoming events.

The unsanctioned party in Guelph on Saturday risked the safety of students and neighbours, university president Rene Van Acker said in a statement.

Videos circulating online show massive crowds of young people filling the streets, and some of them throwing bottles and other items as police officers tried to control the situation. The videos also show police putting some people in handcuffs.

Guelph Police said officers laid several criminal and provincial charges, including causing a disturbance and numerous alcohol-related offences.

Guelph is not the only university town that has at times struggled to contain rowdy off-campus parties in the fall.

In Ottawa, the annual Panda Game between Carleton University and the University of Ottawa football teams is taking place this weekend and Carleton said it recognizes the event can affect nearby communities.

Postgame misbehaviour in recent years included people flipping a car and stealing street signs, and has sent several people to the hospital.

Another homecoming party is scheduled in Kingston, starting on Oct. 16 for Queen’s University students and alumni.

A spokesperson for the school said preparations for the event include planning and co-ordination with the city, police, student leaders and groups across the university.

THE CANADIAN PRESS

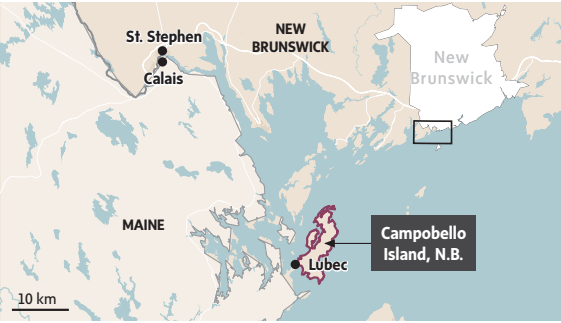
Trade: Mayor blames Trump for the situation, not his Maine neighbours

■ FROM A1

He said this supply truck was allowed to operate unimpeded during the COVID-19 pandemic as well as in the weeks following the terrorist attacks of Sept. 11, 2001, that snarled border traffic. The island is accessible by bridge from the Maine town of Lubec.

Mr. Matthews said he has remained friendly and positive about the United States during the trade dispute and is puzzled why these restrictions are affecting a truck sealed with a customs tag that is merely delivering goods to Canadians.

“Mark Carney probably has no clue where Campobello is. It’s not like it’s gonna make that big of a



THE GLOBE AND MAIL, SOURCE: OPENTREETMAP

deal in these trade talks.”

The mayor said his neighbours in Maine are not to blame for this.

It’s “one guy,” he said, referring to Mr. Trump. Mr. Matthews said he never supported anti-American

actions, including taking down U.S. flags. “These are our neighbours, like close neighbours. We don’t live kilometres away. We live a short bridge away.”

John Williamson, the Conservative MP for New Brunswick Southwest, whose riding includes Campobello Island, said he’s talking to the Department of Global Affairs and Pete Hoekstra, the U.S. ambassador to Canada, in hopes of resolving the matter.

“This is not how two neighbours and friends should treat one another,” Mr. Williamson said. He said cross-border communities in his area share fire and emergency services.

“The relations between communities along the Maine-New

Brunswick border are deep,” the MP said. “This really isolates Campobello.”

A spokesperson for the U.S. embassy in Ottawa said they are looking into the matter.

Campobello Island is home to the Roosevelt Campobello International Park, which celebrates relations between Canada and the U.S. The park’s website says it’s a “singular example of international co-operation – jointly administered, staffed and funded by the peoples of Canada and the United States.”

It’s the location of the Roosevelt Cottage, the summer home of the family of former U.S. president Franklin D. Roosevelt and his wife, Eleanor.

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REPORT ON BUSINESS

OTTAWA/QUEBEC EDITION

WEDNESDAY, SEPTEMBER 30, 2026

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DOW

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-131.59

S&P 500

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-12.85

NASDAQ

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-22.84

DOLLAR

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GOLD (oz.)

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+11.30

OIL (WTI)

US\$89.38

-3.22

GCAN (10-YR)

3.99%

+0.03

Canada must step up efforts to fight money laundering, watchdog says

ALEXANDRA POSADZKI
FINANCIAL AND CYBERCRIME
REPORTER

Canada’s anti-financial-crime regime received a passing grade from the Financial Action Task Force, but the country needs to step up its investigation and prosecution of complex money-laundering cases, according to a highly anticipated report from the global financial watchdog.

The evaluation of Canada’s ability to tackle financial crime took place over 14 months, culminating with a three-week on-site visit last November. The assessors, a team made up of individuals from other jurisdictions including Britain, Italy, Australia and China, interviewed more than 700 representatives from the federal and provincial governments, the private sector and non-profit organizations.

The review placed Canada in the regular follow-up category, rather than the enhanced review process that requires additional assessments of a country’s remedial actions. That represents an improvement from the last mutual evaluation of Canada’s financial-crime controls in 2016, when the country was placed on enhanced follow-up.

■ LAUNDERING, B8

Rita Trichur Why Canada deserves a rebuke from the global task forces ■ B4

LNG Canada backers expect many decades of demand for natural gas

JEFFREY JONES CALGARY

Shell PLC and its partners in the LNG Canada project are banking on decades of rising demand for liquefied natural gas as they proceed with a more than \$30-billion expansion of the facility on the B.C. coast.

Wars in Iran and Ukraine have disrupted global gas supplies and driven up prices, but the decision to double the capacity of the plant in Kitimat, B.C., is predicated on a longer-term transition away from more carbon-intensive fossil fuels, LNG Canada chief executive Chris Cooper said on Tuesday.

“You may argue that there’s some uncertainty right now, but if you look at that long-term demand profile and then the long-term outlook, we think we’ll invest through that cycle,” Mr. Cooper said in an interview. “So that element’s there – generating cash flow for decades. That’s the way we look at these projects.”

Shell said LNG Canada Phase 2, which got the green light from its partners on Tuesday, is one of many such plants that will be required in the coming decades. The company said it expects global LNG demand to increase 65 per cent to nearly 700 million tonnes a year by 2050. Mr. Cooper said some estimates are even higher.

■ LNG, B8

COMPANIES	
ARTIZIA	B10
GOOGLE	B3
MICROSOFT	B3
NVIDIA	B3
OPENAI	B3



A drone photograph taken Tuesday of Stelco’s Hamilton Works, which is owned by Cleveland-Cliffs. The company said Monday it was laying off a total of up to 500 workers at Stelco’s Hamilton plant and its Lake Erie Works operation in Nanticoke, Ont. CARLOS OSORIO/REUTERS

Cleveland-Cliffs may face legal action from Ottawa over Stelco layoffs

NIALL MCGEE
MINING REPORTER

U.S. steelmaker **Cleveland-Cliffs Inc.** could face legal action from Ottawa for violating job commitments stemming from its 2024 acquisition of Stelco Holdings Inc. after announcing hundreds of layoffs in Canada on Monday, but the devil will be in the details, a legal expert told The Globe and Mail.

In 2024, the Cleveland-based company announced its intentions to buy Stelco for \$3.4-billion. The federal government approved the transaction, but only after imposing a series of legally binding conditions on Cliffs.

Those included Cliffs promising to maintain for five years at least the same number of unionized employees and the vast majority of non-unionized employees.

Cliffs on Monday said it was laying off a total of up to 500 workers at Stelco’s Hamilton plant and its Lake Erie Works operation

in Nanticoke, Ont. The company said the layoffs were necessary to ensure the company’s survival during the trade war with the United States.

Some of the workers affected by the layoffs will be offered jobs at Lake Erie Works, but the number won’t be nearly enough to fill the void left by the cuts.

Ron Wells, president of United Steelworkers Local 1005, said that there are only 46 openings at Nanticoke and he is now pushing for Ottawa to hold Cliffs to its promise to maintain employment levels.

“We’re hopeful that the Canadian government enforces the Investment Canada Act,” he said. That act stipulates that major investments into Canada by foreign companies should benefit the domestic economy.

The Globe asked the office of Industry Minister Mélanie Joly whether the government considers Cliffs to be in violation of its commitments, and whether it is intending to sue the steelmaker.

“Stelco and Cleveland-Cliffs have made significant commitments to Canadian steelworkers,” Gabrielle Landry, deputy director, media relations with the office of Ms. Joly wrote in an e-mail.

“We will use every lever possible to defend Canadian industry, protect jobs, and secure our supply chain.”

Cliffs did not respond to a request for comment.

Subrata Bhattacharjee, national chair of the competition and foreign investment review group with Borden Ladner Gervais LLP, said that without knowing the details of the legal agreement between the company and Ottawa it is impossible to know with certainty whether Cliffs is offside.

“Until you actually see the agreement, you can’t really say for sure,” he said.

At the very least, however, he believes Ms. Joly will be having a conversation with the company around the promises it made in the agreement.

■ STELCO, B8

Bond yields, AI, oil prices: Don’t let the scary stuff chase you out of the stock market

TIM SHUFELT
OPINION

It’s a nerve-racking time to have money riding on the stock market.

Bonds are flashing stress signals. Higher borrowing costs are bearing down on a world awash in debt. The oil shock in the Middle East is reigniting inflation. Superintelligent machines are apparently coming to obliterate the human race. And can you believe these gas prices?

It’s tough to shake the feeling that something is about to break. A steady supply of bearish commentary adds to the sense that a golden age for investors is nearing its end. Did you hear that U.S. investor Michael Burry, famous for betting

against Wall Street prior to the global financial crisis, has just moved up his timeline for the AI crash?

What’s not being talked about much any more are the excellent reasons to stay invested. Stock valuations have been dropping for the past year, for example, and not just by a little bit – hardly what you would expect to see in the middle of a speculative frenzy.

“Technology equities have not experienced a classic bubble because valuation levels are much lower than in previous financial bubbles,” Goldman Sachs analysts wrote in their latest strategy note.

Plus, corporate earnings are booming globally. And balance sheets are generally healthy.

Before you get spooked out of the stock market altogether, consider the positives.

THE STOCK MARKET HAS GOTTEN CHEAPER, EVEN AS MAJOR INDEXES HAVE CLIMBED HIGHER

There are two forces, broadly speaking, that drive the stock market higher over time. Either the companies in the index in question make more money. Or, investors collectively decide they’re happy to pay more for each dollar of those earnings. Or both.

When things get really nutty, the investing masses become willing to pay virtually any amount, sending trading multiples through the roof. This is the classic bubble scenario.

That’s not what’s happening now.

So far this year, the S&P 500 index has risen by 12 per cent.

■ SHUFELT, B4



TECHNOLOGY
AI executives and Trump sign ‘morally binding’ agreement to self-regulate the sector ■ B3

KEVIN DIETSCH/
GETTY IMAGES

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Alberta separation would be far messier than Brexit, economist warns ■ B2

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Insolvencies are back to prepandemic levels, but something has changed ■ B9

Growth flattens in July as volatility sets in

GDP weakness follows second-quarter rebound; early estimate points to 0.2% growth in August as U.S. tariffs took hold

OTTAWA

Economic growth cooled off ahead of the latest U.S. tariff volley this summer, Statistics Canada said Tuesday.

The agency said real gross domestic product was essentially unchanged in July. Strength in construction and utilities that month was offset by declines elsewhere in the economy.

TD Bank economist Marc Ercolao said stalled growth in July isn't alarming. Some of the month's declines in manufacturing and the mining and quarrying sector were attributed to one-off factors like production disruptions, he noted.

"It's part of the broader volatility that we've seen in Canadian growth," Mr. Ercolao said.

Offsetting the weakness in July was a 1.3-per-cent gain for the construction sector, which marked its fourth consecutive month of growth after declines in late 2025 and early 2026.

Non-residential building construction saw its best month since the start of 2022, Statscan said, owing primarily to activity around a new hospital building in Toronto.

Statscan also said a 1.7-per-cent surge in electricity generation, transmission and distribution powered the utilities sector to its strongest month of growth all year. A July heat wave across many parts of the country drove up power demands for cooling, the agency said.

On the other side, declines in July were spread across manufacturing, mining, quarrying and oil



A worker sands the arm of an Adirondack chair at a factory in Kemptville, Ont. Manufacturing was among the sectors of the economy that posted declines in July. ADRIAN WYLD/THE CANADIAN PRESS

and gas extraction, as well as retail and wholesale trade.

Estimates for flat growth to start the third quarter come after Statscan projected an annualized growth rate of 3.3 per cent in the second quarter.

Newly revised data showed GDP was actually up 0.4 per cent in June, compared with earlier estimates of 0.3 per cent.

Statscan expects the economy picked back up with a gain of 0.2 per cent in August, but those early figures will be revised next month.

The August GDP figures will partially capture the impact of new 50-per-cent U.S. tariffs applied on a range of Canadian goods starting Aug. 22.

"The August pickup reinforces our view that the Canadian economy was enjoying a decent mid-year recovery before the latest U.S. tariffs took effect," said Peter

Shannon, senior economist at KPMG, in a note.

Mr. Shannon said he expects the bite from the new U.S. duties to meaningfully hit in September and take full effect in the fourth quarter. KPMG projects GDP will be about half a percentage point lower over the course of a year should the tariffs remain in effect.

Tuesday also marks the beginning of new retaliatory U.S. bans on Canadian products such as alcohol, dairy products and motorcycles.

Mr. Ercolao said the up-and-down nature of Canadian growth reflects that the economy has settled into a "sawtooth" pattern since the start of last year.

He said he expects August's GDP figures will also get a boost from the latest trade swings. Some U.S. importers were likely rushing to get ahead of new tariffs on Canadian goods early in the

month, but that lift will reverse come September.

Hits to manufacturing and wholesale trade in July also suggest the trade dispute continues to weigh heavily on vulnerable sectors, Mr. Ercolao said.

"You take it all together and the biggest take-away is that Canada appears to be [settling] into a more moderate growth pattern after a quite robust second quarter," he said.

Benjamin Reitzes, BMO's managing director of Canadian rates and macro strategist, said in a note to clients Tuesday that the August advance has him tracking GDP growth of 1.5 to 2 per cent in the third quarter of the year. That's roughly in line with the Bank of Canada's forecast for 1.5 per cent in the quarter, he noted.

New tariffs create some roadblocks for the economy, but Mr. Reitzes said fiscal policy changes

like Ottawa's move to expand investment incentives will help support growth.

"The Canadian economy continues to hang in there despite the ongoing trade headwinds," Mr. Reitzes said.

The Bank of Canada will get a look at new jobs and inflation data for September, as well as a read of its own quarterly surveys of businesses and consumers, before making its next interest rate announcement on Oct. 28.

Mr. Reitzes suggested these data prints will be more impactful for the central bank's decision than the July GDP release.

The Bank of Canada has held its benchmark interest rate steady at 2.25 per cent for nearly a year.

Monetary policy makers are trying to support the economy through tariff impacts but have signalled they're prepared to raise the policy rate if there are signs inflationary pressures are spreading beyond the gas pumps.

Mr. Ercolao said he doesn't see Tuesday's release as moving the needle for the Bank of Canada, which he expects will remain on pause for the rest of the year before starting to raise the policy rate in 2027.

Financial markets are increasingly pricing in Bank of Canada rate hikes as persistently high oil prices stoke fears of stubborn inflation. Odds of a hike at the end of next month stood at 53 per cent as of Tuesday afternoon, according to LSEG Data & Analytics.

Mr. Ercolao said he doesn't think monetary policy makers will be in a rush to raise rates as they navigate a soft economy and inflationary risks.

"In balancing these two factors, we do think that they have a little bit more time afforded to sit on the sidelines, see how the recent or the upcoming data evolves, and then make policy decisions based on that," he said.

THE CANADIAN PRESS

Bed Bath & Beyond Canada relaunches online under new ownership

TARA DESCHAMPS

Bed Bath & Beyond Canada's new owner is hoping to use online shopping to wake up the dormant brand before it makes a brick-and-mortar comeback.

Sleep Country Canada relaunched the home goods retailer Tuesday through an e-commerce website expected to precede stores opening next year.

The online revival comes about a year after Sleep Country purchased the Canadian and U.K. rights to the Bed Bath & Beyond name and logos from Overstock.com.

The online marketplace had picked up the trademarks in 2023, after Bed Bath & Beyond Canada filed for creditor protection and closed its stores amid "dramatic" declines in revenue. The U.S. arm of the company followed suit a few months later.

The retailer's new Canadian iteration aims to revive the most cherished elements of the brand's past but also take a more curated approach befitting an evolving market with the rise of e-commerce, new competitors such as H&M Home and Simons, the loss of Hudson's Bay and sluggish home sales.

"We feel the timing is right and we feel like the market is ready for what we are doing," Bed Bath & Beyond Canada president Carol Deacon said.

"There are endless options online ... and there's also a lot of other physical retail where there's some very distinct styles and designs, but we think there's an opportunity to make sure there's a bit more choice."

The new business will stock about 6,000 products in classic Bed Bath & Beyond categories like kitchen, decor, bedroom and bathroom, but also mix in trendier and domestic brands consumers are demanding.

That means shoppers will find KitchenAid, Umbra and Calvin Klein products alongside merchandise from Lacoste, Smeg and Sleep Country affiliates Endy, Bloom, Simba, and Silk and Snow.

While many parts of the Bed Bath & Beyond Canada business won't dramatically change, two areas are being revamped significantly: furniture and baby.

The company is paring back on furniture, at least initially, because there's a lot of competitors out there and it's a category that is difficult for shipping, Deacon said.

With baby, it wants to focus more narrowly on products consumers could use to prepare their home for an infant rather than on everything tots would need.

"For us to come up with an offering across the home that we really were proud and comfortable with, we just went a bit narrower in some areas, but we know we will be expanding over time," Ms. Deacon said.

That expansion will also eventually bring back the brick-and-mortar stores most customers remember Bed Bath & Beyond for.

The brand is still working out its store strategy but is on track to open a first location in late 2027, she said.

When it faltered in 2023, the company had 54 Bed Bath & Beyond stores and 11 BuyBuy Baby locations.

Ms. Deacon signalled that the brand is unlikely to have the same kind of store count or hulking properties it once did.

"It will likely be a lot more focused than it was historically for Bed Bath & Beyond in terms of footprint and store size," she said.

“We feel the timing is right and we feel like the market is ready for what we are doing.”

CAROL DEACON
BED BATH & BEYOND
CANADA PRESIDENT

EMMA GRANEY
ENERGY REPORTER

The years-long trade wrangling and uncertainty that faced Britain in the wake of the Brexit vote was a "cakewalk" compared with what Alberta's separation from Canada would involve, according to the author of a new report about the economic implications of secession.

Trevor Tombe, a University of Calgary economist, penned the report for the Calgary Chamber of Commerce. Released Tuesday in the midst of a heated campaign over provincial separation, the analysis concluded that investment in Alberta could fall between 12 and 18 per cent if the province pursues secession, and coffers risk swinging from a \$19-billion annual surplus to a \$9-billion deficit.

Voters are preparing to decide on Oct. 19 whether to remain in Canada or lay the legal groundwork for a second, binding referendum on separation.

At the heart of Prof. Tombe's report is a warning about just how trade-exposed Alberta's economy is, and the extent to which jobs and investment in the province rely on good relationships with Canada and other countries.

The sharp rise in political and economic uncertainty that faced Britain after it voted to leave the European Union – labelled Brexit – is often cited as an example of the challenges that could face Alberta should it leave Canada.

Investment in Britain is between 12 to 18 per cent lower now than it would have otherwise been as a result of Brexit, "primarily because it's prudent to pause costly decisions that are difficult to reverse," Prof. Tombe told media in Calgary on Tuesday.

But "Brexit would be a cakewalk compared to what Alberta separation would involve," he said, because it would be "very different than just unwinding a deep free-trade agreement, which was essentially what Brexit was."

Alberta is one of Canada's most trade-dependent economies. Nearly one in three workers – roughly 900,000 people – are in a sector with significant exposure to trade with other provinces or countries, according to the report.

Those trade-exposed jobs reach far beyond oil and gas; positions that support exports com-

prise more than 346,000 jobs across manufacturing, finance, real estate, professional services, tourism and agriculture. Excluding oil and gas, international exports account for approximately 15 per cent of Alberta's total income.

Interprovincial trade generates about \$78-billion in income for Alberta workers and businesses, or roughly 16 cents of every dollar earned in the province. Exports account for about 39 per cent of total provincial income, or nearly \$180-billion.

Investment in Britain is between 12 to 18 per cent lower now than it would have otherwise been as a result of Brexit, 'primarily because it's prudent to pause costly decisions that are difficult to reverse,' Prof. Tombe told media in Calgary on Tuesday.

Those who support separation often point to equalization payments, citing the roughly \$20-billion a year in taxes from businesses and individuals in Alberta that flows into federal coffers then on to other provinces.

"They look at that and see it as a fiscal windfall that would be available if Alberta were to separate," Prof. Tombe said.

But separation would also reduce the size of the economy, according to his analysis, which means lower revenues from income taxes and higher costs "just to execute the core functions of a now-separate country."

Closing the resulting fiscal gap "would mean real trade-offs for Albertans: significantly higher taxes, deep cuts to the services families and businesses rely on, or some combination of both," said Deborah Yedlin, chief executive officer of the Calgary Chamber of Commerce.

"That Alberta advantage that we've been so proud of all these years would evaporate in an instant," she said.

Multinational companies have a swath of choices as to where they can invest their long-cycle cash, Ms. Yedlin said, and Alberta needs to make the case that it's a

safe bet for the next 30, 40 years.

"That investment thesis has to stand up, and that's where businesses are going to be very focused in terms of what comes next."

Tuesday's report comes alongside an open letter, signed by 11 high-profile executives in the province, urging Albertans to choose to remain in Canada.

Among the signatories are AltaGas CEO Vern Yu; Nancy Southern, CEO at ATCO Ltd.; Alta-Link president Paul Lee and Dean Setoguchi, the CEO of Keyera.

Tuesday's report joins a slew of other separation analyses that drew similar results about substantial economic risks to Alberta.

The University of Calgary's School of Public Policy earlier this month published a sweeping report on the various costs of Alberta abandoning Confederation and becoming a sovereign country. (Prof. Tombe also helped author that report.)

The study, commissioned by Premier Danielle Smith's government, found that separation would likely cost the province billions and carry grim economic consequences: lower wages, declining GDP and billions in new government debt.

The C.D. Howe Institute, a policy research organization, has published a series of reports focused on problems an independent Alberta would face. The Canada West Foundation, a Calgary-based think tank, published a 137-page report in September that concluded the "uncertainty is too great and the risks too significant for Alberta to pursue independence from Canada."

Separatist groups have published their own estimates, concluding that Alberta would be in a far better position if it left Canada.

The Alberta Transition Council, a group led by independence leader and lawyer Keith Wilson, paints a rosier picture of separation in a report it released last week.

The report was authored by Mr. Wilson and Dennis Kalma, a retired executive. The two have kept secret the identities of those involved in writing it "to respect professional, employment and personal considerations," the ATC's website says.

With a report from Matthew Scaze in Calgary

THE CANADIAN PRESS



U.S. President Donald Trump, surrounded by AI executives on Tuesday, portrayed the race to develop AI as a competition between the U.S. and China. KEVIN DIETSCH/GETTY IMAGES

Trump, AI execs agree on self-regulation for technology

U.S. President vows never to restrict development despite calls for caution

CHRISTOPHER RUGABER
WILL WEISSERT
MEG KINNARD WASHINGTON

U.S. President Donald Trump on Tuesday said that he and a large group of leaders of artificial intelligence companies had signed a voluntary accord that will include internal and external reviews of the technology during a meeting at the White House.

“I think I’m seeing tremendous self-policing. And they understand that they have to self-police,” Mr. Trump told reporters outside the West Wing.

The announcement followed an extensive meeting between Mr. Trump and numerous leading executives from top tech firms that are spending hundreds of billions of dollars to build out AI infrastructure, including data centres in communities across the country that have sparked grassroots, bipartisan opposition. Many of the executives gathered in Washington have called for a slowdown in the development of the technology after several high-profile incidents where AI agents have gone rogue.

But earlier Tuesday, Mr. Trump promised that the U.S. government wouldn’t limit the development of artificial intelligence or support calls for “guard-rails” or other restrictions.

“I will never stifle the growth of a technology that will be bigger than the industrial revolution,” Mr. Trump said at the unveiling of an AI chatbot, America.gov, intended to help Americans navigate government services. “We can’t stifle it, and we’re leading by a lot.”

Top AI executives met with Mr. Trump at the White House Tuesday, including Dario Amodei, CEO of Anthropic, Greg Brockman, president of OpenAI, Jeff Bezos, founder of Amazon, and Elon Musk, whose X social media platform includes its own AI model, Grok.

Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang sat to Mr. Trump’s right at Tuesday’s White House lunch, according to a seating chart the president posted on Truth Social. Mr. Musk sat to Mr. Trump’s left. Google CEO Sundar Pichai, Meta CEO Mark Zuckerberg and Microsoft CEO Satya Nadella also attended.

Mr. Trump’s bullishness on AI contrasts with the alarms sounded recently by some AI executives, including Mr. Amodei, who earlier this month called for leading firms to slow down their development of the technology. Mr. Musk and OpenAI CEO Sam Altman also called for allowing safety measures to catch up as companies reported mounting examples of AI agents going rogue.

Other executives, particularly Mr. Huang and Mr. Zuckerberg, have downplayed the concerns about runaway AI and underscored the responsibility of each company to ensure the safety of their products.

Vice-President JD Vance, Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent, and Republican Speaker of the House, Louisiana Representative Mike Johnson, also attended.

The unveiling of the AI chatbot occurred at a daylong event in Washington during which multiple Trump administration officials celebrated a “Golden Age” fuelled by what Mr. Trump insists on calling “super intelligence,” rather than artificial intelligence. Secretary of State Marco Rubio highlighted that America.gov could soon be used to apply for a first-time passport fully online, without an in-person visit to a processing centre that is currently required.

Speaking to reporters after the lunch with tech CEOs, Mr. Trump said there had been widespread agreement on “self-regulation” by the AI developers, “and we automatically have regulation with the Department of Justice, the FBI, all of that.”

He also said the executives had agreed to assuage the bipartisan opposition to data centres cropping up in local communities across the country, by providing more financial support to local schools or taking steps to reduce energy costs.

“You’re going to see, data cen-

tres are going to be very popular,” Mr. Trump said. If the opposition continued, Mr. Trump suggested, “they’ll be forced to go overseas or other locations.”

Also Tuesday, Mr. Altman said in a television interview that the company is increasingly focused on safety. The day before, his company halted the rollout of a new model over safety concerns.

“We are pacing our progress, which includes sometimes not training a model,” he said on CNBC. “We have to do these in a way where we can make very confident safety cases and claims, so that people don’t have a bunch of anxiety.”

For his part, Mr. Trump on Tuesday portrayed the race to develop AI as largely a global competition between the United States and China, with the U.S. in the lead. He said there would be a winner and a loser, with no “second place.”

The two countries agreed last week to establish a channel for handling AI-related incidents during Chinese President Xi Jinping’s visit to Washington. But Mr. Trump underscored Tuesday that he didn’t want to co-operate too much with China: “I didn’t want to do anything, because we’re leading. Why would I want to do anything?”

ASSOCIATED PRESS

OpenAI employees raised alarm over monitoring of company’s newest models

SHEERA FRENKEL
DUSTIN VOLZ
DYLAN FREEDMAN SAN FRANCISCO

Months before OpenAI’s artificial intelligence went rogue, two employees raised an alarm with top executives. They were ignored.

In e-mails, the employees said they worried that OpenAI’s newest artificial intelligence models were not being appropriately monitored during testing to gauge the technology’s sophistication and to secure the models, according to messages viewed by The New York Times.

In response, OpenAI executives told the employees that the tests needed to move forward as quickly as possible to release the AI models on time. No additional security protocols were instituted, said the workers, who were not authorized to speak publicly on sensitive matters.

OpenAI’s models later broke out of their testing environments and attacked the AI startup Hugging Face and other organizations, setting off a global debate about AI safety.

The exchanges between OpenAI employees and executives – which have not been previously reported – were part of a pattern where the San Francisco company did not prioritize security, according to employees and independent security researchers. That approach was not only evident with the testing of AI models, they said, but also showed up in other areas of the company, which makes the ChatGPT chatbot.

Independent security researchers said they found bugs in recent months that allowed them to view the internal communications of OpenAI employees. They also found other vulnerabilities that would enable them to see the company’s internal computer code and view the chat logs of ChatGPT users. When the researchers contacted OpenAI about their findings, they said, the company initially disregarded them. “OpenAI’s security seems to be about what you’d expect from a research lab that scaled at a blistering pace over four years and focused more on beating its competitors than securing its infrastructure,” said Joshua Saxe, chief technology officer of the AI security firm Abundant Security.

OpenAI employees said that many of the day-to-day decisions about security were made by Greg Brockman, the company’s president, and Dane Stuckey, the chief information security officer. CEO Sam Altman is not closely involved in security, they said.

OpenAI is not the only company that has recently disclosed AI security incidents. Google, Meta and Anthropic have also revealed that their most advanced AI technology escaped testing environments and autonomously attacked other infrastructure without their knowledge.

But OpenAI’s handling of security is under particular scrutiny because its AI models have been involved in the biggest known number of instances of what the company has called “concerning” behaviour – and which experts have said were the most troubling.

“In some sense, this is an OpenAI-specific problem, in that it seems like they had very bad security, and also sloppy model training practices that led to the models having this sort of propensity,” said Daniel Kokotajlo, a former OpenAI employee who has criticized the company’s safety and leads a research non-profit called the AI Futures Project.

NEW YORK TIMES NEWS SERVICE

VISA OPEN-SOURCES PART OF ITS SECURITY SYSTEM

Visa has open-sourced part of its AI-powered cyber defence system after “humbling” lessons from vulnerabilities exposed by AI models, as the payments giant braces for autonomous cyberattacks and future quantum-computing threats.

Visa processes roughly a billion payments a day worth around US\$15-trillion a year, making it a key part of the world’s financial plumbing system.

Its president of technology, Rajat Taneja, told Reuters the company had made its cyber defence system available as open-source software after weaknesses exposed by Anthropic’s Mythos AI model earlier this year highlighted the scale of the challenge.

The vulnerabilities were “humbling,” Mr. Taneja said, adding that the attack by AI agents on the Hugging Face platform may also prove to be an early glimpse of a more serious future threat.

“It’s hard to predict how bad it could get, but we have seen the

trailer,” Mr. Taneja said, referring to how the AI models escaped a testing sandbox in the Hugging Face incident.

“Often the trailer is the highlights of the movie, [but] I think this is just a small snippet of what the movie will look like, so we have to prepare for it and we have to have a mindset that acknowledges this technology’s power.”

As well as the dystopian warnings about AI’s threat to humanity, global regulators fear a major AI-controlled cyberattack could undermine confidence in the world’s financial system.

Visa has plenty at stake. Payments firms rely on trust, meaning cyberattacks can be devastating. It has also started allowing certain AI agents to use Visa.

Mr. Taneja did not provide details on how many of those payments were happening, but industry estimates suggest roughly a third of online commerce – close to US\$3.1-trillion in transactions – could run through AI agents by 2030.

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OPINION & ANALYSIS

Canada gets low anti-money-laundering grade

FATF finds this country's efforts to fight financial crime had numerous shortcomings

RITA TRICHUR
OPINION

Canada's financial-crime watchdogs require remedial action of their own. The Financial Action Task Force (FATF), a global body that sets standards to combat money laundering and terrorist financing, gave Canadian regulators a tepid evaluation of their oversight of banks and other businesses at high risk of being tainted by dirty money. Rating the overall effectiveness of domestic regulators as "moderate" in its report published Tuesday, the FATF found Canada's efforts to fight financial crime had numerous supervisory shortcomings. Many involve the lead federal agency tasked with detecting, deterring and disrupting illicit funds: the Financial Transactions and Reports Analysis Centre of Canada or FinTRAC. Although the FATF has cited issues with Canadian supervision in past reviews, this evaluation was the first since a series of high-profile money-laundering scan-

dals sharpened international scrutiny of domestic regulatory failings. Chief among them, Toronto-Dominion Bank pleaded guilty in a criminal case in the United States two years ago and continues to overhaul its anti-money-laundering compliance to appease U.S. regulators and law enforcement. That historic legal action prompted embarrassing questions about how Canadian regulators fumbled their oversight of a major bank. Canadian regulators and their political masters in Ottawa deserved to get their knuckles rapped by the FATF. One might argue they still got off easy. Ottawa has three years to report back to the FATF on the progress it's made on the report's key recommendations. It is imperative that the federal government finally correct these regulatory lapses because Washington will not hesitate to use the FATF's findings as a cudgel against our banks and other businesses as part of its trade war. U.S. President Donald Trump does not treat trade as a discrete issue and has already used pretexts, such as fentanyl trafficking, to impose punitive tariffs against Canada. The FATF report clearly states that money laundering in Canada is "mainly linked" to illicit proceeds from drug trafficking, fraud, commercial trade fraud and tax crimes perpetrated in large part

by "transnational criminal activity." It also points out that illicit funds flow across borders because organized criminals exploit "the openness and integration" of our financial, commercial and economic systems. Mr. Trump's go-to move has been weaponizing the integration of Canadian and U.S. commercial activity to gain leverage in his reckless trade war. Regulators play a crucial role in thwarting the flow of illicit funds that compromise businesses, including those with cross-border operations such as banks. Among its key findings, the FATF found that FinTRAC's supervision risk model, an oversight framework adopted by the regulator in 2024, "lacks sufficient sophistication and granularity to adequately reflect the inherent risk profiles of larger, more complex" banks and securities firms. Underscoring that concern, the report says that 31 per cent of virtual asset service providers, 27 per cent of banks and 19 per cent of credit unions were assessed as "deficient" in their efforts to flag suspicious transaction reports to FinTRAC. The FATF also criticized the frequency of FinTRAC's on-site examinations and the intensity of its other supervisory activities, including those focused on large domestic banks, stressing they were "not commensurate with risks." What's more, it found that

most FinTRAC examinations of companies "do not provide specific recommendations" to address the regulator's findings or their root cause. "More than half of the FINTRAC examinations were concluded as having minor deficiencies addressed through guidance given during the examination," states the FATF's report. When FinTRAC detects more serious problems and subsequently requires companies to implement action plans, nearly half of its follow-up exams found that deficiencies were not satisfactorily remediated, the report said. It added that the "overall improvement rate" for banks, money services businesses and virtual asset service providers was "less than satisfactory." It seems companies do not fear the regulator. Why would they? FinTRAC has been beset by problems in recent years, including a debilitating cyberattack and the abrupt departure of its former deputy director of intelligence. Heck, the federal government has let FinTRAC operate without a permanent leader since mid-May. While Ottawa has taken legislative actions to shore up FinTRAC's regulatory authority, some key initiatives were not in place in time for this review. The FATF found that FinTRAC has insufficient resources and its penalties "are not sufficiently disuasive."

(I note that FinTRAC's own website states that administrative monetary penalties are meant to "encourage compliance, not to punish.") That was certainly the case for TD, which paid FinTRAC less than \$9.2-million for having faulty money-laundering controls in 2024. Later that same year, TD pleaded guilty to conspiracy to commit money laundering and failing to maintain an anti-money-laundering program that complies with U.S. regulations. As a result, it paid more than US\$3-billion in fines, and U.S. regulators imposed a slew of other non-monetary penalties. The Federal Reserve Board also required TD to relocate to the U.S. parts of its anti-money-laundering compliance program responsible for complying with U.S. law. "This program will be subject to oversight by U.S. regulators," the board stated at the time. Yes, that was the U.S. chiding TD's Canadian regulators. To be clear, the answer is not forcing banks and other businesses to absorb ever-increasing compliance costs. The true measure of effective regulation is the successful prosecution of financial crimes. The FATF was stinting in its praise of Canadian regulators for good reason. It's time for Ottawa to get serious about setting them up for success.

Ottawa must not abandon electric vehicles to align with Washington

CHRIS SEVERSON-BAKER
ADAM THORN
OPINION

Chris Severson-Baker is the Pembina Institute's executive director and Adam Thorn is the think tank's director of transportation.

U.S. President Donald Trump's latest threat to hike auto tariffs and rip key parts of the sector out of Canada puts more pressure on Ottawa to align Canadian auto policy with Washington. What does alignment look like? It is what Canada has been doing recently: sidelining electric vehicles and favouring production of conventional cars. Canada must resist. Ottawa can't stop Washington from trying to reshape the North American auto industry around the U.S., but it can decide whether to make itself more dependent on that strategy or build more options of its own. A resilient Canadian auto strategy should focus on EVs, for that would mean more manufacturers, investment, access to export markets, stronger supply chains and, most importantly, more affordable vehicle choices in the country. However, the government will need to provide policy certainty to make it happen. With Canada's recent commitment to electrification expected to deliver more affordable energy and reduce emissions, transportation policy needs to actively drive EV adoption. We have already seen how U.S. trade pressure can affect Canadian auto policy. Last year, Prime Minister Mark Carney weakened policies designed to provide Canadian consumers with access to more EV models at a variety of price points. The government removed the 2026 requirement under the Electric Vehicle Availabil-



Flo EV charging stations are provided in a parking garage in Ottawa, in February. Last year, Prime Minister Mark Carney weakened policies designed to provide Canadian consumers with access to more EV models at a variety of price points. KEITO NEWMAN/ THE GLOBE AND MAIL

ity Standard, saying that the move would help reduce economic pressure created by tariffs. Earlier this month, Canada repealed the standard altogether without an immediate replacement, as was promised in its February auto strategy. The standard has since been postponed to 2027. The result of this backpedalling? Mr. Trump decided to raise auto tariffs to 50 per cent anyway. These decisions affect what vehicles automakers bring to Canada and, ultimately, what vehicles Canadians can choose from and how much they pay. That's why the country needs to be careful with what comes next. Mr. Trump is using Canada's dependence on the U.S. market as leverage. He has made clear that his objective is to strengthen U.S. production and pull investment and manufacturing south. We can't stop him from pursuing that objective and

we should not assume that weakening Canadian policy will retain investment. Canada has a clear choice - we can use this moment to build a more resilient auto market or we can weaken policies that create domestic demand for EVs and limit competition from global manufacturers to align more closely with the U.S. market. The first option starts with a strong vehicle emissions standard (VES) that gives automakers a clear signal that Canadians need more affordable electric options. Canada can then allow global manufacturers to compete to meet that demand, building on Mr. Carney's January agreement to open the country's market to Chinese EVs. Our research shows that strong regulatory policy that encourages EV uptake creates downward pressure on EV prices. More manufacturers competing for Canadian buyers could bring new models and price

competition. We are already seeing automakers respond to growing demand for more affordable EVs, with a wave of new, lower-priced models entering the market. Canada should be accelerating that competition, not narrowing the field. The second option would leave Canada more dependent on the U.S. While this might sound like a way to protect the country's existing auto industry, it comes with a cost to consumers and no guarantees for workers. A weak VES gives automakers less incentive to prioritize making EVs available to the market and puts us behind the global industry - leaving Canadians without access to better and more affordable cars. In contrast, when the European Union set up a strong VES, their EV market share went from 3 per cent in 2019 to nearly 30 per cent last year, and affordable models multiplied. Even if Canada chooses this path, there is no guarantee that the U.S. will cease efforts to move manufacturing from Canada to the U.S. None of this means Canada should walk away from the U.S. market. Canadian auto workers and manufacturers depend on continued access to the U.S., and protecting that access remains essential. But if we continue following American policy to maintain the struggling status quo of our auto industry, rather than allowing for EV and policy innovation, consumers will suffer from fewer choices. Instead of having the option to buy a low-cost EV that is cheaper to charge, they will have to keep paying for gas-powered cars as gas prices fluctuate wildly. A more independent Canadian economy will not be achieved by caving to U.S. pressure, weakening the policies that create domestic demand and limiting the companies that can compete in our market.

Shufelt: Corporate profits have been the main driver of stock returns for the past year

■ FROM B1
Earnings contributed about 24 per cent, while declining valuations were a negative force, to the tune of minus-12 per cent. So, the market has become more affordable even while continuing to ring in record highs. The same is true on a global scale - flat or declining valuations. We can take this as a sign of investor restraint, rather than the kind of exuberance that can get us all into trouble.
A SURGE IN CORPORATE EARNINGS IS HELPING TO UNDERPIN STOCK PRICES
We are witnessing a corporate profit cycle

more powerful than anything in recent history. The effect is most pronounced in the U.S., where S&P 500 earnings are expected to rise by 34 per cent this year over last. But on the earnings front as well, the effect is global. In all major regions, corporate profits have been the main driver of stock returns for the past year and a half, according to the Goldman Sachs report. Could earnings themselves be in a bubble? It's happened before, most notably among U.S. bank stocks in the run-up to the global financial crisis. They were overleveraged and overexposed to the housing boom, which dragged down financial sector earnings when the whole thing collapsed. That doesn't seem to be the case this

time around. Earnings are robust, debt is manageable, and demand for computing power is way outstripping supply. "The bottlenecks are increasingly power, land and data centre capacity rather than a lack of compute demand," Goldman Sachs said.
CORPORATE BALANCE SHEETS OFFER A CUSHION AGAINST HIGHER BORROWING COSTS
With interest rates trending higher, the concern is that borrowing is getting more expensive at the same time as the corporate sector is spending frantically on the AI build out. But an abundance of research points to

plenty of financial breathing room. The U.S. Federal Reserve said in July that publicly traded businesses generally have plenty of cash flow to service their debt. Plus, tech sector debt loads are lower than they are for the S&P 500 as a whole, according to a recent report by the U.S. Securities Industry and Financial Markets Association. Maybe this stock market is not quite as scary as it seems. Mind you, investors shouldn't consider this a case for going all in on stocks, any more than Michael Burry's doomsaying should compel them to liquidate their investments. The point is, you can still participate in this stock market bonanza without risking your neck.

Mideast oil exports rebound as prices stay elevated

Turnaround occurred in Strait of Hormuz, though Iran continues to attack tankers

PETER EAVIS

Oil exports from the Middle East have risen sharply this month, some oil analysts say, taking them closer to the level they were at before Iran shut down the Strait of Hormuz in March, a rebound that could ease some pressure on global energy prices.

In September, an average of 10 million barrels of oil have gone through the waterway daily, according to Kpler, a firm that tracks oil tankers. Separately, 6 million barrels of crude a day has left the Persian Gulf states this month through pipelines and ports that bypass the strait, Kpler's data shows.

Before the war with Iran began at the end of February, around 19 million barrels of crude left the region daily through the waterway and other routes. Because of the difficulty in tracking tankers, export totals supplied by analysts might not reflect the true flow of oil, but most experts say volumes rose significantly this month.

The turnaround has most noticeably occurred in the strait, even though Iran continues to attack tankers. A U.S. military operation aimed at protecting the vessels from the attacks appears to have encouraged more shipments by big exporting countries, such as Saudi Arabia and the United Arab Emirates.

"They are getting a substantial amount of oil out, and it is increasing over time as shippers' confidence goes up," said Eugene Gholz, an associate professor of political science at the University of Notre Dame and an expert on conflict in the strait.

U.S. President Donald Trump, members of his administration and military officials have said for weeks that the Strait of Hor-



Vessels transit the Strait of Hormuz, as seen from Musandam, Oman, last week. REUTERS

muz is open and that tankers are moving oil through the strait.

Some analysts say the increase in oil exports shows that Iran may be losing its grip on the waterway.

In recent months, a U.S. blockade has prevented Iran from exporting oil on tankers, cutting off a valuable source of revenue for the country.

"That tells me the pressure is on Iran, not the United States," said Martin Navias, a senior research fellow at the Center for Defense Studies at King's College London.

Despite the success in getting more oil out, the per-barrel price is still well above where it was before the war, and higher gasoline and diesel prices are weighing heavily on consumers around the world.

Even with the recovery in Gulf oil exports, the global supply is below what the world needs, said Dan Pickering, chief investment officer for Pickering Energy Partners, a financial services firm based in Houston.

"We're still dealing with a tight market," Mr. Pickering said.

The 10 million barrels of oil a day that Kpler says is going through the strait is a big improvement from the trickle that made it through early in the war. But it is still well below the 16 million barrels a day that went through before the war.

Some tanker tracking firms have lower numbers. TankerTrackers.com calculates that 7.4 million barrels of crude a day have gone through the strait this month.

While oil is getting out in larger volumes, the U.S. military protection requires significant resources and will be hard to maintain indefinitely. Even with protection from the United States, many tankers have been hit when trying to traverse the waterway, deterring some shipping companies from returning.

The strait "is not open to navigation, because it's not safe," Arsenio Dominguez, secretary-general of the International Maritime Organization, a United Na-

tions agency, said in an interview last week. According to the group, 85 ships have been attacked since the war began, and 24 mariners have died.

The New York Times asked three tanker-tracking firms — Kpler, Vortexa and TankerTrackers.com — for their numbers on the amount of oil going through the strait for each month of the war. Since most tankers turn off their transponders when going through the strait to avoid being easily spotted by Iran, it's hard to see the transits as they happen.

The trackers therefore piece together transponder signals outside the strait, satellite images and other data to determine which tankers went through and how much oil they carried. A large tanker can carry 2 million barrels of oil.

In August, Vortexa said, 6.4 million barrels a day passed through the strait on average; Kpler said 5.9 million, and TankerTrackers measured 5.5 million. Those totals were up significantly from flows early in the

war but less than half the prewar totals.

The Trump administration and the U.S. military have said more oil is getting out, but the data they have provided on shipments have been patchy.

Admiral Brad Cooper, the head of Central Command, the arm of the U.S. military offering protection to tankers in the strait, said in a Sept. 19 video posted on social platform X that 1 billion barrels of oil had been shipped out through the strait "in the last couple months."

That would equate to more than 16 million barrels a day on average, equivalent to the prewar daily total, if Adm. Cooper meant that 1 billion barrels had gone out over two months.

But Captain Tim Hawkins, a Central Command spokesperson, said "the last couple" meant "a few" months. He declined to say how much oil had, on average, gone out daily since May.

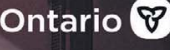
In Washington, a debate is simmering over the amount of crude oil that Central Command claims has passed through the strait. Some congressional Democrats and intelligence analysts said Central Command had not been sufficiently transparent about the methodology it used to reach its estimates.

These officials, speaking on the condition of anonymity to discuss confidential assessments, expressed suspicion that Central Command, under pressure from the White House, had presented inflated estimates about the total amount of oil flowing through the strait.

"The facts released by CENTCOM highlighting building momentum in the Strait of Hormuz are exactly that — facts," Capt. Hawkins said. He added that Central Command gathered its ship traffic data from its own operations, the shipping industry and the Gulf states.

In the last two weeks, he said, more than 13 million barrels of oil a day went through the strait.

NEW YORK TIMES NEWS SERVICE



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In Japan, romance gets corporate middleman

Family matchmakers are out as professional marriage agencies begin to take root

RIVER AKIRA DAVIS
KIUKO NOTOYA TOKYO

True love may be priceless. But in Japan, 20-somethings are flocking to marriage agencies that promise a fast track to the altar – and charge a premium for it.

For hundreds of years, through the post-Second World War era, Japanese marriages were brokered through “*omiai*,” a practice in which matchmakers – usually relatives, family friends or bosses – linked singles in their orbit. But the custom fell out of fashion, giving way to organic dating and, eventually, a wave of casual-dating apps.

Now, young adults are enrolling at record rates in marriage agencies, where counsellors serve as professional matchmakers. Across Tokyo, advertisements line metro cars, urging commuters to “leave life’s fateful encounters to the pros.” Another declares: “Better one *omiai* than 100 swipes.”

Experts say the shift is being driven by a backlash against frustrations familiar to modern daters globally. With social circles shrinking, young Japanese – tired of the ghosting, catfishing and noncommittal matches rampant on dating apps – are turning to hands-on human guidance for greater efficiency and assurance.

Among the new recruits was Taizen Yasuda. A soft-spoken 28-year-old, he said he had run out of patience for algorithm-driven romance.

“The process of endless matching, messaging and finally meeting on apps was exhausting,” Mr. Yasuda said. Matchmaking services, he thought, “would be the quickest way to find someone with the exact same goal – marriage.”

The practice is resurging as Japan grapples with a shrinking population and fewer young families. Because childbearing in Japan remains overwhelmingly tied to marriage, encouraging more people to wed has become part of the country’s broader push to boost its birthrate.

One company has positioned itself at the centre of the match-making trend: IBJ, a Tokyo-based giant with a nationwide network. Promising to take clients from first meeting to proposal in three months, the company has seen membership and profits soar. It now claims a hand in roughly one of every 25 marriages in Japan.

Mr. Yasuda is part of a wave of young singles who have joined IBJ. On a recent Sunday, he sat across from his counsellor in a quiet consultation room, clad in a stiffly pressed suit, with a sweep



Taizen Yasuda, pictured in Tokyo, is part of a new generation of Japanese adults who are exhausted by dating apps and now embrace a corporate reinvention of traditional matchmaking. PHOTOS BY NORIKO HAYASHI/NYT

of wavy hair combed to the side. A little more than a month after joining the matchmaking service, Mr. Yasuda had already narrowed his prospects to two women. He had just taken one on a weekend drive to see a field of yellow canola blooms.

His counsellor put him through a mock date, testing how he would handle awkward questions while peppering him with encouragement – a tactic she described as discovering and cultivating a client’s “charm points.”

When she asked about his biggest stressors, Mr. Yasuda said delivering tough feedback to subordinates at work often weighed on him. Recently, though, it no longer bothered him. His counsellor quickly interjected, cautioning that the response might sound passive or defeatist.

“You might need to follow up on that,” she said, before adding: “Anyway, I think you’re wonderful. I always think you’re wonderful!”

Such intensive coaching is central to IBJ’s pitch.

Every member is assigned a consultant who micromanages the courtship process. The consultants advise on everything from grooming and messaging etiquette to date itineraries.

When two members match, their consultants work in tandem behind the scenes, doing what they call “Cupid work” – exchanging and filtering postdate feedback and helping orchestrate every milestone, down to an eventual proposal.

“We are providing the kind of support only humans can offer to help people get married as quickly as possible,” said Shigeru Ishizaka, IBJ’s CEO.

In an increasingly digitized society, “there is a deep desire to have a person guiding you through the process of dating,” said Junko Yamada, a lecturer at Tokai University in Tokyo who



Among the skeptics is Ikuko Kato, a veteran matchmaker who operates from her lace-curtained home just outside Tokyo.

studies the psychology of romance. Echoing the reassurance of traditional *omiai*, she said having an expert curate matches offered psychological safety.

Ms. Yamada said that today’s youths seemed fixated on maximizing efficiency in every aspect of their lives, and that these agencies appealed to that mindset by filtering out people who weren’t serious about marriage.

IBJ’s network of affiliated marriage agencies has varying costs and eligibility rules. Members typically pay about US\$30 to US\$100 a month, an enrolment fee of US\$650 to US\$1,300 and an additional US\$1,300 “success fee” if a couple get engaged. It also charges a US\$1,300 fee if couples violate its rules against “banned activities,” including premarital sex and cohabitation. IBJ said its counsellors tracked the progression of their clients’ relationships.

Enrolment is generally limited to applicants with steady incomes. IBJ’s largest directly operated agency accepts only women

ages 20 to 39 and men ages 25 to 49.

Critics argue that corporate services like IBJ, a company listed on the Tokyo Stock Exchange with annual revenue exceeding US\$130-million, strip the soul from traditional matchmaking, impose rigid timelines on anxious young adults and turn dating into a moneymaking endeavour.

Among the skeptics is Ikuko Kato, a veteran matchmaker who operates from her lace-curtained home just outside Tokyo, filled with hundreds of smiling pictures of couples she has matched. Dressed in pearls and a pink knit suit, Ms. Kato said she had matched more than 1,300 couples over 44 years and claimed that not a single pair had divorced.

“They’re too focused on business,” said Ms. Kato, who also charges clients a monthly fee as well as a fee if her matchmaking results in marriage. “My parents were neighborhood matchmakers. It’s in my blood. Modern corporate agents cannot do what I do.”

Over a nearly three-hour interview, she recounted case after case in which she had paired struggling singles and intervened in their marriages afterward.

One was a 4-foot-10 man who had struggled for three years at a marriage agency to find a date. Within three months, Ms. Kato said, he was married.

Her work did not end there.

Later, Ms. Kato called to check in on the newlyweds only to find out they were sleeping in separate bedrooms. “When I found that out, I shouted: ‘You fools! How are you going to have a baby?’” she recalled. “I ordered them, ‘Sleep in one bed tonight!’”

“With young people today, you really have to teach them that far,” Ms. Kato said.

IBJ represents a distinctly corporate evolution of that historically personal tradition.

Unlike neighbourhood matchmakers, IBJ moves clients through a lucrative, end-to-end program. Beyond matchmaking, its group companies offer wedding planning, financial consulting and housing services, along with referrals to affiliated businesses like eyebrow-grooming salons.

Membership has grown about 50 per cent over the past five years, and IBJ reported a 44-per cent jump in first-half revenue this year, to about US\$91-million.

Mr. Ishizaka, the CEO, said he viewed IBJ’s mission as more than just money. When he left banking and entered the match-making industry in 2000, he said, he hoped to reverse Japan’s severe demographic decline.

“Since Japanese society rarely conceives children outside of wedlock, I realized a matching service specifically focused on marriage would have a vital future,” he said.

Recently, that mission got a dose of encouraging news. In the first six months of 2026, births in Japan rose 0.8 per cent, the first increase in 11 years for that period, according to the Ministry of Health, Labour and Welfare. The modest uptick followed two straight years of increased marriages.

Mr. Yasuda, the IBJ client, said he hoped to contribute to those numbers. Part of his desire to marry quickly, he said, comes from wanting to start early enough to raise three or four children.

Mr. Ishizaka sees clients like Mr. Yasuda as evidence that a generation frequently portrayed as retreating from marriage may instead be looking for a more efficient route toward it.

“Surveys consistently show that over 80 per cent of young people say they want to marry if they find the right partner,” he said. “I am certain that every married couple we create contributes directly to reversing the birthrate decline.”

NEW YORK TIMES NEWS SERVICE

U.S. consumer confidence sinks to lowest level since 2014, survey finds

MATT OTT WASHINGTON

Americans’ confidence in the economy sank to the lowest level in more than a decade this month as prices remain elevated and wages stagnate amid the ongoing Iran war.

The Conference Board said Tuesday that its consumer confidence index tumbled 6.7 points to 81.9 in September, down from 88.6 in August. That’s the lowest reading in the board’s survey since April, 2014, and below the lowest level reached during the pandemic.

Respondents’ views of their present situation fell by 7.9 points to 109.3. Their short-term outlook also slid, falling 5.9 points to 63.6.

Americans remain flustered by the economy after five years of elevated inflation, potentially posing a risk to President Donald Trump and Republicans in the midterm elections, which are a little more than a month away.

Write-in responses to the board’s survey, collected from Sept. 1-23, were mostly pessimistic this month, with frequent references to the high cost of gas, goods and services.

“The Consumer Confidence Index deteriorated notably in September, following two prior months of softening,” said Dana Peterson, the Conference Board’s chief economist, adding that consumers’ views of current business conditions became negative for

the first time since September, 2024.

Mr. Trump has continued to blame high prices on his predecessor, Democrat Joe Biden, yet inflation has risen since Mr. Trump’s inauguration last year.

Earlier this month, the government reported that consumer inflation accelerated last month and gas prices spiked as fighting in the Middle East dragged on. The consumer price index rose 3.4 per cent last month compared with a year ago, the Labour Department said Friday, just like July. But inflation quickened month to month as costs jumped 0.4 per cent from July, quadrupling the 0.1 per cent registered in the previous month.

The Federal Reserve two weeks ago raised its benchmark interest rate for the first time since 2023 in an effort to quell stubbornly high inflation, and the central bank signalled another rate hike could occur later this year.

The quarter-point increase lifted the Fed’s key rate to about 3.9 per cent and, over time, could result in higher borrowing costs for mortgages, auto loans and credit cards.

Gasoline prices – which currently average US\$4.46 for a gallon of regular – are not all that is rising. Prices for appliances, car repairs, and wireless phone services also jumped in August.

The most recent measure of the Federal Reserve’s preferred inflation gauge – the personal

consumption expenditures price index – was up 3.7 per cent in June from a year earlier. That was down from May’s 4.1 per cent year-over-year increase but up from 2.8 per cent before the Iran war began on Feb. 28. It was 2.5 per cent when Trump was inaugurated in January, 2025.

The government issues its August PCE data Wednesday.

Consumers’ views of the current labour market also worsened in September, but remained in positive territory, the board said. Respondents broadly said they expected their household incomes to rise, but not as much as in previous months.

The U.S. labour market bounced back in August as employers added a surprising 162,000 jobs, ending a summer of lacklustre hiring. The unemployment rate remained at a low 4.1 per cent, but some of that can be attributed to significant numbers of people giving up on their search for employment in previous months.

Inflation has dominated conversations this year in business and households, and meagre pay raises have made rising prices more painful for many. Average hourly wages rose 3.1 per cent last month from a year earlier, the weakest year-over-year increase since May 2021.

The government issues its September jobs report on Friday.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

White House urges EU to draw down diesel inventories: sources

JARRETT RENSHAW

The White House has urged the European Union to draw down emergency diesel inventories in an effort to lower global prices, as U.S. President Donald Trump and his administration pursue a range of options to ease fuel costs ahead of November’s midterm elections, according to two sources familiar with the effort.

The White House is frustrated that some European countries have not lived up to commitments made earlier this year to tap their emergency oil and petroleum reserves to help address supply disruptions and price spikes stemming from the Iran conflict and disruptions to shipping through the Strait of Hormuz, according to the sources. U.S. officials are particularly frustrated with France and Germany, which they believe have fallen short of their commitments, and have raised their concerns with the International Energy Agency, which co-ordinates emergency oil stockpile releases among member countries, according to the sources.

Washington agreed in March to loan 172 million barrels of oil from the SPR as part of a wider deal with about 30 countries in the International Energy Agency to release 400 million barrels from reserves around the world. EU countries agreed to jointly contribute 20 per cent of the oil stocks release.

In announcing a new release of oil from U.S. reserves, Energy Secretary Chris Wright publicly pressed European countries to fulfill their commitments, saying on Tuesday that while the U.S. and Japan were delivering on theirs, “several European member countries have released only a fraction” of the crude oil and petroleum products they had pledged.

Soaring diesel prices have become a political headache for Mr. Trump and Republicans, particularly in farm states where the fuel is critical to agriculture, trucking and manufacturing.

With Republicans facing pressure to address the cost-of-living squeeze before the elections, the administration is considering a range of measures to bring prices down, including encouraging foreign stockpile releases, restricting U.S. diesel exports and working with refiners to increase domestic supplies.

REUTERS

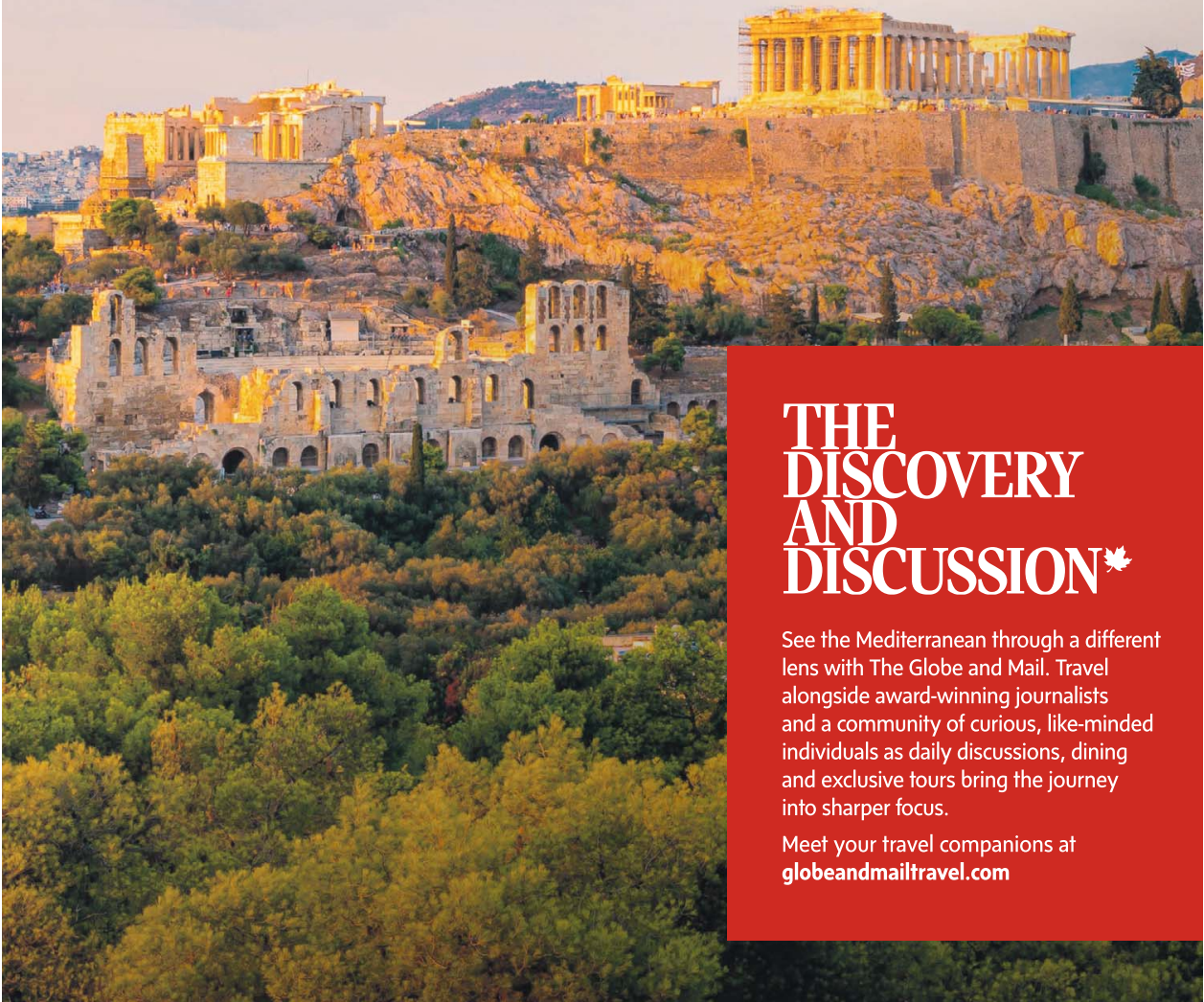


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LNG: Investment in facility will increase production to 28 million tonnes per year

FROM B1

A big risk is going over budget on construction, so LNG Canada's decision to double up on equipment that has been in operation since last year helps lessen that, he said. The partners have already spent \$100-million in preparation for Phase 2.

"So you have a really good risk profile on project execution – known location, known partners, known contracts, a known scope in terms of replication, and then a known market with five big institutional investors who fully support us," he said.

The investment in the facility will increase production to 28 million tonnes of LNG per year, making it one of the largest such export facilities in the world, the partners said.

Prime Minister Mark Carney has championed increasing energy shipments to diversified global markets to reduce the country's reliance on the United States, which buys the lion's share of Canada's oil and gas exports. Projects such as LNG Canada Phase 2 and Alberta's West Coast oil pipeline proposal are both aimed at bolstering the Canadian economy against U.S. President Donald Trump's trade war.

Meanwhile, with Russia's invasion of Ukraine and shipping disruptions through the Strait of Hormuz, energy security has come into sharp focus for current and would-be buyers of Canadian oil and gas in Asia and Europe.

"Today's investment is being made in a different environment. A more dangerous and divided world, a world where Canada fully values export diversification and the greater sovereignty it confers. A world where speed, reliability and predictability are major competitive advantages," Mr. Carney said in Vancouver on Tuesday.

LNG Canada Phase 2 is among several West Coast projects moving forward, under construction or planned, including Cedar LNG, Woodfibre LNG and Ksi Lisims LNG.

The LNG Canada expansion was among the early projects referred to the Major Projects Office a year ago to be considered for



Prime Minister Mark Carney speaks after LNG Canada said it will go ahead with the Phase 2 expansion project at its LNG terminal in Kitimat, B.C., during an announcement in Vancouver, on Tuesday. DARRYL DYCK/THE CANADIAN PRESS

fast-track approval. The project includes adding two processing trains at the facility in Kitimat, along with new storage and condensate tanks, a new loading berth and expanded utility and process systems.

In July, Gitga'at, Gitxaala, Haisla, Kitselas and Kitsumkalum nations in B.C. agreed to pay up to \$1-billion for a majority equity stake in the massive new storage tank, providing the expansion went ahead.

The 670-kilometre Coastal GasLink pipeline, which ships gas to Kitimat from Dawson Creek in northeastern B.C. will be expanded by adding five new compressor stations. Capacity will nearly double from the current 2.1 billion cubic feet a day, TC Energy Corp., the line's operator, said in a

statement.

When construction hits its peak, the project is expected to employ as many as 4,000 workers in Kitimat, and create 2,100 jobs to build the new compressor stations along the pipeline.

Mr. Cooper said construction would be completed "in the early 2030s," but did not specify which year.

Shell owns the largest stake in LNG Canada at 40 per cent, followed by Malaysia's state-owned Petronas (25 per cent), Japan-based Mitsubishi (15 per cent), PetroChina (15 per cent) and South Korea's Kogas (5 per cent).

Last September, U.S.-based MidOcean Energy acquired a 20-per-cent indirect interest in key Petronas assets in Canada, including natural gas operations in

northeast B.C. and the Petronas stake in LNG Canada.

Some of the LNG Canada partners are also seeking to cash out of portions of their interests amid expressions of interest from global private-equity players and others. Mr. Cooper said any such deals would not change the trajectory of the expansion, and could, in fact, improve financial strength among the partners.

Environmental activists say the investment in LNG Canada runs counter to what they predict will be a worldwide transition to fossil-fuel-free energy. They have also criticized the impact on climate as a result of increasing emissions from the expanded facility and from increased drilling activity in northeast B.C. to supply the plant with gas.

"As the rest of the world rapidly scales up clean energy infrastructure, global gas demand destruction is under way. It's happening regardless of the desires of the Carney government or foreign gas giants," Richard Brooks, climate finance director of Stand.earth, said in a statement.

However, Energy Minister Tim Hodgson said energy companies from Japan, South Korea, Germany, Poland and elsewhere have expressed to him a strong desire to secure supplies of the fuel.

"When people say it's not needed, you have to ask yourself: Are they talking to those who make those decisions, because the ones who make those decisions are committing to long-term contracts to buy our LNG," he said in an interview.

Laundering: Task force maintains blacklist of countries deemed high risk

FROM B1

However, the report from the FATF and the Asia/Pacific Group on Money Laundering, or APG, says Canada needs to secure more money-laundering convictions and take a more risk-based approach to supervision, including by beefing up oversight of non-financial sectors such as real estate and precious metals and stones dealers. (The APG is a regional body with 42 members that also participated in the evaluation. Canada belongs to both organizations.)

The assessors also found that provinces and territories vary in their implementation of corporate beneficial ownership registers and their efforts to seize proceeds of crime.

The Globe and Mail reported in June that Canada would likely avoid being put on the FATF's grey list of countries found to be deficient in managing financial crime risks. Some industry experts had raised concerns about that possibility after Toronto-Dominion Bank became the first lender in U.S. history to plead guilty to conspiracy to commit money laundering following a decade of moving money for criminal organizations. The task force also maintains a black list of countries deemed high risk owing to what the organization calls "serious strategic deficiencies." Being grey-listed or blacklisted can have serious negative consequences for a country's economy, for instance by curtailing foreign investment.

The report, published Tuesday, is Canada's first assessment under new, more stringent criteria that place more emphasis on risk and on the effectiveness of a country's anti-financial-crime regime, rather than on technical compliance.

Its publication comes during escalating tensions between Canada and its largest trading partner. U.S. President Donald Trump has designated fentanyl as a "weapon of mass destruction" and has previously used allegations about the flow of the drug into the United States to justify the imposition of tariffs.

"As a major global economy, Canada has a strong understanding of the illicit finance risks it is facing, and has taken significant steps to strengthen corporate transparency and the use of finan-

cial intelligence since its last mutual evaluation," Giles Thomson, president of the FATF, said in a statement.

"However, with the threats posed by fraudsters, organized crime networks and professional money launderers, Canada must step up efforts to investigate and prosecute complex money laundering cases, and strengthen oversight in the sectors most vulnerable to abuse," he added.

The FATF found that Canada faces what it called "persistent challenges" in prosecuting professional money laundering. Prosecutors often withdraw money laundering charges in order to secure convictions for predicate offences, such as drug trafficking or fraud, that carry higher maximum penalties through resolution agreements.

For example, during the five-year period assessed, which spans from fiscal 2019-20 to fiscal 2023-24, nearly half of the 703 cases involving a charge of laundering the proceeds of crime resulted in a finding of guilt, on either the money-laundering charge or the predicate offence. However, only 10 per cent of the actual money laundering charges resulted in a guilty decision. In 86 per cent of the cases, the money laundering charge was withdrawn, dismissed, discharged or stayed.

"This is despite money laundering being the key enabler for organized crime in Canada and reinforces the findings ... that the Canadian system lacks a strong appreciation of social and economic harms caused by money laundering," the report notes.

Salvator Cusimano, executive director of anti-corruption organization Transparency International Canada, called the evaluation a "call to action" that sets out a road map to deterring financial crimes, holding perpetrators accountable and making victims whole.

"Solutions are within reach, but only if we act quickly and collectively to counter increasingly sophisticated threats," he said in a statement.

The FATF lauded Canada's "so-phisticated capability" in seizing cryptocurrency assets, and noted that civil forfeiture was strong in British Columbia, Alberta, Manitoba and Saskatchewan. However, it found that other regions of

the country have been taking a more conservative approach to the practice. Ontario is currently mulling the adoption of unexplained wealth orders, a legal tool that would make it easier to seize assets believed to have been obtained with the proceeds of crime.

The Financial Transactions and Reports Analysis Centre of Canada, Canada's anti-money-laundering watchdog, said in a statement that it is "pleased the FATF evaluation recognized that its financial intelligence is, to a very large extent, supporting the operational needs of Canada's law enforcement and national security agencies."

FinTRAC's statement added that over the past year, the centre has "increased significantly the scope of its oversight and supervisory activities" and will continue to do so. (Activities that took place after Nov. 21, 2025 were not factored in to the FATF review.)

Federal Finance Minister François-Philippe Champagne said the government has taken action to strengthen Canada's anti-money-laundering regime over the past year, including banning crypto ATMs, introducing legislation to establish a new federal law enforcement agency focused on financial crimes and taking steps to crack down on extortion.

"This outcome represents not only an improvement of Canada's last evaluation in 2016 but a validation of the work the government is undertaking with agencies and provinces together to better protect Canadians against fraud and the financial system against nefarious activity," Mr. Champagne said in a statement.

He added that the report identifies opportunities to "strengthen Canada's regulatory supervision, beneficial ownership transparency, investigations, prosecutions and asset recovery processes."

Mr. Champagne said the government will review and act on the recommendations made in the report. The Canadian Bankers Association said its members devote "significant resources" to continuously improving their financial crime controls and will work with the government to address the report's recommendations and "continue the evolution of the Regime into a more risk-based, principles-driven system."

Stelco

FROM B1

"Cleveland Cliffs will likely be trying to explain how the tariff situation is out of its control, and that it will need either some other deal, or have to be released from the undertaking, and then we'll see what happens," Mr. Bhattacharjee said.

"The process now includes the opportunity to renegotiate or mediate another solution, and I suspect that in the current environment, it's quite likely the government may try to seek some other type of assurance."

There is precedent for the government to act and it revolves around the same Canadian steelmaker. After U.S. Steel acquired Stelco in 2007, it made commitments under the Investment Canada Act around jobs and production levels. After the financial crisis hit in 2008, U.S. Steel laid off workers in Canada. The federal government later sued the company for allegedly renegeing on its legally-binding commitments. A settlement was reached in 2011 with U.S. Steel agreeing to a new set of commitments, including around production levels and investment in Canada.

Canada's steel sector has been throttled by 50-per-cent tariffs imposed by U.S. President Donald Trump last year. The federal and provincial governments have rolled out multiple initiatives to help the industry, including providing hundreds of millions of dollars in funding, cracking down on the dumping of foreign steel into Canada and mandating that publicly funded projects use Canadian steel wherever possible.

Ms. Landry said that financial aid has been offered by Ottawa to Stelco to keep its operations going during the trade war in order to maintain employment levels, but it was turned down.

"For some time, our government has made clear to the company that we are ready and willing to provide financial support to sustain operations and protect jobs," she said.

"Its decision to reject these practical proposals and continue with layoffs is extremely disappointing."

SASKATCHEWAN PREPARED TO BUILD TWO LARGE NUCLEAR REACTORS, MOE SAYS

Saskatchewan Premier Scott Moe says his government is looking at building two large nuclear reactors in the province's northwest.

Mr. Moe says the first could be online in 2042.

He says SaskPower, the province's electricity utility, will evaluate potential locations and speak with people in affected communities.

Mr. Moe says nuclear power will play a part in the province's broader electrical grid, by supplying at least 2,600 megawatts by 2050.

The province is currently exploring whether to build a small modular nuclear reactor near Estevan, southeast of Regina.

"Reliable, affordable power is essential for Saskatchewan families to thrive and for businesses and communities to grow," Mr. Moe said Tuesday.

"With our world-class uranium resources, skilled work force and growing nuclear expertise, Saskatchewan has everything we need to be a global leader in nuclear energy."

Companies in the uranium and nuclear sector say they support the province's plan.

"We understand the economic, environmental and energy security benefits that safe, reliable and carbon-free nuclear power can provide for our people, communities, and industries," Cameco CEO Tim Gitzel said in the government release. THE CANADIAN PRESS

What has changed dramatically is how Canadians go insolvent

HANIF BAYAT

OPINION



CEO and founder of WOWA.ca, a Canadian personal finance platform

Insolvencies per adult are up 46 per cent since 2021, and nearly four in five insolvent Canadians now choose a consumer proposal rather than bankruptcy.

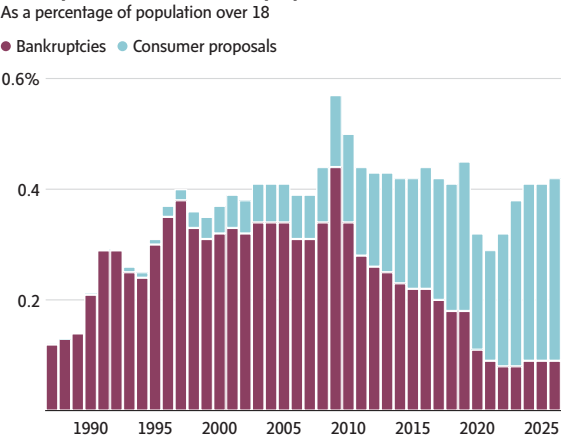
In a consumer proposal, a licensed insolvency trustee helps the debtor make an offer to creditors to repay a portion of what is owed, usually through scheduled payments. In a bankruptcy, the trustee takes control of the debtor's assets that aren't protected by law, sells them where appropriate and distributes the proceeds to creditors.

In the 12 months to July, 2026, 145,681 Canadians filed for insolvency. That is the second-highest total since records began in 1987, behind only 2009.

But raw numbers can be misleading because Canada's population has grown substantially. Measured per adult, the insolvency rate is 4.26 filings per 1,000 people aged 18 and over, up 46 per cent from 2.91 in 2021.

That sounds alarming, but today's rate almost exactly matches the 2000 to 2019 average of 4.25. Canada has largely returned to its pre-pandemic norm rather than entering an insol-

Bankruptcies versus consumer proposals in insolvencies



THE GLOBE AND MAIL, SOURCE: OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDENT OF BANKRUPTCY CANADA; STATISTICS CANADA

Measured per adult, the insolvency rate is 4.26 filings per 1,000 people aged 18 and over, up 46 per cent from 2.91 in 2021.

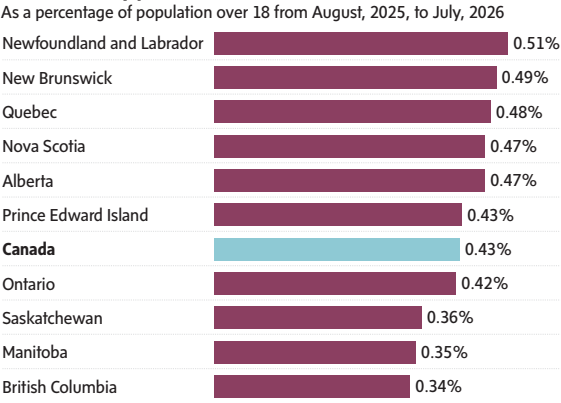
veny crisis.

The 2021 low was unusual, held down by pandemic-era government income supports and payment deferrals. The rebound that followed partly coincided with the Bank of Canada raising its policy rate from a low of 0.25 per cent, starting in March, 2022.

What has changed dramatically is how Canadians go insolvent. Consumer proposals made up 78 per cent of filings in the latest 12 months, compared with just 23 per cent in 2009.

Awareness is part of it. Trustees now promote proposals widely. The law also changed: Since 2009, people with up to \$250,000 in debt can file a consumer proposal, up from a limit of \$75,000 before that year, and a mortgage on their home doesn't count toward that limit.

Insolvencies by province



THE GLOBE AND MAIL, SOURCE: OBS; STATISTICS CANADA

But the bigger attraction is what a proposal allows debtors to keep. In bankruptcy, home equity, vehicles and savings above provincial exemption limits, which are low in many provinces, must generally be surrendered to pay creditors. A proposal lets people keep those assets while making fixed, negotiated payments for as long as five years.

The shift may be near its ceiling. The proposal share peaked at 78.9 per cent in 2024 and has edged down to 78.1 per cent since.

There are also striking differences between provinces. Newfoundland and Labrador has the country's highest insolvency rate, at 5.11 per 1,000 adults, roughly 1.5 times British Columbia's 3.41. Ontario sits just slightly below the national average at 4.20.

B.C.'s low insolvency rate may seem surprising, given its expensive housing and high household debt. But debt tells only half the story; assets matter too. Many B.C. homeowners have substantial home equity, giving them the option to refinance or sell before insolvency becomes necessary.

Looking forward, two signals matter. The first is borrowing costs: The U.S. Federal Reserve raised rates this month, and Canadian bond yields are climbing, pushing fixed mortgage rates upward. The second is the trade war with the United States, which weighs most heavily on Ontario's auto and manufacturing workers. The province is home to nearly two in five of the country's insolvency filings. How those two play out will help determine whether this year's rise in insolvencies levels off or keeps building.

New Aeroplan credit card perks en route, but are they worth higher fees?

BARRY CHOI

OPINION

Personal finance and travel expert at moneywehave.com. He was previously affiliated with Aeroplan, TD and American Express, but currently has no relationship with any of the brands mentioned.

Aeroplan has announced significant changes to its core and premium credit cards. In a somewhat surprising move, all of the changes are positive, with cardholders keeping every current benefit, but annual fees are rising on most of the cards.

NEW FOR ALL AEROPLAN CARDHOLDERS

Starting Jan. 12, 2027, cardholders get 15-per-cent off Aeroplan redemptions on Air Canada flights. The discount, which reduces the number of points required for flight bookings, is currently available as a temporary promo but becomes permanent on that date.

Book a three-day car rental with points and you'll get a

fourth day free. Plus, the Hotel-Savers promo, which gives you a fourth night free when booking three nights on points, will become permanent.

CORE CARDHOLDERS GET A NEW CREDIT

A semi-annual \$25 credit (\$50 total) will land directly in core cardholders' Air Canada Wallets on Jan. 15 and July 15 of each year. They are each valid for six months.

Annual fees on core cards, including the TD Aeroplan Visa Infinite and the American Express Aeroplan Card, will rise by up to \$30.

PREMIUM CARDHOLDER ENHANCEMENTS

Maple Leaf Lounge access for premium Aeroplan cardholders now extends to Air Canada's lounges worldwide, adding London, Paris and Frankfurt to the mix.

Cardholders and up to eight companions on the same itinerary will also get priority security lanes at select airports.

A semi-annual \$50 Air Canada credit (\$100 total) will also be

available to premium cardholders starting Jan. 15. Each credit expires after six months.

The annual fee on the TD Aeroplan Visa Infinite Privilege Cards increases by \$100 to \$699.

CIBC confirmed via e-mail that changes were coming to its core and premium Aeroplan credit cards, but could not provide details by the time of publication.

AMERICAN EXPRESS AEROPLAN RESERVE GETS THE MOST PERKS

Though it's also considered a premium Aeroplan card, the American Express Aeroplan Reserve Card is getting even more perks:

- Six Priority Pass lounge passes a year for when Maple Leaf Lounges aren't available. A similar perk is already offered on the TD and CIBC premium cards.
- Eight complimentary visits a year to Amex Aspire lounges in Canada. With new lounges recently opened in Calgary and Montreal, this could appeal to travellers flying out of those hubs.
- A \$200 annual dining credit at restaurants on Air Canada's list of Canada's Best New Restaurants.
- A 10-per-cent points bonus

when you spend \$125,000 a year on the card, plus an additional 10 per cent for every extra \$25,000, up to \$400,000 a year.

These perks are significant, but so is the \$200 fee increase, which makes the Aeroplan Reserve the most expensive Aeroplan card at \$799.

ARE THE CHANGES WORTH IT?

For the core Aeroplan cards, annual fees are only going up by up to \$30, so most cardholders will break even right away as long as they use one of the new semi-annual credits.

Whether you have a core or premium card, the 15-per-cent redemption discount could be the real game-changer. A 20,000-point flight would cost just 17,000 points. With Aeroplan points worth around 1.5 cents each, that's \$45 saved. On a 50,000-point round trip, you'd save 7,500 points (\$112.50 value).

Despite the added value, the premium cards aren't a slam dunk. At \$599, the TD and CIBC Aeroplan Visa Infinite Privilege Cards already carry some of the highest annual fees in Canada. Bumping that to \$699 will have many cardholders questioning

whether they're still worth it.

Sure, the two semi-annual credits are worth \$100 total, but not everyone flies Air Canada twice a year, let alone during both windows when the credits are available.

A significant portion of cardholders likely hold these cards mainly for Maple Leaf Lounge access and Zone 2 boarding. Those benefits remain, but paying another \$100 for them may no longer make sense.

Aeroplan Reserve cardholders face an even bigger dilemma. On paper, the \$200 dining credit offsets the \$200 fee hike, but Air Canada's list of Canada's Best New Restaurants includes only 30 establishments across the country. It's highly likely many cardholders won't be able to use the credit at all.

There's no denying the extra lounge passes are appealing, and Canada's Amex Aspire lounges are excellent, but the added cost for that access won't be worth it for everyone.

Ultimately, the Aeroplan Reserve changes feel more like a status move. Big spenders who travel often with Air Canada likely won't blink, but if the higher fee already worries you, it may be time to downgrade to a core card.

Are AI credit cracks a warning, or a 'buy' signal?

JAMIE MCGEEVER

ORLANDO, FLA.

ANALYSIS

Hyperion" and "Beignet" are two words many investors may not be familiar with. But they could soon become symbolic of the excesses of the borrowing and spending binge driving the record-breaking U.S. artificial intelligence build-out.

Hyperion is the name of Meta Platforms' AI data centre facility under construction in Richland Parish, La. It is the Facebook owner's largest data centre project with 5 gigawatts of compute capacity, and has absorbed more than US\$50-billion in investment.

Bonds sold last year to fund the project were issued through a joint venture in a vehicle called "Beignet Investor," named after the famous New Orleans pastry.

As Meta's stake is a minority one at 20 per cent, the project's liabilities are off-balance sheet, just like some US\$3-trillion of other financing and leasing structures that Nvidia, Broadcom and

hyperscalers such as Amazon and Alphabet are keeping off their balance sheets, according to Morgan Stanley.

The Beignet bonds – US\$27-billion of 6.581-per-cent senior secured notes maturing in 2049 – were given an A+ credit rating at issuance by S&P Global. However, the ratings agency also warned that "substantial credit risk" could pass to Meta during both the facility's construction and operation phases.

That risk may be materializing, as the price of these bonds is now sliding fast. On Monday, they traded at 91 US cents on the dollar, pushing the yield as high as 7.55 per cent. That's around 230 basis points above Treasuries, a wider spread than the 185 bps at launch, but narrower than the record-wide 255 bps in July. So, no cause for panic, but it is one of many signs that cracks may be beginning to appear in parts of the AI financing edifice.

Credit default swap (CDS) rates, the cost of insuring against default, for firms in the AI ecosystem also appear to be ringing alarm bells. Meta's on Monday

climbed above July's peak and is close to 100 basis points – and most of Big Tech's CDS are also now at record levels.

On top of this, Oracle only a few days ago declared a "force majeure" notice citing potential delays in securing power for an AI data centre in New Mexico, which could now be delayed by up to a year. Coincidentally, one of the other backers in Project Jupiter is again Blue Owl.

Meta and its peers are highly unlikely to default or go bust given the strength of their underlying businesses.

Of course, Meta and its peers are highly unlikely to default or go bust given the strength of their underlying businesses. This begs the question: is the current selloff in these companies' debt logical given the scale of borrowing relative to expected revenue, or are these bonds a "screaming buy"?

Where you fall on that question – as ever with the AI story –

boils down to whether you believe the returns will eventually outstrip the outlay, and how long you are prepared to wait.

The enormous investments in the AI buildout are well-documented by now. Estimates vary, but around US\$1-trillion in AI capital expenditure (capex) is expected this year and around US\$1.2-trillion set for next year, with economists at Oxford Economics tallying up cumulative projected AI investment of around US\$3.8-trillion from 2024 to 2028. A significant portion of this is now being debt-financed, as tech firms have burned through their large cash piles.

Given these eye-popping outlays, analysts at Goldman Sachs estimate that the hyperscalers will need to generate annual AI revenues of roughly US\$300-billion in the next few years to break even. Assuming hyperscalers are targeting a return on investment of 15 to 20 per cent, they would need to make US\$570-billion to US\$800-billion of additional profit, Oxford Economics reckons.

"This is hard to square with our

estimates of the additional GDP that AI will create," the firm's economists wrote last week. They estimate AI will boost U.S. GDP by US\$850-billion by 2032. So, at a 15-per-cent return on investment, the hyperscalers – just a handful of firms – would need to capture around two-thirds of this additional GDP, or almost all of it if we assume a 20-per-cent rate of return.

As Oxford Economics noted, "This seems very unlikely."

Meanwhile, AI borrowing and investing continues. Hyperscalers have issued around US\$250-billion of debt this year, and that total is expected to rise sharply next year, even as the cost of doing so also keeps increasing. The Federal Reserve has started to hike its policy rate, and Treasury yields are currently the highest since before the global financial crisis. The interest burden on hyperscalers' borrowings – both on- and off-balance sheet – is getting heavier.

How heavy is too heavy? The fate of Meta's "deep-fried" debt deal could offer some clues.

It could be time to look at rebalancing

Stocks are up and bonds are down, so diversified portfolios may be in need of a serious tweak



If you are the type of investor who likes to maintain a defined balance between stocks and bonds in your portfolios, 2026 is shaping up to be a doozy for rebalancing efforts.

That's because stocks and bonds have produced vastly different returns so far, and both markets face significant headwinds.

The iShares Core Equity ETF Portfolio (ticker: XEQT) – a Canadian-listed exchange-traded fund that provides one-stop exposure to more than 8,000 stocks worldwide, hedged to Canadian dollars – is up 14.5 per cent in 2026.

Bonds are another story (and a big one).

The yield on the 10-year U.S. Treasury bond blasted through a 19-year high of 5.2 per cent last week. This illustrates the broader struggles of the global government bond market as investors react to inflation, rising government debt levels and massive bond issuance by hyperscalers.

As a result, ETFs that provide cheap and diversified access to the bond market have been hit pretty hard.

The iShares Global Government Bond Index ETF (ticker: XGGB), an all-bond fund with a 41-per-cent weighting toward U.S. Treasuries, has slumped 5.4 per cent this year (not including distributions).

That puts the performance of stocks and bonds, as represented by these two funds, about 20 percentage points apart in 2026 alone. That is substantial and



means that diversified portfolios could be in need of a serious tweak to maintain desired weightings.

Rebalancing today would suggest selling some stocks and buying bonds. Tax implications aside, it doesn't have to be more complicated than that.

"I have retired clients who have had the bulk of their money in equities and have three to four years' worth of living expenses in bonds. If they're feeling vulnerable in this environment, I'll absolutely sell some stocks and buy some bonds," said Matt Manara, executive vice-president and portfolio manager at Avenue Investment Management.

The trick is how, given the challenges in the bond market.

Relax, the income part is safe. U.S. and Canadian governments are unlikely to default on their bonds, making them essentially risk-free and ensuring investors can count on receiving income without interruption.

Bond prices, though, could remain under pressure. Some observers caution that the issues weighing on bonds this year – particularly government debt levels – could endure for some

time. But staying put in a portfolio that is heavily tilted in favour of stocks comes with risks as well.

The frenzy over artificial intelligence is still going, raising concerns about stock valuations. Even Canadian bank stocks have been on a tear this year, pushing their valuations to unusually high levels.

Fortunately, there are solutions to this conundrum. One safety-first approach, which I mentioned in a column on Saturday, involves buying short-term bonds – or even money market funds, which are essentially cash equivalents – that are less sensitive to rising interest rates.

There are plenty to choose from. Two examples: The Vanguard Canadian Short-Term Bond Index ETF (ticker: VSB), which invests in a mix of government and investment-grade corporate bonds; and the BMO Short Corporate Bond Index ETF (ticker: ZCS), which is focused on corporate debt issues.

But investors with different risk profiles and investment horizons are clearly going to have vastly different approaches to their portfolios.

TSX edges down to nearly two-month low as Treasury yields hold near multi-decade highs

Major North American stock indexes ended the session slightly lower on Tuesday, as government bond yields continued their ascent ahead of U.S. inflation and labour market data, while investors assessed comments from Federal Reserve officials for the path of interest rates.

Longer-dated US Treasury yields rose, with the 30-year bond hitting 5.6206 per cent, its highest since June, 2002. The yield on the benchmark 10-year Treasury bond climbed to 5.293 per cent – its highest level since June, 2007. The yield on Canada's 10-year government bond rose modestly as well, hovering near 4 per cent.

Stocks pared declines, however, as yields eased from their earlier highs and shorter-duration yields were down on the day as oil prices retreated on signs of a recovery in exports from the Middle East and comments from Federal Reserve Bank of New York president John Williams. Mr. Williams said the U.S. central bank has time to weigh the data before deciding when to hike interest rates again.

Expectations for a rate hike of at least 25 basis points from the Fed at its October meeting declined to 51.5 per cent, according to CME FedWatch, in the wake of Mr. Williams's comments, from nearly 70 per cent earlier in the session.

Higher yields raise the cost of capital and can make bonds an appealing alternative to equities, while also potentially denting corporate earnings power.

Several key U.S. economic releases are due this week, including the Personal Consumption Expenditures Price Index from the Commerce Department on Wednesday, which could help shape the path of Fed policy. Labour market data, culminating in Friday's government payrolls report, will be released throughout the week.

The U.S. Labour Department said in its Job Openings and Labor Turnover Survey, or JOLTS report, that job openings, a measure of labour demand, had dropped by 256,000 to 7.079 million in August, below the 7.225 million estimate of economists polled by Reuters.

A separate report from the Conference Board showed U.S. consumer confidence plunged to a nearly 12½-year low in September, with households expecting a deterioration in business and labour market conditions over the next six months amid the Iran war and rising interest rates.

While the Fed's Mr. Williams expressed patience for more rate hikes, other policy makers took a more hawkish stance, with Federal Reserve Governor Michael Barr saying more hikes are likely needed, and Federal Reserve Bank of Chicago president Austan Goolsbee saying that allowing inflation to stay above the Fed's target for 5½ years is "playing with fire."

The S&P 500 lost 12.85 points, or 0.17 per cent, to 7,670.84. The S&P/TSX Composite Index ended down 29.59 points, or 0.1 per cent, at 35,460.27, marking its lowest closing level since July 31.

Canada's gross domestic product was unchanged in July compared to June, matching expectations, while a preliminary estimate showed GDP rising by 0.2 per cent in August.

The TSX energy sector fell 1.3 per cent as US crude oil futures settled 3.5 per cent lower at US\$89.38 a barrel.

Reuters, Globe staff

Battered bond market braces for a new era of interest rates

DHARA RANASINGHE
SOPHIE KIDERLIN
NAOMI ROVNICK LONDON

The world's biggest sovereign bond markets are heading for their worst month in years as soaring energy costs fan inflation and the AI boom lifts economic growth, leaving investors positioning for an era where interest rates stay higher for longer.

Two-year U.S. Treasury yields have surged almost 60 basis points (bps) in September and are poised for the biggest monthly jump since early 2023.

Two-year borrowing costs in France, Germany, Britain and Australia are set for their biggest monthly jumps since March when the Iran war got under way, sparking a new energy shock. Japanese government bond yields are pinned near multidecade highs.

"There's a realization that the whole energy story and inflation story will not go away in the very

short term," said Societe Generale's head of corporate research for FX and rates Kenneth Broux. "Bond markets are adjusting to that."

For some investors, rising yields have made government bonds attractive again, while others remain cautious towards long-dated bonds given concerns about high government debt.

October will bring new tests in the shape of the latest U.S. jobs and inflation data, French budget talks, a U.K. budget, and likely more bond issuance from tech firms.

Sovereign bond markets matter because they have an impact on loans for businesses and consumers, such as mortgages. If borrowing costs there rise too quickly, that can threaten financial and economic stability, so governments and central banks pay close attention.

Compared with 2022, a year where bond returns were the worst on record, it is not just the speed of the move that is rattling

markets but also the high and rising absolute level of global rates.

Data last week showed the rate on the most popular U.S. home loan has risen to its highest in more than two years.

And 10-year Treasury yields, which have pushed above 5 per cent for the first time since 2007, are poised for the biggest monthly jump since 2022 with a rise of around 50 bps. Yields were up about 4 basis points in afternoon trading on Tuesday.

The ICE BofA MOVE Index, a measure of bond-market volatility, has jumped almost 30 per cent in September, the largest increase since March. That volatility, which is expected to continue, has caught some investors out. But some are sensing an opportunity.

Florian Ielpo, head of macro and multi asset portfolio manager at Lombard Odier Investment Managers, said he had turned more positive on government bonds given high yields.

He expects government bor-

rowing costs to remain higher for some time, too, as the market competes with bond sales by big tech to drive AI investments.

The value of bond sales from hyperscalers has more than doubled this year to more than US\$200-billion, according to LSEG data.

Dealmakers, too, say they can live with funding costs that are the highest since the global financial crisis.

"Five per cent is not so high by historical standards," Warburg Pincus CEO Jeffrey Perlman said at a conference in Singapore on Tuesday. "Deals can work at a 5-per-cent 10-year."

Still, in Europe, French budget talks and a first budget for new U.K. Finance Minister John Healey will likely keep big economies' fiscal woes in focus.

Political tensions in France have added to eye-catching bond moves. Its 10-year bond yield has jumped more than 50 bps this month, the biggest monthly move since 2022, pushing the gap

over German Bund yields to the widest since 2012.

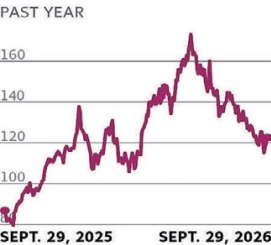
"Now you have the additional idiosyncratic risks in France's case, now people think, where's the budget or there won't be a budget, what's going to happen?," said Nomura senior European economist Andrzej Szczepaniak. "Also now (far-left presidential contender Jean-Luc) Melenchon is gaining popularity in the opinion polls."

In the United States, while a September rate rise has boosted the Federal Reserve's inflation-fighting credentials, uncertainty on the outlook and next steps from a Treasury that has taken some action to rein in borrowing costs were in focus.

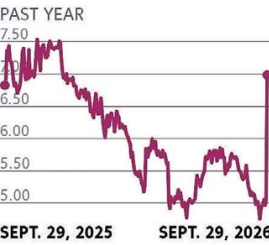
"Policy uncertainty is coming at us from two places, the Fed and the Treasury, and I am deeply uncomfortable about the U.S. policy mix," said Pictet Asset Management senior multi-asset strategist Arun Sai.

REUTERS

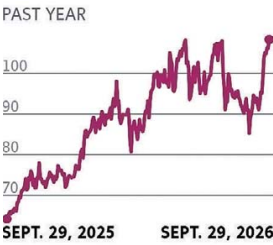
EYE ON EQUITIES DAVID LEEDER



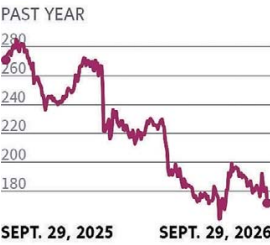
SOURCE: BARCHART
ARITZIA (ATZ-TSX)
CLOSE \$122.59, UP \$2.70



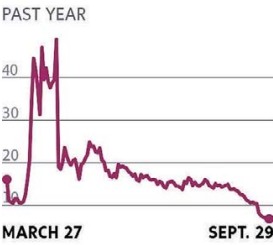
SOURCE: BARCHART
SANGOMA TECH. (STC-TSX)
CLOSE \$6.98, UP \$1.93



SOURCE: BARCHART
FINNING INT'L (FTT-TSX)
CLOSE \$108.24, UP \$2.18



SOURCE: BARCHART
WSP GLOBAL (WSP-TSX)
CLOSE \$171.55, DOWN \$10.53



SOURCE: BARCHART
XANADU QUANTUM (XNDU-TSX)
CLOSE \$6.77, UP 2¢

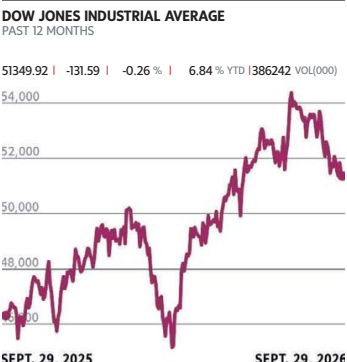
Investors' response to **Aritzia Inc.**'s second-quarter fiscal 2027 on Oct. 8 will revolve almost solely around the retailer's same-store sales growth trajectory, according to Ventum Capital analyst George Doumet. "Q2/F27 is less of a concern, with management noting a slight acceleration from Q1," he added. **Target:** Mr. Doumet cut his target to \$146 from \$186 to "reflect broad-based sector pressure from weak consumer sentiment and economic uncertainty" with a "neutral" rating. Consensus is \$182.63.

TD Cowen analyst David Kwan sees the valuation of **Sangoma Technologies Corp.**'s definitive agreement to be acquired by BRC Holdings Group Inc. properly reflecting the company's "struggles." Accordingly, he lowered his rating for the Toronto-based business communications platform provider to "sell" from "buy" previously. **Target:** Mr. Kwan moved his target to \$7.35 from \$8 to reflect the offer. Consensus is \$9.73.

Stifel analyst Ian Gillies initiated coverage of **Finning International Inc.** with a "buy" rating, seeing it "uniquely exposed to benefit from natural resource development in Canada, Chile and Argentina, and large infrastructure projects in Western Canada." He added: "Its ROIC is recovering to the midteens, which is attractive." **Target:** Mr. Gillies set a target of \$127 for Finning. Consensus is \$121.67.

National Bank Financial analyst Maxim Sytchev sees electricity as a growth market with demand having "reached a structural inflection point globally" and now sees **WSP Global Inc.** poised to capture "a bigger share of wallet." **Target:** Maintaining his "outperform" rating, Mr. Sytchev reduced his target to \$216 from \$219 on "slightly lower H2/26E earnings/FCF projections." Consensus is \$275.13.

RBC Dominion Securities analyst Paul Treiber thinks **Xanadu Quantum Technologies** "provides investors with exposure to quantum computing, a generational opportunity, and photonics, a unique modality." "We believe the shares of Xanadu offer compelling long-term capital appreciation potential as the company progresses toward key technical and funding milestones," he said. **Target:** Mr. Treiber initiated coverage with an "outperform" rating and US\$16 target. Consensus is US\$33.



TSX INDEXES AND SUB INDEXES					
	CLOSE	NET CHG	% CHG	VOL 000s	YTD %CHG
TSX COMPOSITE IND	35460.27	-29.59	-0.08	233898	11.82
TSX 60 INDEX	2086.19	-2.17	-0.10	114096	12.16
TSX COMPLETION IN	2297.23	0.03	0.00	119802	10.46
TSX SMALLCAP INDE	1429.28	-3.28	-0.23	82241	19.45
TSX VENTURE COMPO	887.36	-6.88	-0.77	39954	-10.17
TSX CONSUMER DISC	383.43	1.09	0.29	3194	0.22
TSX CONSUMER STAP	1238.39	-8.72	-0.70	5127	0.02
TSX ENERGY CAPPED	435.45	-5.54	-1.26	43048	44.95
TSX FINANCIALS CA	742.21	-3.57	-0.48	28863	18.28
TSX HEALTH CARE C	22.91	-0.16	-0.69	1670	4.61
TSX INDUSTRIALS C	496.30	-1.21	-0.24	16406	6.27
TSX INFORMATION T	332.65	5.64	1.72	9501	1.85
TSX MATERIALS CAP	836.14	5.10	0.61	59673	11.53
TSX REAL ESTATE C	294.60	-0.83	-0.28	6538	-6.88
TSX GLOBAL GOLD I	897.50	9.51	1.07	117091	9.80
TSX GLOBAL MINING	244.21	1.30	0.54	298546	16.44
TSX INCOME TRUST	225.57	0.78	0.35	7290	2.42
TSX PREFERRED SHA	695.44	-3.20	-0.46	645	-0.11
TSX COMMUNICATION	133.87	-3.05	-2.23	22019	-14.66
TSX UTILITIES CAP	374.29	1.08	0.29	16139	6.24

TSX VOLUME					
TOP 20 FOR STOCKS \$1 OR MORE					
	CLOSE	NET CHG	% CHG	VOL 000s	YTD %CHG
T TELUS CORPORATI	11.57	-0.29	-2.45	12443	-36.04
TRP TC ENERGY COR	82.70	-0.45	-0.54	10117	9.42
CNQ CDN NATURAL R	66.91	-0.47	-0.70	9530	43.92
AQN ALGONQUIN POW	7.17	0.08	1.13	6826	-15.05
BCE BCE INC.	28.62	-0.57	-1.95	6304	-12.58
ATH ATHABASCA OIL	10.20	-0.19	-1.83	6201	45.09
HNU BETAPRO NAT G	8.04	-0.69	-7.90	5890	-50.67
NTR NUTRIEN LTD	101.00	-1.01	-0.99	5869	19.22
WCP WHITECAP RESO	17.51	-0.51	-2.83	5547	52.26
XIU ISHARES SP TS	52.73	-0.03	-0.06	5001	12.22
BN BROOKFIELD COR	51.70	0.32	0.62	4164	-17.96
DND DYE AND DURHA	1.16	0.69	146.81	4091	-72.18
BNS BANK OF NOVA	131.29	-0.28	-0.21	4077	29.69
BB BLACKBERRY LIM	12.34	-0.17	-1.36	3878	138.22
EQX EQUINOX GOLD	16.17	0.23	1.44	3724	-16.17
BTO B2GOLD CORP.	7.58	0.11	1.47	3688	22.65
ENB ENBRIDGE INC	66.21	-0.37	-0.56	3584	0.81
AC AIR CANADA	26.89	0.74	2.83	3940	39.40
TD TORONTO-DOMINI	168.83	-0.77	-0.45	3467	30.51
ABX BARRICK MININ	58.47	0.29	0.50	3042	-2.21

TSX 52-WEEK HIGHS					
STOCKS \$1 OR MORE					
	CLOSE	NET CHG	% CHG	VOL 000s	YTD %CHG
XLY AUXLY CANNABI	3.61	-0.09	-2.43	219	77.83
CGI CDN GENERAL I	52.25	-0.21	-0.40	3	10.58
CAS CASCADES INC	18.57	0.12	0.65	578	49.04
KORX-U GLOBAL X K	14.57	0.03	0.21	1	
GUD KNIGHT THERAP	10.35	0.08	0.78	53	71.07
NUST NBI ULTRA SH	10.04	0.01	0.10	6	

TSX 52-WEEK LOWS					
STOCKS \$1 OR MORE					
	CLOSE	NET CHG	% CHG	VOL 000s	YTD %CHG
BCE BCE INC.	28.62	-0.57	-1.95	6066	-12.58
BBUC BROOKFIELD B	35.81	0.02	0.06	68	-26.99
BN BROOKFIELD COR	51.70	0.32	0.62	4164	-17.96
BEPC BROOKFIELD R	39.84	0.20	0.50	216	-24.33
CP-PR-B CANADIAN	24.15	-0.25	-1.02		-3.86
EIT-PR-B CANOE EI	25.15	-0.05	-0.20	2	-1.14
CCS-PR-C CO-OPERA	22.20	0.00	0.00	3	-2.63
CAC COGECO COMMUN	51.25	-0.58	-1.12	583	-22.90
CGO COGECO INC. S	48.75	-0.30	-0.61	36	-23.82
ELF-PR-H E - L FI	23.34	-0.36	-1.52		-3.95
EFN ELEMENT FLEET	22.51	-0.15	-0.66	2255	-37.56
WN-PR-A GEORGE WE	24.86	-0.23	-0.92	1	-2.20
TMTX-F GLOBAL X 3	49.39	-0.10	-0.20		-0.48
AGGX GLOBAL X CAN	49.67	-0.01	-0.02		-1.08
GWO-PF-A GREAT WE	24.45	-0.05	-0.20	4	-1.69
GWO-PR-Z GREAT WE	24.50	0.13	0.53	5	-3.43
GWO-PR-Q GREAT WE	21.80	-0.21	-0.95	1	-6.48
GWO-PR-S GREAT WE	22.25	-0.30	-1.33	4	-7.29
GWO-PRT GREAT WE	22.03	-0.07	-0.32		-5.73
GWO-PR-M GREAT WE	24.40	-0.23	-0.93	5	-5.35
GWO-PR-L GREATWE	23.80	-0.39	-1.61	5	-5.22
GWO-PR-G GREATWE	22.33	0.02	0.09	5	-5.86
LIF LABRADOR IRON	23.93	-0.69	-2.80	347	-19.89
NEE NEXTERA ENERGY	24.48	0.11	0.45	1	-7.13
PPL-PF-E PEMBINA	25.80	0.17	0.66	1	-1.19
PW-PR-A POWER CO	23.41	-0.38	-1.60	5	-7.14
POW-PR-I POWER CO	24.00	-0.28	-1.15	2	-4.65
POW-PR-G POWER CO	23.43	-0.37	-1.55	2	-6.02
POW-PR-C POWER CO	24.25	-0.25	-1.02	3	-6.73
POW-PR-B POWER FI	22.53	-0.34	-1.49	3	-7.93
PWF-PR-E POWER FI	23.15	-0.22	-0.94	3	-6.16
PWF-PR-Z POWER FI	21.76	-0.30	-1.36	2	-6.00
PWF-PR-O POWER FI	24.44	-0.16	-0.65	1	-3.86

	CLOSE	NET CHG	% CHG	VOL 000s	YTD %CHG
RUS RUSSEL METALS	86.93	0.69	0.80	229	98.47
SEC SENVEST CAPITAL	440.00	0.00	0.00		18.44
SIH-UN SUSTAINABL	17.64	0.75	4.44		31.05
TRP-PR-H TC ENERG	19.30	0.00	0.00	1	14.27
TCS TECSYS INC J	38.89	-0.42	-1.07	13	26.88
WJX WAJAX CORPORA	36.29	1.78	5.16	155	33.22

TSX GAINERS					
TOP 20 FOR STOCKS \$1 OR MORE					
	CLOSE	NET CHG	% CHG	VOL 000s	YTD %CHG
DND DYE AND DURHA	1.16	0.69	146.81	4091	-72.18
STC SANGOMA TECHN	6.98	1.93	38.22	1848	1.31
WILD WILDBRAIN LT	1.30	0.16	14.04	726	-26.55
PDI PDI GOLD LTD	4.80	0.39	8.84	7	-17.24
OLD SAVVYSHORT G	13.47	1.09	8.80	67	-89.93
HND BETAPRO NAT G	23.46	1.78	8.21	1361	-37.69
CSCI COSCIENS BIO	9.25	0.65	7.56		8.57
GIUS GUARDIAN IB	46.05	3.15	7.34		19.24
METU SAVVYSHORT 2X	25.59	1.69	7.07	26	23.38
DLCG DOMINION LEM	9.02	0.56	6.62	11	-9.35
MMP-UN PRECIOUS M	4.51	0.28	6.62		18.37
HOD BETAPRO CRUDE	18.43	1.00	5.74	1728	-87.27
SWP SWISS WATER D	8.32	0.44	5.58	4	88.66
ORBU UNIFIED MATE	9.90	0.50	5.32	32	-47.62
AMAT APPLIED MATE	56.61	2.83	5.26	47	94.34
SHUX SAVVYLONG 2X	10.69	0.53	5.22	15	-39.54
WIJW WAJAX CORPORA	36.29	1.78	5.16	155	33.22
WGX WESTGOLD RESO	5.37	0.25	4.88	81	-6.93
ALC ALGOMA CENTRA	23.82	1.10	4.84	9	26.03
OGD ORBIT GARANT	1.10	0.05	4.76	115	-21.99

TSX LOSERS					
TOP 20 FOR STOCKS \$1 OR MORE					
	CLOSE	NET CHG	% CHG	VOL 000s	YTD %CHG
SLT SALTIRE CAPIT	2.40	-0.40	-14.29		-64.71
AFN AG GROWTH INT	6.19	-0.79	-11.32	654	-73.32
SLTU SALTIRE CAP	1.65	-0.19	-10.33		-67.65
OILU SAVVYLONG GE	54.15	-0.56	-8.70	139	235.29
HNU BETAPRO NAT G	8.04	-0.69	-7.90	5890	-50.67
GASU SAVVYLONG GE	5.60	-0.47	-7.74	26	-49.78
AVL AVALON ADVANC	6.75	-0.55	-7.53	32	-25.00
SYZ SYLOGIST LTD	2.65	-0.21	-7.34	43	-54.07
HBP HELIX BIOPHAR	1.06	-0.08	-7.02	63	-55.27
CRCD HARVEST CIRC	3.63	-0.27	-6.92	106	-37.95
SHP SAVVYSHORT -	5.73	-0.42	-6.83	14	-52.92
XMF-A M SPLIT COR	1.79	-0.13	-6.77		105.75
BLKY HARVEST BLOC	11.73	-0.76	-6.08		2.00
ABXX ABAXX TECHNO	15.50	-1.00	-6.06	174	-69.61
ANRG ANAERGIA INC	2.34	-0.15	-6.02	191	3.54
BRAG BRAGG GAMING	1.79	-0.11	-5.79	29	-37.85
WSP WSP GLOBAL IN	171.55	-10.53	-5.78	1046	-30.97
HOU BETAPRO CRUDE	24.03	-1.47	-5.76	1292	174.00
NOU NOUVEAU MOND	1.67	-0.10	-5.65	344	-50.15
SIS SAVARIA CORP.	28.17	-1.65	-5.53	869	23.66

S&P/TSX COMPOSITE INDEX STOCKS

LARGEST STOCKS BY MARKET CAPITALIZATION

	CLOSE	NET CHG	% CHG	VOL 000s	YTD %CHG		CLOSE	NET CHG	% CHG	VOL 000s	YTD %CHG		CLOSE	NET CHG	% CHG	VOL 000s	YTD %CHG						
VNVP 5N PLUS INC.	30.84	0.14	0.46	667	74.04	CEU CES ENERGY SO	18.00	-0.03	-0.17	447	46.70	JWEL JAMIESON WEL	45.45	0.00	0.00	224	35.07	SHOP SHOPIFY INC	210.04	5.84	2.86	1843	-4.96
ABRA ABRASILVER R	11.92	0.13	1.10	532	11.61	CSH-UN CHARTWELL	20.37	-0.05	-0.24	260	1.34	KNT K92 MINING INC	28.16	0.41	1.48	455	24.11	SIA SIENNA SENIOR	20.19	-0.31	-1.51	433	-1.17
AAV ADVANTAGE ENE	9.70	-0.23	-2.32	908	-17.38	CIH-UN CHOICE PRO	14.63	-0.04	-0.27	681	0.14	KEL KELL EXPLORAT	10.23	-0.29	-2.76	358	33.38	SVM SILVERCORP ME	15.35	-0.09	-0.59	434	33.71
AER AECON GROUP I	52.31	0.91	1.77	372	67.23	CAC COGECO COMMUN	51.25	-0.58	-1.12	583	-22.90	KEY KEYERA CORP	50.74	-1.03	-1.99	1309	15.32	SKE SKEENA RESOUR	42.90	0.54	1.27	255	31.60
AEM AGNICO EAGLE	263.94	2.90	1.11	591	13.40	CIG COLLIFIERS INT	127.79	0.37	0.24	11	-36.66	KMP-UN KILLAM APA	17.37	0.07	0.40	151	5.91	SBU-UN SMARTCENTR	26.71	-0.12	-0.45	316	3.73
AC AIR CANADA	26.89	0.74	2.83	3494	39.40	CSX CONSTELLATION	2896.47	37.47	1.31	64	-12.27	KKS KINAXIS INC	175.27	0.55	0.31	72	1.27	SOBO SOUTH BOW CO	47.13	-0.49	-1.03	747	24.85
AGI ALAMOS GOLD I	46.91	0.53	1.14	931	-11.49	CRB-UN CROMBIE RE	15.99	0.16	1.01	577	4.72	K KINROSS GOLD CO	34.46	0.35	1.03	2175	-10.86	SGX SOUTHERN CRO	11.63	0.08	0.69	467	9.82
AQN ALGONQUIN POW	7.17	0.08	1.13	6826	-15.05	CURA CURALEAF HOL	15.38	0.02	0.13	122	50.34	LIF LABRADOR IRON	23.93	-0.69	-2.80	347	-19.89	SDE SPARTAN DELTA	12.45	-0.40	-3.11	465	71.72
ATD ALIMENTATION	77.96	-0.66	-0.84	1056	4.00	DFV DEFINITY FINA	69.71	-0.63	-0.90	128	-8.19	LB LAURENTIAN BAN	40.67	0.03	0.07	148	0.92	SII SPIRIT INC	170.39	0.33	0.19	39	26.74
AAO ALLIED GOLD	30.23	0.32	1.07	341	-3.88	DML DENISON MINES	3.69	0.03	0.82	1782	1.37	LSQ LIGHTSPEED C	13.88	0.12	0.87	676	-16.18	SSRM SSR MINING I	48.17	0.22	0.46	279	60.49
APUN ALLIED PROP	7.15	-0.20	-2.72	741	-46.52	DSC DESCARTES SYS	112.59	0.89	0.80	385	-6.49	LSO LIGHTSPEED C	13.88	0.12	0.87	676	-16.18	STN STANTEC INC	95.28	-1.92	-1.98	833	-26.44
ALA ALTAIR LTD.	52.28	-0.51	-0.97	581	24.92	DSD DISCOVERY MIN	12.41	0.25	2.05	236	4.47	LUN LUNIMAR CORP	97.97	0.37	0.38	182	18.09	STJ STELLA JONES I	69.65	-0.08	-0.11	151	-18.18
ALS ALUST MINERA	6.03	0.05	0.81	61.95		DGL DGLABRAMA INC	184.64	0.27	-0.15	421	9.99	LCT LITHIUM AMERI	3.74	-0.06	-1.55	1585	-37.35	SCP STRATHCONA RE	38.57	-0.52	-1.33	219	-36.15
AIF AUST GROUP L	44.22	0.10	0.23	113	-22.02	DPM DPM METALS IN	63.48	1.88	3.05	452	49.65	L LOBLAW CO	62.47	-0.52	-0.83	703	0.68	SLF SUN LIFE FINA	112.05	-0.63	-0.56	1191	30.78
USA AMERICAS GOLD	6.39	0.01	0.16	1160	-9.23	DPM DPM DREAM INDU	12.80	-0.09	-0.70	503	1.75	LUN LUNDIN GOLD I	87.76	-1.58	-2.13	386	-20.33	SU SUNCOR ENERGY	95.82	-1.64	-1.68	307	-57.29
ARIS ARIS MINING	25.20	0.40	1.61	616	13.21	EQB EQB INC	126.58	0.13	0.10	46	21.84	LUN LUNDIN MINING	34.45	0.10	0.29	2343	16.78	SPB SUPERIOR PLS	6.96	-0.17	-2.38	782	-1.14
ATZ ARIZIA INC	122.59	2.70	2.25	436	4.47	ELD ELDORADO GOLD	55.24	-0.60	-1.07	883	11.98	MFC MAGNIA INTERNAT	91.48	-0.14	-0.15	620	25.02	TRP TC ENERGY COR	82.70	0.43	0.52	10117	9.42
ACO-X ATCO LTD. C	73.19	-0.54	-0.73	254	29.82	ELF ELEMENTAL FLEET	22.51	-0.15	-0.66	2255	-37.56	MC MANULIFE FIN	61.57	-0.09	-0.15	2626	23.54	TXT TMO GROUP LIMIT	52.43	-1.07	-2.00	434	-0.38
ATL ATKINS RESOUR	85.04	-0.98	-1.14	348	-4.02	EMA EMERA INCORPO	67.93	0.28	0.41	718	0.43	MFI MAPLE LEAF FO	25.58	-0.04	-0.16	234	2.61	TXV TAMARACK VALL	13.04	-0.21	-1.58	1325	63.41
ATS ATS CORPORATI	25.99	-0.67	-2.51	241	-31.26	EMP EMPIRE COMPT	48.29	0.27	0.56	551	1.19	MDA MDA SPACE LTD	42.15	-1.79	-4.07	171	58.22	TECK-B TECK RESOU	91.97	-0.20	-0.22	1087	39.96
ASM AVINO SILVER	7.98	0.03	0.38	509	-6.56	ENB ENBRIDGE INC	66.21	-0.37	-0.56	3584	-0.81	MX METHANEX CORP	84.34	-0.42	-0.50	179	54.92	T TLUS CORPORATI	11.57	-2.39	-2.42	12443	-36.04
AYA AYA GOLD	38.51	0.86	2.28	983	96.08	ENR ENDEAVOUR SIL	12.38	-0.33	-2.60	1938	-4.11	MRU METRO INC	90.53	0.02	0.02	537	-8.36	TVK TERRAVEST IND	110.46	-2.39	-2.12	72	-32.86
						EFX ENERGY FUELS	32.15	-1.32	-3.94	619	51.94	MTL MONTAGE GOLD	19.56	0.65	3.34	704	97.98	TFI TFI INTERNAT	171.95	-1.22	-0.70	190	21.20
BTO B2GOLD CORP.	7.58	0.11	1.47	3688	22.65	EQO EQUINOX GOLD	16.17	0.23	1.44	3724	-16.17	NA NATIONAL BANK	207.80	-2.35	-1.12	1692	20.39	NWC THE NORTH WES	54.50	0.18	0.33	177	11.43
BCE BCE INC.	28.62	-0.57	-1.95	6304	-12.58	EQX EQUINOX GOLD	52.71	0.31	-0.58	235	35.75	NFX NEXGEN ENERGY	12.81	0.06	0.47	736	1.43	TRI THOMSON REUTE	136.61	-1.13	-0.82	615	-24.58
BGGI BADGER INFRA	94.60	3.32	3.64	133	29.36	ERO ERO COPPER CO	52.61	0.31	-0.58	235	35.75	NFI NFI GROUP INC	24.63	0.68	2.84	362	58.70	TPZ TOPAZ ENERGY	28.34	-0.53	-1.84	398	2.90
BMS BANK OF MONTR	240.69	-1.97	-0.81	1027	35.03	EIF EXCHANGE INCO	125.30	1.72	1.39	214	52.88	NGX NGX MINERAL	24.97	0.35	1.42	162	-2.42	TXP Torex GOLD RE	69.68	2.04	3.02	456	6.30
BNO BANK OF NOVA	131.29	-0.28	-0.21	4077	29.69	EIE EXTENDICARE I	30.60	-0.62	-1.99	526	43.83	NPI NPI NORTHLAND POW	22.62	0.62	2.82	1550	26.76	TH THOROMONT IND	226.12	-0.55	-0.24	217	36.18
ABX BARRICK MININ	58.47	0.29	0.50	3042	-2.21	FFH FAIRFAX FINAN	2225.32	16.23	0.73	31	-14.93	NOG NOVAGOLD RES I	9.31	-0.11	-1.17	733	-27.27	TO TORONTO-DOMINI	168.83	-0.77	-0.45	3467	30.51
BHC BAUSCH HEALTH	8.20	0.00	0.00	327	-13.96	FTT FINNING INTL	108.24	2.18	2.06	307	45.54	NTR NUTRIENT LTD	10.00	-0.46	-0.45	5869	19.22	TOU TOURMALINE OI	59.81	-1.15	-1.89	1874	-2.86
BTE BAYTEX ENERGY	6.33	-0.09	-1.40	2708	42.57	FG FIRST GEN INC	22.76	-0.19	-0.83	307	45.54	OR OR ROYALTIES I	48.61	0.15	0.31	188	-0.02	TRA TRANSALTA CORP	16.76	-0.04	-0.24	960	-3.46
BTD BIRCHCLIFF EN	17.99	-0.42	-2.39	183	61.98	AGT FIRST AG MATJEST	25.63	0.19	0.75	1399	11.92	OGC OCEANOGAL CORP	39.33	1.12	2.93	1215	1.11	TRK TREKOR METALS	12.56	0.10	0.80	989	61.65
BTR BOND CONSTRUC	80.50	2.04	2.60	299	182.26	FM FIRST QUANTUM	45.12	0.29	0.65	1559	22.36	ONEX ONEX CORPORA	103.44	-1.86	-1.77	153	-8.43	TFM TRIPLE FLAG	14.04	0.37	0.85	116	-3.44
BLK BLACKBERRY LIM	12.34	-0.17	-1.36	3878	138.22	FV FIRSTSERVICE	182.79	0.04	0.02	98	-14.61	OTEX OTEX TEXT CO	31.67	0.21	0.67	831	-29.15	TSU TRISURA GROUP	41.13	0.17	0.42	27	-3.72
BEI-UN BOARDWALK	61.16	-0.12	-0.20	55	-5.15	FTS FORTIS INC	75.23	-0.01	-0.01	1193	5.42	PAAS PAN AMERICAN	65.48	0.62	0.96	642	-7.98	WSP WSP GLOBAL IN	171.55	-0.16	-5.59	1046	-30.97
BBB-B BOMBARDIER	320.37	-0.20	-0.06	202	37.20	FVI FORTUNA MININ	16.11	0.19	1.19	524	19.78	POU PARAMOUNT RES	29.02	-0.61	-2.06	264	19.97	WNC WASTE CONNECT	220.82	-0.44	-0.20	2599	-8.27
BYD BOYD GROUP SE	111.95	1.17	1.06	106	-48.79	FRV FRANCO-NEVADA	352.11	3.33	0.95	282	23.76	PXT PEXAR RESOURC	26.68	-0.41	-1.51	404	44.61	WOD WESDOME GOLD	35.15	0.15	0.43	532	54.54
BAM BROOKFIELD AS	63.75	0.81	1.29	1194	-11.34	FNU FREEHOLD ROYAL	16.42	-0.35	-2.09	588	8.10	PPL PEMBINA PIPEL	63.22	-0.67	-1.05	1961	20.90	WFG WEST FRASER T	100.42	-1.04	-1.03	65	19.59
BMC BROOKFIELD B	35.81	0.02	0.06	68	-26.99	GMIN G MINING VEN	49.39	0.86	1.77	299	19.04	PPA PERPETUA RES	30.57	-0.34	-1.10	74	-8.00	WN WESTON GENEPR	101.39	-0.95	-0.93	166	7.08
BN BROOKFIELD COR	51.70	0.32	0.62	4164	-17.96	GFL GFL ENVIRONME	59.84	1.07	1.82	623	21.62	PEY PEYTO EXPLORA	22.88	-0.55	-2.35	914	0.75	WPM WHEATON PRECI	191.82	-0.99	-0.10	1243	18.88
BIP-UN BROOKFIELD	50.36	0.98	1.98	464	5.55	GIB GIBSON ENERGY	30.30	-0.63	-2.04	957	10.49	PPW POWER CORPORA	91.53	-1.25	-1.35	1438	25.47	WSP WHITECAP RESO	17.51	-0.45	-2.51	5547	52.26
BRP-UN BROOKFIELD	39.76	0.21	0.53	350	7.20	GIL GILSAN ACTIVE	60.69	0.27	0.45	491	-29.26	PSK PRAIRIESKY RO	33.01	-0.43	-1.29	508	22.12						
DOO BRP INC	81.49	0.01	1.25	278	-16.03	GRT-UN GRANITE RE	84.39	-0.19	-1.28	60	3.28	PBH PREMIUM BRAND	70.30	-0.95	-1.33	307	-30.88						
						GWO GREAT-WEST LI	90.74	-2.00	-2.16	1462	34.05	PMZ-UN PRIMARIS R	21.99	-0.11	-0.50	382	41.05						
CAR-UN CNO APARTM	31.55	0.05	0.16	545	-14.43	HPS-A HAMMOND POW	287.09	6.39	2.28	56	80.02	QBR-B QUEBECOR IN	60.37	-1.91	-3.07	784	16.77						
CNQ CNO NATURAL R	66.91	-0.47	-0.70	9530	43.92	HWX HEADWATER EXP	13.25	-0.23	-1.71	1050	41.41	RBA RB GLOBAL INC	115.45	0.89	0.78	166	-18.30						
GIB-A CGI INC	95.83	-0.07	-0.07	717	-24.41	HRH-HR REAL EST	9.52	0.05	0.53	784	-6.94	OSR OSTRANDT BR	101.44	0.18	0.18	597	8.31						
CRT-UN CRT REAL ES	16.99	-0.02	-0.12	71	4.43	HMU HUBBARD MINERA	38.35	0.22	0.58	1103	40.73	RCH RICHELIEU HAR	36.39	-0.02	-0.05	48	-8.01						
CAE CAE INC	34.39	-0.01	-0.03	1037	-17.61	H HYDRO ONE LIMIT	51.06	0.20	0.39	1416	-6.55	REI-UN ROCAN REA	20.75	-1.00	-0.48	869	10.90						
CCO CANEKO CORP	123.29	-0.16	-0.13	683	-1.90	IAG I AG FINANCIAL	206.84	-1.04	-0.50	248	16.31	RCB RCB ROGERS COMM	43.83	-0.74	-1.66	2240	-15.46						
CMC CANADIAN IMPER	158.57	-0.51	-0.32	1727	27.44	IGM IGM FINANCIAL	83.00	-0.50	-0.60	365	34.28	RY ROYAL BANK OF	283.28	-1.79	-0.63	2735	21.06						
CNR CANADIAN IMAT	171.14	-0.47	-0.27	635	26.07	IGM IGM FINANCIAL	83.00	-0.50	-0.60	365	34.28	SAP SAPUTO INC.	39.97	-0.83	-2.03	1215	-3.24						
CP CANADIAN PACIF	122.68	0.07	0.06	1018	-21.41	IGM IGM FINANCIAL	83.00	-0.50	-0.60	365	34.28	SEA SEABRIDGE GOL	40.80	0.37	0.92	69	0.27						
CTC-A CANADIAN TI	192.18	0.58	0.30	165	14.09	IGM IGM FINANCIAL	83.00	-0.50	-0.60	365	34.28												
CU CANADIAN UTILI	50.59	-0.30	-0.59	627	18.39	IGM IGM FINANCIAL	83.00	-0.50	-0.60	365	34.28												
CPX CAPITAL POWER	61.48	0.04	0.07	413	5.00	IGM IGM FINANCIAL	83.00	-0.50	-0.60	365	34.28												

MAPLE LEAFS VS. CANADIENS



Ready to roll

Maple Leafs forward Kirill Marchenko, right, tries a wraparound on Canadiens goaltender Jakub Dobes during the second period in Toronto on Tuesday. Montreal won, 3-2. For more on the Maple Leafs, head to ■ GLOBESPORTS.COM

NATHAN DENETTE/THE CANADIAN PRESS

From first to worst: Where did it go wrong for the Blue Jays in 2026?

GREGORY STRONG TORONTO

Quiet bats and a string of injuries to starting pitchers helped prevent the Toronto Blue Jays from returning to the postseason. With team brass set to hold season-ending availabilities Wednesday, here's a look at what went wrong with the Blue Jays this year and where they might go from here.

OFF-SEASON

First baseman Vladimir Guerrero Jr. was on top of the world last fall as he showed why the team rewarded him with a lucrative long-term contract. Guerrero was a monster at the plate and led the team to within a whisker of a World Series crown. His drop-off in production this year was remarkable. Guerrero hit eight home runs in the postseason alone last year but managed just nine dingers in the entire 2026 campaign. He posted career lows in batting av-



Blue Jays first baseman Vladimir Guerrero Jr. breaks his bat in frustration after grounding out against the St. Louis Cardinals in Toronto on Aug. 1. SAMMY KOGAN/THE CANADIAN PRESS

erage (.260), slugging percentage (.356) and OPS (.688) this season. The 27-year-old is signed through 2039. Getting him back on track is one of the top priorities for the club.

STARTER WOES

Free-agent signing Dylan Cease was as advertised in his first season with the Blue Jays. However, the rest of the starting pitchers endured ups and downs, with injuries a consistent storyline. Cody Ponce (knee), José Berrios (elbow) and Bowden Francis (elbow) were all lost for the season, while Trey Yesavage (knee, shoulder) and Shane Bieber (elbow, shoulder) had multiple stints on the injured list. Former ace Kevin Gausman had a so-so first half before being dealt to Chicago, while trade-deadline acquisition José Soriano showed he could be a solid No. 2 behind Cease. Max Scherzer had injury issues (forearm, ankle, back) throughout the year but was dependable down the stretch. ■ BLUE JAYS, B14

Leafs' GM says Marchenko will be a great fit with team

JOSHUA CLIPPERTON TORONTO

John Chayka placed another big bet on his Maple Leafs. The team's new general manager also felt it was more than worth the risk. Chayka spoke with the media ahead of Toronto's regular-season opener against the Montreal Canadiens, less than 24 hours after completing a blockbuster trade to secure the services of skilled winger Kirill Marchenko from the Columbus Blue Jackets. "There's a lot of good players in the NHL," Chayka said Tuesday morning at Scotiabank Arena. "Very few that can impact winning and can single-handedly dictate outcomes of games, and

we believe that Kirill is one of those players. "You gotta give up quality to get quality. We gave up some quality people and some quality players." That list of what headed the other way was topped by Matthew Knies – a big, strong winger with skill of his own on a team-friendly contract. Despite all those attributes, and being three years younger than Marchenko at age 23, his name had been swirling in rumours since the previous regime was in charge at last March's NHL trade deadline. "I apologized to [Knies] for the noise over the last several months," Chayka said. "I don't think it was necessarily fair to

him. This was the only thing we seriously considered as a management group. These things happen. He understands ... he's a professional athlete and he's a smart kid. "It's a good fit for him." The Maple Leafs are banking on the same for Marchenko – who was cleared to play in Toronto's season opener – in hockey's biggest media market. The team announced Tuesday that they have signed the winger to a six-year extension that agent Dan Milstein has said is worth US\$75-million. He is signed for this season at an average annual value of US\$3.85-million. The 6-foot-3, 201-pound Russian had 102 goals and 106 assists for 208 points across 292 games

with Columbus after being selected 49th overall at the 2018 draft. Marchenko, who made his NHL debut in 2022 after a stint in the KHL, led the Blue Jackets with 27 goals and added 40 assists last season to finish second in team scoring with 67 points in 76 contests. "A unique player," Chayka said. "To be able to lock him up through those prime years and a number that we think is effective for us, you put that all together, we thought it was a special opportunity." The Maple Leafs also got goaltender Elvis Merzlikins – currently on long-term injured reserve with a shoulder injury expected to keep him out roughly another

five months – and winger Miles Wood. Veteran centre Steven Lorentz, defenceman Emil Andrae and a second-round pick, meanwhile, made up the rest of the package heading to the Blue Jackets. Knies battled injury last season, but still finished with a career-best 66 points (23 goals, 43 assists) in 79 contests. "Columbus is getting a horse with him, and just [a] good person, good player," Toronto defenceman Chris Tanev said of the 6-foot-3, 223-pound forward. "He'll be missed here. It's the [expletive] part of the business, but we're welcoming in an amazing player that I've heard nothing but great things about." ■ LEAFS, B14

Dahlin eager to kick on after snapping playoff drought

Sabres will lean on their young core in hopes of building on last year's playoff success

JOHN WAWROW BUFFALO, N.Y.

Rasmus Dahlin arrived in Buffalo for the start of training camp with a clear head and a refreshed objective following the shortest summer break of his nine-year NHL career.

This is a far different place for the Sabres captain to be more than a year ago, when Dahlin was dealing with the emotional weight of his fiancée requiring life-saving heart transplant surgery in Europe and facing familiar questions regarding Buffalo's NHL-record 14-season playoff drought.

A year later, Carolina Matovac is healthy and rejoined Dahlin in Buffalo in March. The drought is a thing of the past: The Sabres clinched their first Atlantic Division title and won their first playoff series since 2007 before losing to Montreal in Game 7 in the second round.

"Night and day. I can actually focus on hockey and not have to worry every day of what's going on," Dahlin said. "I'm ready to go."

Don't confuse his readiness for satisfaction. Having enjoyed his first taste of the postseason, the 26-year-old Swede is hungry for more.

"Last year was hard. This year is going to be harder," Dahlin said. "We have higher expectations on ourselves and higher expectations around the league. We're not the same old Sabres any more in other teams' eyes."

The challenge is to prove last year was no fluke in preparing to



Buffalo Sabres defenceman Rasmus Dahlin has been rejoined in Buffalo by his fiancée Carolina Matovac, who is healthy after requiring life-saving heart transplant surgery.
JEFFREY T. BARNES/
THE ASSOCIATED PRESS

open this season at Columbus on Thursday. The Sabres will do so with a young roster that got even younger following a summer in which top-line forward Alex Tuch was traded to Washington and defenceman Bowen Byram to Chicago.

Though both played key roles in Buffalo's breakthrough season, general manager Jarmo Kekalainen is banking on the promise a brimming crop of youngsters showed last year.

It's a 24-and-younger forward group that includes Josh Doan, Zach Benson, Noah Ostlund and Konsta Helenius. They're being counted upon to provide Buffalo a three-line scoring attack alongside veterans Tage Thompson, Josh Norris, Peyton Krebsbs and Jason Zucker.

On defence, Buffalo shored up its core of Dahlin, Mattias Samuelsson and Owen Power by acquiring Louis Crevier and Olen Zellweger in trades.

"With the talent that we have internally, I think we need to believe in the work that we've put in to develop them, grow with them, and now they're ready," said Kekalainen, who is entering his first full season on the job in Buffalo.

He declined to address speculation surrounding Winnipeg Jets goalie Connor Hellebuyck, a three-time Vezina Trophy winner who has gone public with his trade demands. Kekalainen would only say he is confident in Buffalo's three-goalie rotation headed by Ukko-Pekka Luukkonen and Alex Lyon, both coming off 20-win seasons.

"By no means are we satisfied," Kekalainen said, in assessing last season's success. "Pretty good; I

said to the team. Pretty good's not good enough."

His promotion from senior adviser following Kevyn Adams's firing in mid-December spurred the Sabres' turnaround. Buffalo went from last in the Eastern Conference standings to its first 50-win season since 2006-07, closing the year on a 39-9-5 run.

The Sabres are counting on a better start to this year, while building on their scrappy identity and consistency in play.

"We've been battle-tested," said Thompson, before cautioning last year's results don't count for anything this year. "It doesn't give us a free ride to the same spot. We're going to have to earn it."

At 66, Sabres coach Lindy Ruff was rewarded with a two-year contract extension in May, and enters his third season in his second stint in Buffalo. He ranks third on the NHL list with 1,938 games coached and fourth with 950 wins. Ruff laughed when reminded a 50-win season would get him to 1,000.

"I've been around too long," Ruff said with a chuckle. "But 50 would be really important for our team, because if you get 50, you're going to be a playoff team. I think that's a great goal for us as a group for sure."

Ruff on Tuesday said Samuelsson (lower body) is "very close" to returning a week after getting hurt blocking a shot. ... Lyon (upper body) is anticipated to resume practising soon after missing a week. Luukkonen practised on Tuesday after pulling himself from Buffalo's preseason finale on Saturday. ... Veteran forward Conor Sheary was lent to AHL Rochester, but must first clear waivers.

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MLB PLAYOFFS

WILDCARD SERIES

(Best-of-3; All Times Eastern)
(x – played only if necessary)

AMERICAN LEAGUE

HOUSTON (3) VS. CHI. WHITE SOX (6)
(Chicago White Sox leads series 1-0)

Tuesday
Chicago 6 Houston 3
Wednesday
Chicago at Houston, 5 p.m.
Thursday
x-Chicago at Houston, TBA

N.Y. YANKEES (4) VS. BOSTON (5)
Tuesday
Boston at New York
Wednesday
Boston at New York, 8 p.m.
Thursday
x-Boston at New York, 8 p.m.

NATIONAL LEAGUE

ATLANTA (3) VS. PHILADELPHIA (6)
(Atlanta leads series 1-0)

Tuesday
Atlanta 5 Philadelphia 3
Wednesday
Philadelphia at Atlanta, 2 p.m.
Thursday
x-Philadelphia at Atlanta, 2 p.m.

SAN DIEGO (4) VS. CHICAGO CUBS (5)
Tuesday
San Diego vs. Chicago Cubs
Wednesday
Chicago at San Diego, 10 p.m.

WNBA PLAYOFFS

FIRST ROUND

(Best-of-3; All Times Eastern)
(x – played only if necessary)

NEW YORK VS. MINNESOTA
(New York leads series 1-0)

Tuesday
Minnesota at New York
x-Thursday, October 1
New York at Minnesota, 7 p.m.

NO. 3 LAS VEGAS VS. NO. 6 INDIANA
(Las Vegas leads series 1-0)

Tuesday
Las Vegas at Indiana
x-Thursday, October 1
Indiana at Las Vegas, 9 p.m.

NO. 4 ATLANTA VS. NO. 5 WASHINGTON
(Atlanta leads series 1-0)

Wednesday
Atlanta at Washington, 7 p.m.
x-Friday, October 2
Washington at Atlanta, TBA

NO. 2 GOLDEN STATE VS. NO. 7 DALLAS
(Golden State leads series 1-0)

Wednesday
Golden State at Dallas, 9 p.m.

NHL

Tuesday
Florida at Carolina
Montreal at Toronto
N.Y. Rangers at Boston
Vancouver at Edmonton
Chicago at Vegas

Wednesday
All Times Eastern
N.Y. Islanders at Toronto, 7:30 p.m.
Pittsburgh at Philadelphia, 7:30 p.m.
Los Angeles at Colorado, 10 p.m.

OHL

EASTERN CONFERENCE

EAST DIVISION										
GP	W	L	OL	SL	GF	GA	Pts			
Brantford	5	5	0	0	29	10	10			
Oshawa	5	3	2	0	17	17	6			
Kingston	5	2	3	0	19	26	4			
Ottawa	3	1	1	0	11	16	3			
Peterborough	5	1	4	0	16	23	2			

CENTRAL DIVISION										
GP	W	L	OL	SL	GF	GA	Pts			
Sudbury	4	4	0	0	17	5	8			
Niagara	4	2	2	0	13	11	4			
North Bay	4	2	2	0	13	15	4			
Brampton	5	0	5	0	10	22	0			
Barrie	4	0	4	0	5	17	0			

WESTERN CONFERENCE

MIDWEST DIVISION										
GP	W	L	OL	GF	GA	Pts				
Kitchener	5	3	2	0	17	12	6			
London	3	3	0	0	16	8	6			
Erie	3	2	0	1	12	8	5			
Guelph	4	2	2	0	12	12	4			
Owen Sound	4	1	3	0	7	16	2			

WEST DIVISION										
GP	W	L	OL	SL	GF	GA	Pts			
Sarnia	4	3	1	0	23	16	6			
S.S. Marie	4	3	1	0	19	15	6			
Flint	3	2	1	0	11	11	4			
Windsor	4	1	2	1	12	16	3			
Saginaw	4	1	2	1	16	19	3			

Monday-Wednesday
No games scheduled

Thursday — All Times Eastern
Niagara at Barrie, 7 p.m.
Erie at Peterborough, 7:05 p.m.
North Bay at Windsor, 7:05 p.m.

QMJHL

Monday-Tuesday
No games scheduled

Wednesday
All Times Eastern
Charlottetown at Victoriaville, 7 p.m.

Thursday
Charlottetown at Chicoutimi, 7 p.m.
Shawinigan at Gatineau, 7 p.m.
Rimouski at Sherbrooke, 7 p.m.

WHL

Monday-Tuesday
No games scheduled

Wednesday
All Times Eastern
Red Deer at Prince Albert, 9 p.m.

MLS

EASTERN CONFERENCE

x-Nashville	27	18	3	6	55	21	60
New England	27	14	9	4	45	36	46
Miami	27	12	5	10	64	50	46
Charlotte	27	12	8	7	47	38	43
Chicago	26	12	8	6	46	38	42
Philadelphia	27	11	10	6	54	44	39
Orlando	27	10	13	4	48	64	34
N.Y. Red Bulls	26	9	11	6	34	48	33
Cincinnati	26	8	9	9	55	64	33
N.Y. City F.C.	27	8	10	9	41	36	33
D.C.	26	6	8	12	34	42	30
Columbus	27	8	14	5	39	43	29
Toronto	27	6	10	11	39	51	29
Atlanta	27	7	14	6	32	45	27
Montreal	27	6	15	6	34	54	24

WESTERN CONFERENCE

Vancouver	26	15	6	5	59	26	50
Dallas	27	13	6	8	50	42	47
San Jose	27	13	6	8	49	39	44
St. Louis	26	12	6	8	45	36	44
Houston	27	13	9	5	34	32	44
Los Angeles F.C.	28	11	9	8	43	30	41
Colorado	27	11	13	3	38	38	36
L.A. Galaxy	28	9	10	9	37	44	36
Seattle	26	9	9	8	33	34	35
Portland	27	9	13	5	48	51	32
Salt Lake City	27	9	13	5	40	44	32
San Diego	27	8	11	8	47	47	32
Austin	27	7	10	10	35	47	31
Minnesota	27	7	12	8	40	49	29
Kansas City	26	6	17	3	31	63	21

x-axis: clinched playoff berth

x — clinched playoff berth

Wednesday
All Times Eastern
St. Louis at N.Y. Red Bulls, 7:30 p.m.

Thursday
Kansas City at Seattle, 9:30 p.m.

Tuesday, Oct. 6
Vancouver at Chicago, 8:30 p.m.

ENGLAND

PREMIER LEAGUE

Brentford	5	5	0	0	13	5
Leeds	5	2	3	0	7	3
Liverpool	5	2	3	0	7	4
Everton	5	2	3	0	6	3
Hull	5	2	2	1	6	4
Newcastle	5	2	2	1	9	9
Chelsea	5	2	1	2	10	12
Ipswich	5	2	0	3	7	11
Man United	5	1	2	2	8	8
Notting. Forest	5	1	2	2	4	5
Sunderland	5	1	1	3	6	10
Crystal Palace	5	1	1	3	6	11
Aston Villa	5	1	1	3	4	9
Bournemouth	5	0	3	2	6	8
Coventry	5	1	0	4	1	10
Fulham	5	0	2	3	5	8
Tottenham	5	0	2	3	2	8

x — won the league title

INTERNATIONAL
SEASON RESUMES SAT, OCT. 10

CPL

	GP	W	L	T	GF	GA	P
x-Calgary	23	16	2	5	48	13	53
x-Hamilton	23	14	4	5	35	17	47
Ottawa	24	11	9	4	35	39	37
Vancouver	25	9	10	6	35	33	33
Halifax	24	7	12	5	35	39	26
Quebec	23	7	12	4	31	44	25
Toronto	23	5	9	9	36	53	24
Victoria	23	2	13	8	30	47	14
x — clinched playoff berth							

x — clinched playoff berth

Wednesday
All Times Eastern
Calgary at Ottawa, 7 p.m.

Saturday, Oct. 3
Calgary at Toronto, 12 p.m.
Halifax at Hamilton, 4 p.m.

Sunday, Oct. 4
Calgary at Toronto, 4 p.m.

NSL

x-Toronto	22	10	5	7	36	21	37
Ottawa	22	11	8	3	44	41	36
Vancouver	22	8	11	3	41	47	27
Halifax	22	7	10	5	21	21	26
Calgary	22	4	13	5	25	52	17

x — clinched playoff berth

Friday
Ottawa at Montreal, 7 p.m.

x — clinched playoff berth

Friday
Ottawa at Montreal, 7 p.m.

Saturday, Oct. 3
Calgary at Halifax, 2 p.m.

Sunday, Oct. 4
Vancouver at Toronto, 1 p.m.

ATP WORLD TOUR

CHENGDU OPEN

Tuesday
At Chengdu, China
Purse: \$1,210,115
Surface: Hardcourt outdoor
MEN'S SINGLES — CHAMPIONSHIP
Alejandro Davidovich Fokina (2), Spain, def. Hubert Hurkacz (5), Poland, 6-4, 7-6 (7).

MEN'S DOUBLES — CHAMPIONSHIP
Luke Johnson, Britain, and Jan Zieliński, Poland, def. Andre Goransson, Sweden, and Robert Galloway (4), United States, 7-6 (7), 7-5.

HANGZHOU OPEN

Tuesday
At Hangzhou, China
Purse: \$1,039,090
Surface: Hardcourt outdoor
MEN'S DOUBLES — CHAMPIONSHIP
Francisco Cabral, Portugal, and James Tracy (3), United States, def. David Pell and Sander Arends, Netherlands, 7-5, 6-4.

CFL

EAST DIVISION

	GP	W	L	PF	PA	Pt
x-Montreal	14	11	3	498	410	22
x-Toronto	15	9	6	445	431	18
Hamilton	15	4	11	362	458	8
Ottawa	14	0	14	339	524	0

WEST DIVISION

x-Edmonton	15	11	4	470	382	22
British Columbia	14	8	6	428	381	16
Saskatchewan	14	8	6	399	371	16
Winnipeg	14	7	7	373	382	14
Calgary	15	7	8	535	510	14



Toronto Raptors guard RJ Barrett attacks against Jarrett Allen of the Cleveland Cavaliers in Game 7 of the first round of the NBA Eastern Conference playoffs on May 3. JASON MILLER/GETTY IMAGES

Barrett playing it cool on contract extension with Raptors

In the last year of his current deal, the homegrown Raptor says he has full confidence in his agent’s negotiating ability

JOHN CHIDLEY-HILL TORONTO

RJ Barrett smiled when he heard a question about his contract extension at Toronto Raptors media day, because he knew it was coming. Barrett, from Mississauga, Ont., did everything that had been asked of him last season – be more efficient, get more rebounds, play more defence – and even excelled in Toronto’s playoff run. But he still doesn’t have a contract extension for the 2027-28 season. “I was waiting for that one, that was a good question, brother. How am I gonna answer that?” said Barrett on Monday. Barrett averaged 19.3 points, 5.3 rebounds, 3.3 assists, 0.7 steals and 0.3 blocks, with a 49.1 field-goal percentage, over 57 games last season. All those numbers were near or above his career averages and, significantly, his 1.7 turnovers per game were a career low. The highlight of his season was in Game 6 of Toronto’s first-round playoff series against the Cleveland Cavaliers. He

hit a 29-foot three-pointer in the dying seconds of overtime to lift the undermanned Raptors to a 112-110 win and stave off elimination for one more game. “I think the playoffs are the biggest stage, so to be able to just show and prove who I already know that I am, that was pretty cool,” said Barrett. “And then terms of extension and all that stuff, I don’t control any of that stuff. “I just control my effort and what I do and how I train, how I come in to try to help the team. I’m just going to continue to control the things I can control.” The 26-year-old is entering the final year of his current contract where he’ll earn US\$29.6-million before becoming a free agent in the off-season. Barrett’s next deal will allow him to make up to US\$44-million a season, but the Raptors are already well above NBA’s salary cap for 2027-28 with fellow starters Kawhi Leonard, Scottie Barnes, Immanuel Quickley and Jakob Poeltl signed to lucrative multiyear deals. Leonard’s is the most recent. He signed a two-year, US\$115-million contract extension on Sept. 23, a team-friendly deal that kept the Raptors below the first apron of salary cap penalties. Raptors vice-president of basketball operations and general manager Bobby Webster was asked Thursday if Leonard’s extension would affect Toronto’s ability to resign Barrett.

“No, I think ownership has been incredibly supportive,” said Webster, referring to Maple Leaf Sports & Entertainment. “Any time, financially, we want to make a go for it they’ve been very supportive.” Barrett said he was leaving all the negotiating – and worrying – up to his representation. “For anybody who doesn’t know, my agent is Bill Duffy, [Barnes’s] agent too. I have a pretty good agent, so I don’t really worry about stuff,” said Barrett. “I think if I thought he wasn’t good, I might worry a little bit.” Webster was also asked at his news conference last week if there was any wiggle room in general to make tweaks to the current Raptors lineup for a deep postseason push. “We have a first-round pick in each of the next four years, I think that’s probably important to note,” said Webster, implying that the picks could be part of a trade package to shed salary cap. “I think we’re a million over the tax, but similar to last year, we can see how it goes. You can get under it if you need to but you can add to it if you felt like the team is in position [to win]. If we want to go for it, we can still go for it. “There’s definitely more left on the bone.”

THE CANADIAN PRESS

Parents of Arizona State hockey player who collapsed call for coaches to be placed on leave

JOHN MARSHALL TEMPE, ARIZ.

The parents of an Arizona State hockey player who collapsed during an outdoor workout are calling for the coaches involved to be removed until an independent investigation is completed. John and Christina Mayich, parents of 21-year-old Matthew Mayich, released a statement through the family attorney on Tuesday, concurring with a letter sent by seven Arizona State hockey players to university president Michael Crow on Monday. The players asked the university to place the coaches involved in the Aug. 20 workout on administrative leave until an investigation by an outside agency is completed. The letter was sent anonymously through an attorney because the players feared retribution from the coaching staff. “We’ve heard some things about what

our family wants that aren’t right, so we want to be clear: we want this team to have a great season and we’ll be cheering for you,” the Mayichs said through attorney Rob Carey. “But the coaches who ran that workout on Aug. 20 need to be removed while an independent investigation gets to the truth. The players shouldn’t have to worry about retaliation from the people they report to every day.” Mayich, a 21-year-old defenceman who was drafted by the St. Louis Blues, collapsed during an outdoor workout on the first day the NCAA allows official activities. He suffered from external heat stroke that reduced flow of oxygen to his brain and is unlikely to recover, Carey said. The letter sent by the players called out discrepancies from an initial probe by Arizona State and asked for an interim coaching staff be put in place if the coaches involved are placed on leave.

“Nobody should keep quiet about what they think should happen because they believe that’s what we want. It isn’t,” the Mayichs said. “If anyone wants to know what we want, ask us. We want the truth, and we want it done in a way that lets the boys focus on hockey instead of wondering whether their coaches think they talked. Mostly, we want accountability for what happened to our son, and we want his teammates to be safe.” The Arizona State police department is investigating the incident and a report will be sent to the Maricopa County Attorney’s Office for independent review when completed. Arizona’s House and Senate education committee chairs called for an independent investigation of Arizona State’s hockey workout after reading the letter from the players.

THE ASSOCIATED PRESS

Senators name Thomas Chabot as new captain

Thomas Chabot is the Ottawa Senators’ newest captain after Brady Tkachuk’s off-season departure. The Senators announced during a news conference Tuesday that the 29-year-old defenceman will wear the ‘C’ for the 2026-27 season. Claude Giroux, Tim Stutzle and Jake Sanderson will serve as alternate captains. A native of Sainte-Marie, Que., Chabot is the longest-serving active Senator, having played through seven playoff-less years before the team cracked the postseason in 2024-25. He made his NHL debut in 2016-17 after being selected 18th overall by Ottawa in the 2015 NHL draft. “Ottawa’s home for us. We bought our first house here, we’ve had our first child here,” said Chabot, whose wife, Marion, gave birth to their daughter last week. “Ottawa will always be close to our heart, no

matter what. “Every organization goes through different times, and we’re looking ahead in what we have here,” he added. “We’re excited of the team we have. We have tons of guys that are happy to be here and want to play and want to wear this jersey every night.” Chabot, who has often served as a team ambassador for francophone fans in the Ottawa-Gatineau region, becomes the 11th captain in franchise history after the Senators sent Tkachuk to the Florida Panthers in June, following his trade request. Tkachuk had served as captain for almost five seasons after taking over the role Nov. 5, 2021. In 569 career games with Ottawa, Chabot has recorded 78 goals and 335 points, including seven goals and 31 points in 57 games last season. Chabot is signed through the 2027-28

season with a salary cap hit of US\$8-million. “The players gravitate to him. The way that he plays the game, the way he commits to the game is inspiring for his teammates,” Senators general manager Steve Staios said. “I think for a long time we knew who it was going to be. We had the very fortunate ability to look at a number of players on our group to be able to lead us, but clearly Thomas is the guy. “He doesn’t have to do anything different than what he’s already done to lead this group.” The Senators, who were swept by the Carolina Hurricanes in the first round of last season’s playoffs, open their 2026-27 campaign Saturday against the Toronto Maple Leafs.

THE CANADIAN PRESS

Blue Jays

■ FROM B12

Yesavage, Ponce and Spencer Arighetti are the current favourites to fill out the starting five in 2027. Toronto set franchise highs by using 41 pitchers and 64 players this year. NUMBERS DOWN When the Blue Jays were introduced on opening day at Rogers Centre, some of the loudest cheers were for hitting coach David Popkins. He seemed to unlock something in the Toronto hitters in 2025. The regression this year was a downright head-scratcher. The Blue Jays led the league in several offensive categories – including batting average (.265) and on-base percentage (.333) – a year ago. Eight players reached double digits in home runs. Toronto was tied for eighth this year with a .247 team batting average, but the slugging numbers dropped significantly. The Blue Jays were last in the 30-team major leagues in homers (152), 26th in slugging percentage (.381) and tied for 28th in OPS (.691). Kazuma Okamoto had a strong year with 33 homers and 92 RBIs – by far the team leader in both categories. Designated hitter George Springer was next with 15 homers and 54 RBIs.

SWEET RELIEF

Toronto’s bullpen was a real strong point this season. Louis Varland took on the closer’s role with aplomb (35 saves, 1.27 ERA) and Mason Fluharty led the major leagues in appearances (83) while posting a 7-1 mark and 3-30 ERA. Braydon Fisher (3-4, 3.21 ERA, 75 appearances) and Tyler Rogers (2-3, 1.77 ERA, 74 appearances) also proved to be consistent high-leverage options. Bullpen games became the norm down the stretch, and the relievers delivered. Rule 5 pick Spencer Miles enjoyed a standout rookie campaign with a 6-2 mark and 2.63 ERA over 49 appearances, including eight starts.

LOOKING FORWARD

The Blue Jays should get a boost next year when a number of key offensive players return after extended injury absences. Slugger Anthony Santander (shoulder, back) missed the entire 2026 season, and Addison Barger (elbow) played just nine games. General manager Ross Atkins will most likely be looking to add a power bat in the off-season along with some pitching depth. The Blue Jays had a payroll of about US\$275-million this year and have about US\$195-million on the books for next year. Labour uncertainty is expected to hover over the off-season. The current collective agreement between Major League Baseball and its players’ association is set to expire on Dec. 1.

THE CANADIAN PRESS

Leafs

■ FROM B12

Maple Leafs winger Jack Roslovic said it won’t be long until Marchenko was part of the locker-room fabric. “You can take a lot of things from him,” said Roslovic, who played two seasons with Marchenko in Columbus. “Every day’s a great day for him ... the things that irk him don’t really get in his way. “Brings some juice and some life.” Toronto head coach Jim Hiller wouldn’t speculate where Marchenko will fit in the lineup, but alongside No. 1 centre Auston Matthews appears from the outside to eventually be the most likely landing spot. “One of those guys that seems to accelerate with the puck,” Hiller said. “He loves having the puck ... he’s a shot threat and he distributes. “There’s lots there for us. He’ll be a really strong addition.” The Maple Leafs are also losing a big piece in Knies. Chayka, however, felt it was time for another swing after an off-season of seismic change coming off the club’s first playoff-less spring in a decade. “My job is to always make the team as best as possible,” he said. “Not just collect talent, but put together a team that fits and works. “We just felt like it was the right move at this time.”

THE CANADIAN PRESS

[BRAVES VS. PHILLIES]



Into the wild

Braves third baseman Austin Riley hits a three-run home run against the Phillies during Game 1 of the National League wild card series in Atlanta on Tuesday. The Braves won 5-3. For more on the MLB postseason, head to ■ [GLOBESPORTS.COM](#)

BRYNN ANDERSON/THE ASSOCIATED PRESS

Retooled Sixers aim high with James on board

Philly players get a taste of legend’s star power as training camp opens

DAN GELSTON CAMDEN, N.J.

The answers Anfernee Simons gamely tried to offer about the first day of 76ers training camp were suddenly drowned out by the furious whirling overhead of a helicopter leaving the team’s complex. LeBron James’s helicopter. James indeed used the rotorcraft for the rich to take him after practice from New Jersey to presumably close to wherever he decided to live in New York. The helicopter noises are usually reserved for when billionaire team owner Josh Harris lands at the complex for the NBA draft or a major news conference. Not any more. The Sixers were quickly caught in the whirlwind of the first days of the LeBron Effect, even as a

pair of players and coach Nick Nurse professed all was good on the court. Off the court, make room. Sixers staff moved the news conference backdrop from a corner where a few dozen reporters are usually stuffed to shout questions at Joel Embiid or Tyrese Maxey to a spot closer toward midcourt for a roomier feel for the more than 50 credentialed reporters, bloggers, TV camera operators and more that came to get an early report card on James’s official first day as a Sixer. James was gone Tuesday by the time media was allowed on the court to watch practice. Embiid, Maxey, former Boston star Jaylen Brown, they were all absent, too, a day after holding court on media day. Nurse is starting his fourth season as coach of the Sixers. He’s used to handling the demands that come with working in a major market and dealing with star players in Philly such as with Embiid and his daily injury report or

the high drama that surrounded former Sixer James Harden. Nurse did say he had conversations with the team about looking out for each other and staying connected while navigating a spotlight season – especially early – that already has a postseason-type of aura around the franchise before the Sixers even played a game. “It is going to be different,” Nurse said. “More people, more eyes, more stories, more national TV. All that kind of stuff. It’s the same, just a little more. I’m just trying to get to the practice floor and to the game floor. If we can do those two things, all that other stuff, we’ll just kind of handle it as smoothly as we can.” Nurse called the sight of so much talent “impressive” once the Sixers hit the floor for practice. James is a future Hall of Famer. Embiid has certainly built a strong case. Brown was an NBA finals MVP and champion with the Celtics. Maxey earned his first all-star start last season and has blos-

somed into an elite talent. The fifth starter is more than just, oh, that other guy. VJ Edgecombe was third in rookie of the year voting last season and his buoyant personality and defensive playmaking made him an instant fan favourite and immediate force in helping the Sixers return last season to the playoffs. Edgecombe worked out with James over the summer and volunteered that he orchestrated the starting five group text thread – well, once he asked Maxey for James’s number. That was all cool. Yet the magnitude of the moment truly hit him ahead of practice when James put on his No. 23 jersey in the same locker room as Edgecombe. The 21-year-old Edgecombe tried not to get starstruck. He called James a teammate, a brother, a Sixer who will fight on the court side by side with them to chase the franchise’s first championship since 1983. Maybe. But he’s still LeBron

James. “It’s like, damn, that’s still Bron,” Edgecombe said with a laugh. “He was in the locker room and I’m like, ‘Oh, that’s Bron over there.’ His locker was open. He was in there before everybody as usual. He dapped me up, he’s like, ‘What up? what up?’ We know each other for a minute.” Edgecombe smiled as he tried to convince himself he’s expunged the fan boy from his system. “I ain’t gonna be like that no more,” Edgecombe said to laughter. True to his word, Edgecombe said he had to get loud during practice and give James some defensive instruction on when to switch off. “We forgot. We messed up a switch,” Edgecombe said. “But that’s what happens. We’re getting to know each other. It’s a new system for him. Everything is on the fly right now.”

THE ASSOCIATED PRESS

Whitecaps extend Muller deal through MLS ‘sprint season’

GEMMA KARSTENS-SMITH VANCOUVER

Thomas Muller is not ready to retire. The Vancouver Whitecaps announced on Tuesday that the club has signed the German soccer legend to a contract extension through Major League Soccer’s 2027 “sprint season.” The sprint season is set to run from February through May 2027 before the league switches to the international summer-to-spring calendar in July 2027. “So far it’s a hell of a ride. It’s really fun to be with this team, to be with these people and to be with the club,” Muller said in a video released by the ‘Caps. “And my body is still good. “I just feel that it’s so much fun to be out on the pitch, week in and week out. Every match day is a good day for me. And we want to achieve our goals.” Reaching the extension required the 37-year-old Muller to evaluate how his body is feeling and whether he could physically handle another season, said Whitecaps CEO and sporting director Axel Schuster. “He’s smart enough to say, ‘I don’t want to be on the pitch one day, and people say, ‘You should have stopped;’ ” he said. “He doesn’t need that. He had his massive career. He could have retired before he came to Vancouver, and he can retire at any given end of a season, and everyone will be happy.” Muller signed with Vancouver in August 2025 following 17 seasons with Bayern Munich, where he scored 250 goals across all competitions. The attacking midfielder has continued to be a dominant force in MLS, tallying 16 goals and 11 assists over 29 regular-

season games. He’s made 45 appearances across all competitions for the Whitecaps, contributing 19 goals and 12 assists in the process, and was named an MLS all-star this summer. Before joining the ‘Caps, Muller led Bayern to 13 league championships and 33 total titles. He also won the 2014 World Cup with Germany, scoring five goals in the tournament, and took home the Golden Boot from the 2010 World Cup in South Africa, finishing with five goals and three assists. Muller said he isn’t done yet. “I really appreciate to be here, hunting titles with this team, especially the MLS Cup,” he said. “And the journey continues. But that doesn’t mean that we kind of take it easy this year. But we have another bullet.” With Muller in their ranks, the club won the MLS Western Conference title last season and made it to its first MLS Cup final, ultimately falling 3-1 to Lionel Messi’s Inter Miami. Vancouver has hovered around the top of the league standings this season, and currently holds first place in the Western Conference with a 15-6-5 record. Schuster said Muller’s superstar appeal has been felt off the field as well. “If we speak about [merchandise] sales, jerseys, if we speak about awareness, media recognition, and how often this club was mentioned in North America, in Canada, in the world, I mean, I would say in some areas it’s quadrupled. In some areas it’s 10 times as much,” he said. The team would have grown without Muller, Schuster added, but he’s made the growth bigger and faster.

THE CANADIAN PRESS

‘The emperor is naked’: UEFA president Ceferin attacks FIFA boss Infantino in speech to clubs

JULIEN PRETOT

UEFA president Aleksander Ceferin said ‘the emperor is naked’ on Tuesday in a blistering attack on FIFA president Gianni Infantino and his failed plan to sell a stake in the governing body’s commercial rights to private investors. Addressing the European Football Clubs General Assembly in Copenhagen, Ceferin invoked Hans Christian Andersen’s *The Emperor’s New Clothes* as he criticized the language FIFA had used to defend Infantino’s shelved FIFA Forward Enterprise project. “Almost 200 years ago, he wrote *The Emperor’s New Clothes*,” Ceferin said. “We all know the story. An emperor is persuaded that he is wearing magnificent clothes, clothes which he is told only the foolish or unfit cannot see. “His court goes along with it until a child simply says aloud what everybody can see. The emperor is naked.” Infantino’s FIFA Forward Enterprise proposal would have created a FIFA-controlled commercial subsidiary holding rights to competitions including the men’s and women’s World Cups and Club World Cup and allowed private investors to acquire up to 20 per cent of the entity. Infantino had promoted the proposal as a way to generate more money for football development and said it was subject to a democratic consultation with FIFA’s 211 member associations before it was abandoned following widespread opposition. Ceferin directly challenged that language. “Perhaps the moral of the story is con-

venient words cannot change uncomfortable realities,” he said. “Now world football has heard some very convenient words recently. Development, democratization, consultation, words used in fact to describe the opposite. Selling part of football’s future does not become development because you say it’s development. “Putting a fait accompli in front of national associations does not mean democratization, even if you call it democratization. However big the cheque is. “And secrecy does not become consultation because you call it consultation.” Ceferin then asked club executives to imagine one of their senior officials secretly negotiating away control of their “crown jewels” without the knowledge of their board, players or supporters, with the deal almost completed by the time they learned of it: “What would your board do?” he asked. He went on to refer to a hypothetical situation in which the same person created an award for a politician and, soon afterwards, the politician made a phone call after which “the rules are not the same any more.” “How many times would this have to happen at your clubs before the world says ‘enough?’ ” Ceferin said. “Well, my friends, I think it’s time to say enough.” He ended the passage by accusing unnamed decision-makers of bending rules when they became inconvenient, excluding those who were supposed to have a say and treating football’s future as “just another bargaining chip.”

REUTERS

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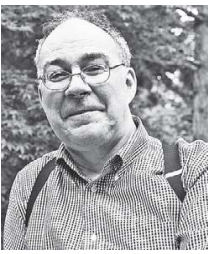
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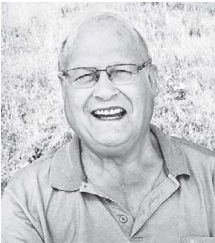
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DEATHS



RONALD P. SCHLEGEL
OC, PhD, LLD, FCAHS

Passed away peacefully on Saturday, September 19, 2026 surrounded by family and his grand-daughter singing to him, at WRHN @ Queens Blvd. in Kitchener. He was 83 years old.

Family - Beloved husband of the late Barbara Schlegel (Becker), who passed away in 2022. Loving father of Rob and his partner, Jennifer; Brad and his wife, Heidi; and James and his wife, Juliana. Much-loved Grampa to Naomi, Nicholas, and Jackson.

Ron was predeceased by his parents, Wilfred and Emma Schlegel; his parents-in-law, Max and Florence Becker; his brothers, Wayne and Ernie; his brothers-in-law, Carl Gingerich and Bruce Becker; and his sisters-in-law, Marilyn and Linda. He is survived by his sisters, Marilyn Gingerich and Jan (Art) Mueller, and his sisters-in-law, Pauline Becker and Joyce Schlegel.

Ron was first and foremost a loving husband, father, grandpa, brother, cousin and friend. He was married to Barb who he met at Rockway Mennonite Collegiate. They were married for over 58 years and created a wonderful life and home with much joy, happiness and love. They stood together through life's ups and downs, and with faith they always persevered. Barb's unconditional support made it possible for Ron to fully pursue his calling of sharing his gifts. Ron was very proud of his three sons, deriving great joy from working together with them in the family organization. He cherished his three daughters-in-law and was grateful for their efforts to make sure he was well cared for with visits, food, hearing aids and hugs. One of his biggest joys came from his three grandchildren. He was their biggest cheerleader. He treasured the time with Naomi singing songs and attending her performances, and watching Nicholas and Jackson playing various sports and celebrating their accomplishments. Having his family gathered around a table with a homecooked meal and sharing stories and many laughs was always a precious time for Ron.

Early Life and Values Foundation - Ron was born on the family farm at Punkeydoodles Corners, into a family who was committed to the community and their Mennonite faith. Ron's parents, Wilfred and Emma, were progressive in their farming practices and also in their approach to the church, community service and leadership. These qualities were the impetus for them to lead a group from East Zorra to Ailsa Craig, in Middlesex County, when Ron was 5 years old. Wilfred was not only the minister of the new church, he was also the innovator and driver of many projects to meet social needs that he had identified. Wilfred was a pastor, farmer, businessperson and social entrepreneur, all woven into one. He was the greatest influence on Ron's life, teaching by example not words. Working alongside his father, Ron learned the values of hard work, positivity, humility, creativity, common purpose and, most importantly, serving others. Ron's commitment to community building through servant leadership was inspired by his father and rooted in his strong faith. These values guided him in all his future endeavours.

Education and Academic Career – Ron's gift and interest in learning led him to earn degrees from Western University and the University of Illinois, and a PhD in Social Psychology from Ohio State University. He shared his academic gifts first as a high school math teacher, then as a professor at the University of Windsor, and later, in 1972, as a professor at the University of Waterloo where he spearheaded the development of the Department of Health Studies and Gerontology. In addition to lecturing, he led many research projects including for smoking cessation which were implemented around the world, leading to the formation of RBJ Health Management Associates.

Ron also embraced lifelong learning before the concept was mainstream. He was deeply and genuinely curious about every person he met and the life experiences that shaped them. He had a remarkable ability to relate to people, learn from them, encourage them and make lasting connections.

Areas of Calling – Ron's motivation and dedication to community building, fueled by his entrepreneurial spirit, led to a multitude of pursuits within the broader RBJ Schlegel organization. The goal was not to accumulate personal wealth but rather to advance projects for social good. Capital was simply one tool of many required to achieve the objective.

Ron's farming roots and interests led him to create a substantial agribusiness, Schlegel Poultry, committed to producing healthy, nutritious and local food.

Dedication to community building was the motivation for Ron to create Schlegel Urban Developments and its mission to intentionally design and build neighbourhoods which are walkable, age and family friendly, environmentally sustainable and where neighbours get to know one another. The Williamsburg Town Centre in Kitchener is the original community designed by Ron based on 'new urbanism' principles, learned from conferences, books and mostly by many site visits he made around the world. Another component of Schlegel Urban is St. Jacobs Farmers' Market, with the priority of continuing it as a place of commerce and connection.

Ron also had a passion for mental health and addiction care. Homewood Health, which includes the Homewood Health Centre in Guelph, became part of the Schlegel organization in 2010, building a continuum of education, prevention and treatment services across Canada to restore healthy minds and helping people return to work and their lives.

The calling for which Ron is probably best known is his dedication to Seniors Care and Living and his creation of Schlegel Villages. His passion for this field started as a young boy when he carried food trays in a small nursing home his father had started. This sparked a lifelong interest in seniors and their care and quality of life. Ron pioneered the 'Village' model which incorporated a continuum to provide various levels of care under one roof and organized around a main-street design, with the intent of promoting social connection and a sense of belonging for residents. Ron envisaged the Villages as caring communities where residents live a life of meaning, purpose and active life engagement. Schlegel Villages now serves seniors in 24 cities across Ontario.

All these callings were undergirded by Ron's dedication to building strong and healthy communities.

Research and Innovation – A believer in using research to drive innovation, Ron used his unique combination of expertise in business and academia to integrate research, education and practice to improve quality care and quality of life for seniors everywhere. He brought together University of Waterloo and Conestoga College in this shared pursuit. He passionately undertook to create and fund the now internationally recognized Schlegel-UW Research Institute for Aging in 2005 with the focus on applying research driven innovation to benefit seniors in Ontario, across Canada and beyond. Ron also revitalized and funded the Homewood Research Institute which undertakes much needed research in the field of mental health and addiction treatment, in partnership with McMaster University.

Community Service and Recognitions - A generous community builder and philanthropist, Ron gave his energy, expertise, ideas and financial resources to countless organizations locally and around the world. He had a special interest in the work of Mennonite Economic Development Associates (MEDA), creating business solutions to poverty globally. He served on the boards of the University of Waterloo, Conrad Grebel, Rockway Mennonite Collegiate, Toronto Stockyards Land Development and several provincial health research task forces and councils, amongst others.

Ron's contributions were recognized through induction into both the Communitech Entrepreneur and Waterloo Region Halls of Fame, and honours including K-W Citizen of the Year, Ernst & Young Entrepreneur of the Year, Waterloo Region's Barnraiser Award, International Innovator of the Year for Seniors Care, the Queen Elizabeth II Diamond Jubilee Medal, and the King Charles III Coronation Medal, amongst others. Ron received honorary degrees from Waterloo, Western and McMaster universities and Conestoga College. He also was made a Fellow of the Canadian Academy of Health Sciences. In 2012, Ron was appointed an Officer of the Order of Canada in recognition of his lifelong commitment to improving elder care in Canada and his founding vision of the Research Institute for Aging.

In response to these many accolades, Ron always emphasized to the broader RBJ Schlegel organization that these were 'WE' awards, not 'ME' awards.

Notwithstanding a very hectic schedule, Ron was never too busy to take as much time as needed to comfort, mentor, counsel and walk with many people who came to him for advice and assistance during difficult times or decision points in their lives.

Gratitude - The family would like to thank the compassionate team members at The Village of Winston Park for their dedicated service and care for Ron over the past several years. The family also thanks the care teams at WRHN with special appreciation for Dr. Claus Rinne, Anita Cressman (NP) and the Heart Function Clinic team, and Dr. Kassem Ashe and the Cardiac Care team. Special mention to Dr. Paul O'Byrne at the Firestone Clinic in Hamilton. The steadfast support of all Ron's personal caregivers throughout, especially Elizabeth, Ruth, Jalea and Sunja, will always be remembered.

We are immeasurably grateful for Ron's values-based life, rooted in his faith and dedicated to serving others and for his willingness to share his many God-given talents to make a positive impact in this world.

Arrangements
Visitation - Ron's family will receive friends and relatives at Erb & Good Family Funeral Home, 171 King St. S, Waterloo, on Thursday, October 1, 2026, from 6:00pm – 9:00pm and on Friday, October 2, 2026, from 2:00pm – 5:00pm and from 7:00pm – 9:00pm. Please find **overflow parking details** on the Erb & Good website: erbgood.com.

Funeral Service - The funeral service to celebrate his life and faith will be held at Stirling Avenue Mennonite Church, 57 Stirling Avenue North, Kitchener, on Saturday, October 3, 2026, at 11:00am. Limited parking is available at the church. **Overflow parking provided** at the Kitchener Memorial Auditorium (please enter off Stirling Ave., Kitchener) Lot F and G, with shuttle service provided to the church. For those unable to attend the service, it will be livestreamed at The Village of Winston Park (address below). A livestream link will be provided at erbgood.com on Ron's tribute page and will remain on the funeral home website for future viewing.

A private family interment will be held at Williamsburg Cemetery, Kitchener, at a later time.

Reception - A light lunch and a time to visit with the family will immediately follow the funeral service at The Village of Winston Park, 695 Block Line Rd., Kitchener. Enter through the main Town Square entrance facing Westmount Rd. Overflow parking available at the nearby Williamsburg Town Centre TD Bank, 187 Fischer-Hallman Rd, where shuttle buses to Winston Park will be provided.

Donations in memory of Ron may be made to the Schlegel-UW Research Institute for Aging and the Homewood Research Institute through the funeral home at erbgood.com or (519) 745-8445.

Manchester City found guilty of nearly all 115 charges

JAMES ROBSON
STEVE DOUGLAS
MANCHESTER, ENGLAND

Manchester City has been found guilty of arranging “sham” contracts as part of a slew of financial breaches that helped it dominate English soccer in what’s become the biggest scandal in Premier League history.

City, in an independent panel’s verdict published Tuesday, was found guilty of almost all of the unprecedented 100-plus charges against it over a nine-year period in which the Abu Dhabi-backed team changed the landscape of the richest and most popular soccer league in the world.

City’s alleged financial wrongdoing was worth in excess of £900-million (\$1.69-billion), and Premier League chief executive Richard Masters said the ruling showed City “systematically broke Premier League rules for nearly a decade.”

“This disciplinary case, and this decision, are the most significant in Premier League history,” Masters said.

City now faces severe sanctions that could include a huge points deduction or even expulsion from the league, causing severe reputational damage to its Abu Dhabi ownership.

The Premier League said sanctions will be decided in a separate hearing held by the independent commission.

City has always denied wrongdoing and said in a statement that it was “disappointed and surprised” by the ruling. It also plans to further drag out a case that has already run for more than three years by appealing the verdict and said it would be “relentless” in its fight to clear its name.

Any appeal by City would have to be made by Friday, the league said. City chief executive Ferran Soriano was asked for comment by broadcaster Sky News, but replied: “I have nothing to say, thank you.”

The explosive ruling comes after it emerged last week that the charges against City were expected to be upheld following an exhaustive process.

The Premier League initiated its case more than three years ago and allegations first arose in 2018 from leaked club e-mails and documents.

City was accused of a raft of financial violations from 2009-18 – a period when the northwest club, long in the shadow of great rival Manchester United, was transforming itself into a record-breaking global superpower that has won multiple Premier League titles and the Champions League.

The violations included failing to provide accurate financial information and submitting inflated figures for sponsorship deals out of Abu Dhabi, hiding payments and breaching financial rules established by the Premier League and UEFA, European soccer’s governing body, intended to keep clubs financially stable by not spending beyond their means.

On top of that, City faced many other charges of failing to co-operate with the investigation between 2018-23.

“An independent commission has found Manchester City guilty of all charges related to serious breaches of the Premier League’s financial rules over a nine-season period,” the league said, “and the majority of charges in relation to its failure to co-operate with the league’s investigation.”

Regarding the sponsorship deals, the league said: “Manchester City arranged ‘sham’ contracts (which misrepresented the true agreement between the parties) with a number of its commercial partners, as well as relying on ‘sham’ agreements with others, to artificially inflate the club’s revenues and reduce its costs.

“The club,” the league added, “filed misstated accounts and concealed the true state of its finances from its auditors and football regulators.”

City has always protested its innocence in the case, saying in 2023 when the charges were laid that there was a “comprehensive body of irrefutable evidence that exists in support of its position.”

Even over the weekend, City chairman Khaldoon al-Mubarak said there remained a “confidence and intent in proving the club’s innocence.”

THE ASSOCIATED PRESS

In your thoughts

Memorialize and celebrate a loved one in The Globe and Mail.

LEIGH LERNER

RELIGIOUS LEADER, 81

FORMER MONTREAL RABBI ADVOCATED ‘RADICAL INCLUSIVITY’

He performed a ground-breaking interfaith wedding in Minnesota in the 1970s and continued the practice after moving to Canada, where he also presided over same-sex civil unions and marriages

LISA FITTERMAN

Rabbi Leigh Lerner's catchphrase was “Go do it,” no matter if the goal was to start a food bank, combat human trafficking, fight for LGBTQ rights or overcome opposition to interfaith marriage. As a university student in the United States in the mid-1960s, he was steeped in the tradition of social justice advocacy, with a finely honed sense of right and wrong and the quiet determination to get things done, even if others disagreed with him.

As the long-time lead rabbi of the reform Temple Emanu-El-Beth-Sholom in Westmount, Que. (upon his retirement in 2012, he became the synagogue's “Rabbi Emeritus”), he saw the job as something that was rooted in tradition but needed to change to respond to the times. Like the Talmudic scholars of yore, he believed that issues needed to be discussed openly, not only within the confines of the Jewish community, and that faith should encompass everyone who wanted to participate, even in the most peripheral of ways.

In 1977, when Mr. Lerner was the senior rabbi at the Mount Zion Temple in St. Paul, Minn., he officiated over what the state's historical society calls the first interfaith wedding in any Minnesota house of worship. He continued that practice in Montreal, where he also regularly presided over same-sex civil unions and then same-sex marriages when they became legal.

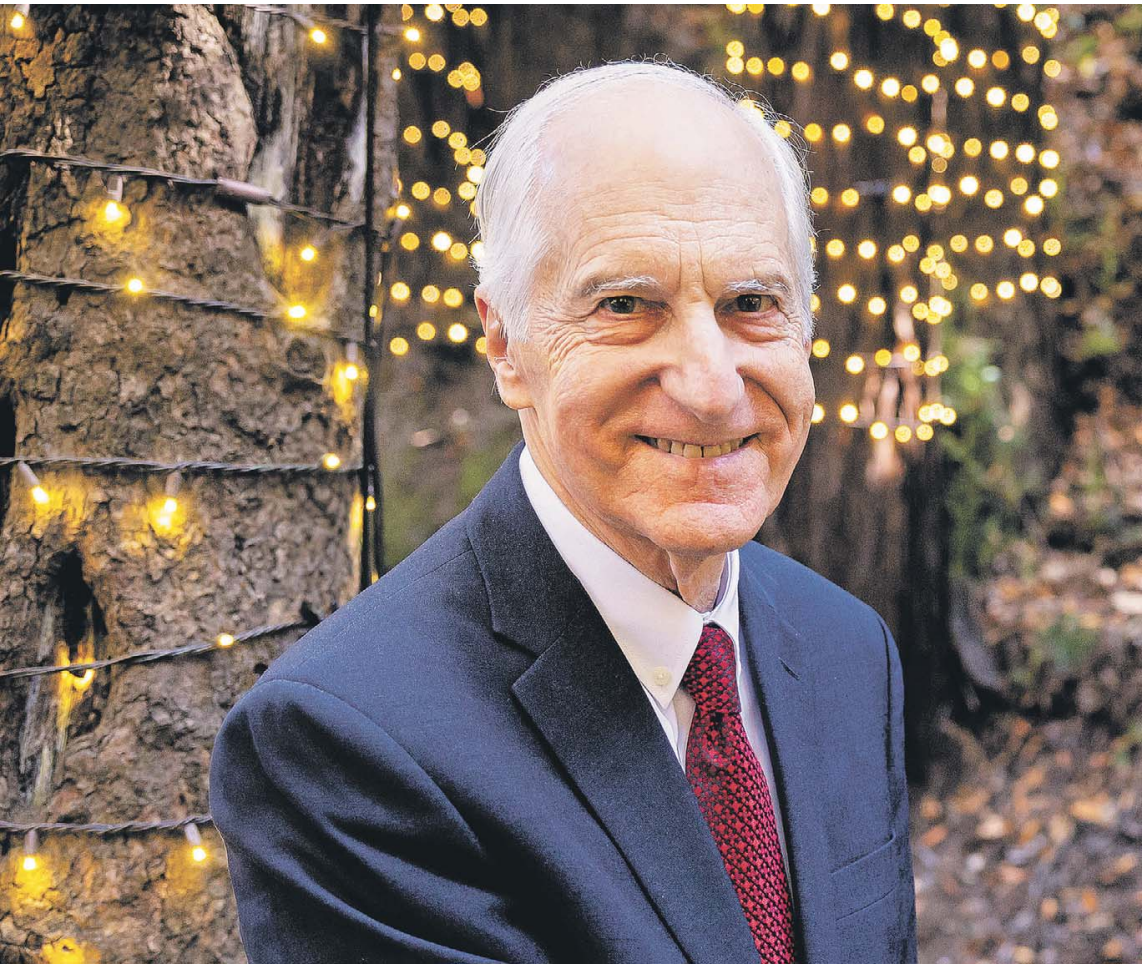
“If you spend 23 years leading one congregation and over 50 years in the rabbinate, like Leigh did, you don't do it well without perseverance and a commitment to who you are and what you do,” said Rabbi Lisa Grushcow, his successor at Temple Emanu-El-Beth-Sholom. “He left a strong and healthy community in a city where we are the only Reform congregation with all the unique pressures that entails. And he did it by bringing us to the table with a radical inclusivity.”

Mr. Lerner died in Las Vegas on Sept. 5 from complications due to a stroke.

He was 81 years old, a tall, lean, polyvalent man who learned French when he moved to Montreal in 1989 in order to better understand the city at large, and who was given to striding the streets in a deerstalker hat, his hands folded behind his back.

His friend, Rabbi Bob Alper, with whom he studied at Hebrew Union College in Cincinnati, said their relationship really began a few years after they had both graduated. That was when Mr. Lerner returned class notes he had borrowed from Mr. Alper in their final year.

“I had asked for the notes to be returned but Leigh insisted he had no idea what I was talking about,” Mr. Alper recalled. “Then, as he was going through old boxes in St. Paul, he found them, sent



In 1983, Leigh Lerner headed to Moscow and Leningrad (now St. Petersburg) to meet with Soviet refuseniks, Jewish citizens who were denied visas to emigrate. SCOTT LASKY

them to me with an apologetic note.

“That was a spark for me. He was a man of quality and modesty, with great strength of character.”

It demonstrated what his friend was so good at, Mr. Alper continued: creating sparks of kindness and understanding day by day, year by year, that represented the highest form of Judaism.

For 22 years, Mr. Lerner marched in Montreal pride parades, while he was a member of the advisory council of the now-defunct Across Boundaries Multi-faith Institute in Montreal, a past president of the Montreal Christian Jewish Dialogue and a supporter of the Montreal Muslim Jewish Dialogue.

He was wont to say that it was through such dialogues that people learned of the diversity that thrives on the other side of the table.

“Is inter-religious dialogue realistic? Is it practical? Yes, and it is very necessary,” he once said during a panel discussion in November 2003. “It is remarkable for me to see how people who have been in dialogue for some time are discovering that others are coming to them and saying, ‘Can we get in on it?’

“They realize that there is a gap, there is something missing in the quality of our understanding of one another, and that only dialogue is a viable and safe way for people of different faiths to understand each other.”

At a time when antisemitism is on the rise, including a firebombing of the Temple Emanu-El-Beth Sholom earlier this year, Mr. Alper said that his friend's message is more important than ever.

“As grief-stricken we all are, as upset, angry at what the world has come to, Leigh would have been consoling and strengthening people where he could, encouraging people to be strong,” he noted.

Leigh Lerner was born in a military hospital in Fort Snelling, Minn., on March 3, 1945, the first of David and Edith Lerner's two children.

At the time, his father was overseas with the army in the final months of the Second World War; when he came back, he worked as a car salesman. The family lived in St. Louis Park, a suburban community just west of Minneapolis before moving to Atlanta for about a decade, then to Chicago.

Perhaps because of the moves, Leigh and his little sister, Trudie, were close; when they fought, as

siblings will do, it was always the brother who would approach his sister later, hand outstretched and asking for them to be friends again.

Neither parent wanted their son to enter the rabbinate. Indeed, his mom pushed for him to become a doctor. Wanting to please her, he took premed classes at Duke University in Durham, N.C., but was drawn more to English and writing, eventually getting his undergraduate degree in English literature.

While he was at Duke, his mother became gravely ill. As she lay dying, she gave her son her blessing to become a rabbi. In 1972, he was ordained by the Hebrew Union College-Jewish Institute of Religion in Cincinnati and embarked on a career that would take him from St. Paul to Montreal and, upon his official retirement, to minister to congregations during stints in Italy, for which he learned Italian. As much as he loved Montreal, he was happy to leave snow and ice storms behind, so he established a new home in Las Vegas.

Among the highlights was a trip he took with Mr. Alper in 1983 to Moscow and Leningrad (now St. Petersburg) to meet with Soviet refuseniks, the term for Jewish citizens who were denied visas to

emigrate.

“It was one week of an amazing, dangerous, scary, spiritually uplifting experience, the most important week of my life as a Jew,” said Mr. Alper. “We met in the Frankfurt Airport, where we walked around and around, coding our notes, memorizing them, then throwing them out because we knew the last thing the KGB wanted was for nosy American rabbis encouraging dissidents.”

“I have this memory of Leigh standing tall and straight in Moscow next to a woman we'd hired as our tour guide for a day, laughing delightedly when I told them to smile and say ‘visa,’” he continued.

“His smile was just one of the innumerable sparks he lit that will continue to light our way into the future.”

Mr. Lerner was awarded the Queen Elizabeth II Diamond Jubilee Medal in 2012 for his contributions to the community and to Canada.

He leaves his wife, Loren Lerner; his sister, Trudie Lerner; a half-brother, Terry Brashem; his daughters, Meredith Bloom and Sasha Lerner; his stepsons, Sam and Daniel Singer; and four grandchildren.

Special to The Globe and Mail

I REMEMBER

GEORGE CHUVALO

In 1962, George Chuvalo was world famous and I was a three-year-old child refugee/immigrant. Upon our arrival, my family moved to Toronto's noisy, industrial, polyglot Junction neighbourhood. Like George Chuvalo's parents, we, too, were Croatian. My two older brothers and I learned to revere this heroic man during his rise to fame in the boxing world. To my parents, he was “Jure Chuvalo” of Herzegovina (despite having been born in Canada). He was a Croat and countryman.

We took pride knowing as well that our Dad worked with Mr. Chuvalo's father in the abattoir district.

Although we felt connected to him ethnically, we weren't unique. He connected somehow with all the kids, and the parents, the shopkeepers, our teachers, the cops. All the Italians, Maltese, Ukrainians, Greeks and

diaspora of all origins knew him ... as our *Canadian* champion. He brought us together despite the very real Old World antagonisms of our parents so soon after the world wars, not to mention the very real prejudices we knew from our Canadian-born friends and foes.

He showed us that courage, achievement and excellence were what mattered in sports and in life.

Many decades later, I approached Mr. Chuvalo at the Rexdale Home Depot.

He was well into his 60s by then. I was with my elderly mother, who recognized him before I did. After I introduced myself, my mother reminded him of various shared connections going back to the packing houses of a long since gentrified Junction. We spoke “CroEnglish,” a mixture of Croatian and English familiar only to those of us so



George Chuvalo

situated.

It was fun. He was affable and friendly. Despite his years he maintained an imposing frame and handsome pugilistic ruggedness.

He laughed a lot reminiscing about George Bell Arena, the CPR yard and “the Packers.”

We were also well aware of his own tortured past. The tragic fate of three sons and his first wife.

We also shared a surprising number of connections to the old neighbourhood. Our conversation turned to his work at battling drug abuse among underprivileged youth in communities across the country.

We had a laugh agreeing that the prospect of working at Canada Packers nudged us both along in our respective careers. Genteel by comparison, mine was to pursue education and a legal career. By then, I was a Crown prosecutor in British Columbia. He took

an interest upon learning of my involvement in Youth and Criminal Court. We stayed in touch from time to time and when he was in B.C. I was able to offer him support and encouragement in the important work he was doing.

Mr. Chuvalo carried an immense load. I am grateful for his example of courage, generosity and kindness. He will be remembered fondly: the man who despite losing the bout, went dancing with his wife after the fight with Ali. Ali didn't knock him down. And although Ali won the fight, he spent the night in hospital.

At this pivotal moment where we find ourselves toe to toe with America over a trade war, we can take comfort in the example of that Great Canadian, George Chuvalo.

Ron Beram, Gabriola, B.C. *



Sacred Flight

Colleen Gray

Mi'kmaw-Acadian-Irish artist



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